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Preface

Most of this book is a compilation of essays originally published on Substack. They were written by 0xAgro over a period of roughly six months, from November 14, 2025, to June 5, 2026. Every essay was released free of charge and, if still available, should remain free to read. If you are purchasing this book solely for access to the essays themselves, I encourage you to seek out the originals instead.

While the ideas in this book are as original as the author can conceive them to be, AI tools were used to refine the prose and polish the communication. If you take issue with that, I encourage you to read Ludwig Wittgenstein. You may also wish to reflect on where your own sense of meaning comes from. Is meaning found in communication, or in language games? Does it arise from the purely mental, or from the functional relationship between mind and the physical world?

Although the central ideas remain unchanged, the text has been revised where necessary to improve readability and allow the essays to function as a connected work rather than a collection of isolated articles.

This physical book exists for one reason: preservation.

I believe there are ideas within these pages that may one day prove useful. How confident should anyone be in such a belief? Not very. A person who claims to perceive

patterns that others do not is, statistically speaking, far more likely to be mistaken than correct.

There are only two broad possibilities. Either I am deeply mistaken, and perhaps one day that will become obvious, or I am not, and these ideas may hold value beyond my own lifetime. Reason would suggest the future does not yet exist, that I may never witness whether any of this matters, and that there is little justification for preserving thoughts whose usefulness cannot be measured.

Yet instinct does not always submit to reason.

Whatever connection exists between these words and a future reader rests almost entirely on instinct. Whether that instinct is a gift or a flaw is not mine to determine.

1

Freedom

Freedom & Its Illusion Quantified

The Struggle Between Innate and Imposed Governance and the End of Human Consciousness



This chapter seeks to explore the concept of freedom by quantifying its relationship to governance. It critically examines past theories on governance, particularly those of Adam Smith, Karl Marx, and Georg Wilhelm Friedrich Hegel. Hegel and Smith, failed to fully account for the complexities of human nature and evolving governance. A new theory of historical dialectics, distinct from Hegel's framework, is proposed. This theory offers a more profound understanding of the risks humanity faces in the future, attempting to predict a general trajectory for human civilization while suggesting predicting itself is flawed. In doing so, it examines the tension between innate governance, the biological and psychological forces that shape individual behaviour, and imposed governance, the physical environment modified by societal structures like laws, money, and social incentives. If this chapter holds, the contents imply humans may at some point lose

consciousness as we know it. This dialectic is simply pattern recognition, not history in itself.

Governance is a complex interplay between two forces:

Innate governance: refers to the natural, biological instincts that govern human behaviour, including our innate desires for survival, procreation, and social interaction. These biological imperatives are deeply rooted in our evolutionary history. Innate governance is decision-making rooted in repetitive physical realities, conscious or not.

Imposed governance: includes the societal structures that we create, such as laws, monetary systems, and social norms effecting physical realities. These systems are not innate but are imposed upon us by the structures of society, often as a response to the need to organize, regulate, and control innate governance.

Alcohol is an example of a substance that alters innate governance. It impairs judgment and may lead to actions driven more by immediate desire than long-term survival or social harmony. After intoxication, individuals often experience regret as their new innate impulses temporarily override. This can create chaos. Another example of innate governance change would be an implant changing original human limitations.

A free world has the ability to confine, a confined world is never free

Freedom is often seen as the ability to act without constraint. This perception is deeply flawed. For example, consider the case of an ant walking into a trap: the ant follows a scent trail, which represents its innate drive to fulfill its biological imperative, only to be trapped. This is a metaphor for how our desires, driven by innate governance, can lead us into systems of imposed governance that constrain us in the physical world it creates. While we may feel free in the moment, in the end, we are often trapped by the very forces we follow.

Another clear example is a house cat kept indoors. It may act on its desires, yet it would feel far freer chasing a mouse down the street than constantly having to stop every few seconds to avoid a wall.

Freedom is not an absolute state. Rather, it is the point where innate governance and imposed governance align temporarily per individual. The greater the divergence between these two forces, the less freedom is experienced. The equation for freedom can be expressed as follows:

$$\textbf{Freedom} = 1 - \frac{1}{|I_m - I_n|}$$

Freedom: { Freedom ∈ R, 0 < Freedom < ∞ }

Imposed governance: { I_m | I_m ∈ R, 0 < I_m < 1, I_m ≠ I_n }

Innate governance: { I_n | I_n ∈ R, 0 < I_n < 1, I_m ≠ I_n }

This can be seen as a per person, per attribute formula. The vagueness is purposeful, given the complexity of biological beings and consciousness as they appear to us. Imposed governance (I_m) tells you how the external world values an attribute from 0 to 1. Innate governance (I_n) tells you how your internal world values the same attribute from 0 to 1.

For example, let's say a government decides to ban laughter since they see it as a divisive act. People naturally enjoy laughter, even though it may be divisive it can also include people, nonetheless it is a fundamentally human act. In this case, for laughter our I_m factor would be low at 0.1 suppressing our desire for laughter. Let's assume our I_n factor for laughter is 0.9. This gives a freedom score of 0.25, very low on the scale to infinity. On the other hand let's say the government lifts the ban and the overall external governance values I_m at 0.85. This would give a freedom score of 20. Now they incentivize laughter more

giving a new I_m factor of 0.9005. This would give a freedom score of 2000.

It sounds like human freedom is simple, you just have to optimize the freedom equation per human attribute. This thinking is flawed. This turns into the seeing one's eye with one's own eye problem. How do you optimize each trait? How do you even know all human traits? By optimizing one you will almost always diminish another. This is why nature and evolution are so powerful, but humanity tends to believe they are smarter and can take shortcuts. This equation is not meant to optimize humanity, it is only given to illustrate the concept of freedom, which in the modern age is not clearly defined.

The page only listens to those who write

Hegel's dialectic proposes that history progresses toward rationality, which he defines as the ultimate form of freedom. However, this view is flawed because it reflects Hegel's personal innate governance (rationality), not true universal freedom. Intellectuals often project intellectualism onto others, assuming that everyone shares the same goal of rationality as some divine device. Under the likes of Hegel I would guess the I_m score for rationality would be around 0.95 whereas the I_n score may hover around 0.7.

Place a man among distorted mirrors, and he calls himself the original

Human nature is not solely rational, if it were, emotions like love and desire, which often lead to irrational actions, would not exist. Innate governance drives us to act foolishly at times, but this is crucial for human connection and survival. True freedom is not about rationality triumphing over instinct; it's the balance between innate governance and imposed governance. Pure freedom may not even be something you truly want as it may mean the loss of awareness. I would argue Sharks who have allegedly had minimal change in their design over hundreds of millions of years are actually more free than humans.

Marx took Hegel's idea of the dialectic and historical synthesis and applied it to his vision of a classless society. He believed that freedom could be achieved by abolishing class struggle. However, Marx's vision was rejected by innate governance as seen historically. Even if you think it wasn't implemented properly, the implementing itself was rejected. By projecting his intellectual ideals onto human nature, Marx assumed that the removal of class structures would align with our biological instincts. But the conflict between innate governance and imposed governance, with their inherent differences, leads to chaos as the two forces diverge too much. Under Marx the I_{m} factor for labour

motivation might only be 0.1 where the I_n factor may truly be higher at 0.5.

Adam Smith's free market theory assumes that self-interest leads to societal benefit, which is partially true. Free markets work by linking part of innate governance to imposed governance through desire. While markets initially meet basic needs, they gradually stretch and manipulate desire to maximize profit, pushing innate governance away from imposed governance. Essentially, this system pushes innate governance too far, too fast, distorting natural impulses. I would argue for the freedom equation the I_m factor for desire under free markets is 0.9 while the I_n factor is only 0.5. Over time this can pull the I_m factor for something like love from 0.9 to 0.1 with the I_n factor 0.9.

Additionally, the centralization of wealth and information access exacerbates inequality awareness, triggering innate governance's desire for the feeling of fairness (not necessarily equality of outcome). This imbalance will eventually cause the system to crumble, as the gap between the innate and imposed widens, leading to social unrest. I would argue that the I_m factor for a sense of fairness matches I_n at first, but over time slowly fades. For example an I_m factor 0.8 at first matching I_n, but then over time I_m approaches zero while I_n stays the same. For more information please read chapter 6.4.

The relationship between innate governance and imposed governance is often in conflict. This begs the question: why not simply abolish imposed governance and embrace anarchy?

Anarchy, in this chapter defined as the absence of imposed governance, is a paradox when we consider innate governance. While it may seem that eliminating all societal structures would lead to greater freedom, the truth is that innate governance creates a need for imposed governance. For example, without laws, individuals would create their own systems of trade, property, and conflict resolution, which are forms of imposed governance. True anarchy would involve the absence of social structures altogether, but as innate governance requires cooperation for survival and reproduction, such a state would be impossible until needed imposed governance integrates fully into innate governance, which is a long process.

Space travel may promise the expansion of humanity's reach, but it's unlikely to be as liberating as we imagine. We evolved to live on Earth, and no other planet is likely to provide conditions that suit us as well. Colonizing distant worlds could eventually lead to humanity evolving into separate species, especially with the limitations of communication and travel speed, distances that would make contact difficult and evolution even more divergent over time.

Rather than representing a new chapter of freedom, space exploration may reflect the limitations of our current societal structures. The myth of Icarus warns that leaving our home for the heavens doesn't lead to ascension, but rather to isolation and potential downfall.

Since humans naturally seek freedom, this equation suggests that if imposed governance shifts too far from our innate desires, it can lead to a situation where pursuing freedom itself becomes harmful. In extreme cases, such as when imposed governance overpowers innate desires, freedom may shift into something that ultimately leads to the death of the species, not rationality as Hegel suggested. For example, if society pulls too hard on human desires, it could result in an ant trap, a system where the pursuit of freedom leads to self-destruction as the gap between innate and imposed governance becomes too great.

I want to clarify that I am not attaching any moral value to freedom; I am simply attempting to define it. If each individual is resisting imposed governance over time, evolution suggests that, with enough time, we will reach a state of freedom, but at a cost. True freedom would imply a loss of awareness. At some point if the laws of physics allow, innate governance would merge with imposed governance, meaning that thought would no longer be necessary. Evolution would no longer favour consciousness, as it would hinder progress. This presents

another critique of Hegel: why would rationality propagate if the very act of thinking slows you down? It's not thought that leads to success, it's thoughtless action. This may help explain the drive of species to preserve consciousness. There must be an understanding that optimizing for freedom can contradict your current sense of freedom.

From this perspective, consciousness is simply a chaotic, transitional phase for a species. This phase could theoretically be extended, but over time it tends to favour comfort over continuity. This means that any conscious species in our universe is inherently chaotic. In other words, consciousness is chaos, but more specifically, it is controlled chaos. If we want to find consciousness, we need to look for chaos.

We mistake movement for destination

Let us take a Kantian view of the mind and combine it with Darwinism. Humans, in general, are coordinated through a shared biological structure. Each agent interacts with a universal data stream that surrounds it: we see the data stream, hear it, taste it, and feel it. From this input, we act in ways largely programmed toward survival and reproduction, relative to the physical environment in which we were shaped. With this in mind, I will introduce the concept of *Physical Access*:

Physical Access: The amount of physical data an individual's choices can alter within the universal data stream in order to fuel unconscious and conscious desire (Innate Governance). Physical Access can increase through greater personal rationality, access to or creation of tools, charisma, desire extraction, and similar capacities.

So, as a general explanation, one could say that kings attempt to increase their own Physical Access by creating a kingdom. Over time, individuals gain Physical Access as a proxy for the king's effort to expand his own. A king who wants the kingdom to labour must therefore grant a certain increase in Physical Access. He may attempt to hypnotize the kingdom, but he still needs it, and he needs them happy enough to continue: he needs others to reproduce with, and his Physical Access only lasts as long as the hypnotism holds. For his reign to continue with effective human labour, he must grant a minimum level of rationality (Physical Access). Over time, individuals begin to keep one another in line through mutual Physical Access, collapsing kingdoms, giving more Physical Access to the individual. However, this assumes that individuals continue to gain Physical Access through the king's trickle-down desires, an assumption that can become dangerous. It can lead to the belief that because kings appear to be slowly disappearing, the "right future" must be one without any kings at all, with everyone equal in every regard. This treats history as a god simply because it is

'history', like a sailor following the light of a lighthouse at Point Nemo and believing it must indicate livable land.

If you assume that a historical dialectic leads to a heaven, all this really shows is a trail toward a singularity. Depending on the physical limits of the universe or the physical constraints of a system that keeps Physical Access low, freedom is not guaranteed. Physical Access, when allowed, will seek what once kept it alive, albeit with possible variation. If Physical Access can create an environment oriented toward procreation yet removes procreation in favour of pleasure without consequence, the result is extinction.

Historic dialectic also assumes that bottlenecks can't occur, but what happens if Physical Access grows so large for each individual that they begin using it against one another? At that point, the dialectic collapses. Equality can also mean equal access to unsustainable power. There are limits to human rationality within complex systems; we still look at the stars and explain their movement through animals calling it dialectic.

As such, biology itself is not separate from a governance system; it is governance. If you want to design a governance structure with a goal and sustain that goal, you are always in tension with individual biology, innate governance. Forget the individual and how the individual interacts with

your structure, and the system will collapse over time, either through destruction or through a slow loss of consciousness via the absence of procreation or absolute conformity to the environment.

Worship persists only while its value is felt by the many

If you compartmentalize meaning and transform survival into serving others, you're rewiring humanity to pursue a goal that, in its very nature, can undo itself when it might otherwise be unsustainable. Essentially, by converting survival-based meaning, once used to serve the individual, into something that serves others, you open the door for immense potential to benefit the masses. However, this shift also unleashes destructive power that can unravel what was once protected by keeping meaning rooted at the individual level.

Looking further into the future, the prediction becomes more uncertain, as the accuracy of our assumptions about quantifying innate governance degrades. Nevertheless, based on current trends, it seems likely that people will gradually shift governance structures to allow for a closer alignment between innate governance and imposed governance per individual.

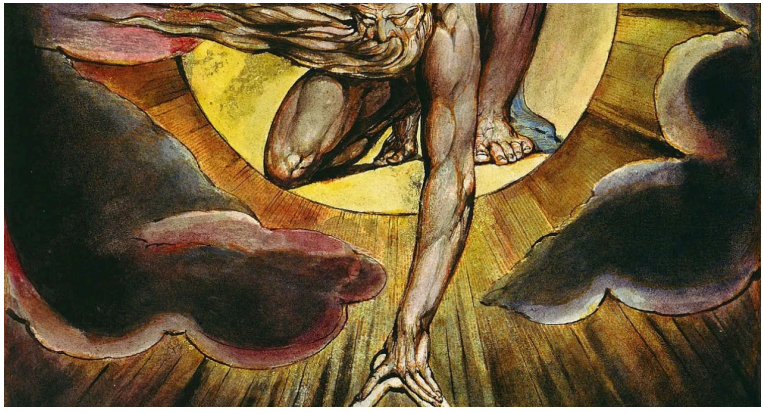
In one case, markets continue to conflict with innate governance, particularly in how it exploits desire, society will eventually reject the structure so long innate

governance doesn't change (implanted intelligence). People do not want to work unnecessarily, and they naturally seek comfort once their basic needs are met. This will likely result in social unrest, with demands for Universal Basic Income (UBI) becoming widespread or other forms of taxation. However, once UBI is introduced, it will soon be realized that UBI is simply another form of taxation as companies increase in size. This will lead to renewed unrest, with people demanding access to the ownership of the centralized entities that control the economy.

Eventually, this may lead to a society in which governance is based on a more equitable distribution of resources, possibly through universal share ownership in companies or organizations. Such a society would be seen as 'fair' from the perspective of innate governance (at least the majority). However, this new system may still infect, leading to a new form of corruption or, in the worst case, to humanity's destruction.

Expanding on Max Stirner: The Limits of Ego

A Critique-Like Expansion on Stirner's Concept of the Spook



Shortly after writing Freedom & Its Illusion Quantified, I began searching for similar ideas in philosophy and came across Max Stirner. While this chapter may read like a critique, from Stirner's perspective, I can only point out that his desire to protect the ego is incomplete and overlooks the physical realities that interact with it. This chapter also introduces the concept of the *physical spook*, something Stirner seems to dismiss.

Following is a summary of Max Stirner's core ideas, not direct quotes from his work:

The Ego (The Unique One): The self, defined by individual will and desire, free from external authorities or ideals.

The Spook: An external idea or ideal (e.g., morality, religion, the state) that has power over the individual by being perceived as a higher truth. Once you recognize it as a spook, it no longer controls you, as you see it for what it is, just an idea, not an objective authority.

Union of Egoists: A temporary, self-interested alliance where individuals come together based on mutual benefit, not shared values or obligations.

When people hear the term 'ego' or encounter someone advocating for egoistic actions, they immediately associate it with selfishness and its negative connotations. However, given that we are all thinking beings interacting with our senses, it's only natural that we each aim to order and shape our own world. This doesn't necessarily mean that altruism, love, or reciprocity are absent; it simply means that when I take an action that feeds my drive, I do it because it benefits me in some way. With that in mind, I'd like to introduce a new distinction.

We are all egoists, but people's actions generally fall into two categories. I emphasize the word *generally* because actions exist on a gradient, and it's nearly impossible for any modern human action to fit perfectly into one of these categories. As Stirner would say, these labels are spooks in themselves.

Local Egoist: A Local Egoist acts solely in their own self-interest, with no drive to benefit others, whether consciously or unconsciously. They are focused on their personal gain in the moment and do not consider the broader impact on other egos. An example is a parasite only harming the ego of the host.

Extended Egoist: An Extended Egoist, while still acting for their own interest, recognizes the interconnectedness of other egos (consciously or unconsciously). Their actions benefit other egos, either directly or indirectly, and their ego rewards them. An example is human love, I am drawn to someone who is also drawn to me.

Now that we've clarified these terms, the initial repulsion that many people feel toward Stirner's philosophy can start to fade. The reason I can't criticize Stirner's core philosophy is that, at the end of the day, he can always fall back on his own ego. To him, everything outside his ego is a spook, including the advocacy for detecting spooks itself. Stirner could easily argue that anything he does is merely him influencing other egos in accordance with his personal philosophy. Essentially, he's stating:

This is my philosophy for my life, do with that what you will

I can approach his ideas using reason, but even that, from his perspective, is a spook imposed on his ego. So, all that's left for me to argue is that his way of living, his approach to

defending his ego, might actually go against his very goal of protecting it.

Stirner seems to dismiss physical realities and their effects on the ego. In doing so, he overlooks how these realities can create the very effects of his spooks that he claims restrict the ego. For example, let's consider the union of egoists. Imagine a society built on a contract, essentially, any modern social structure where the abstractions are honest, and everyone consents. In this society, one group controls all the resources the ego desires. As a result, the social contract no longer benefits Stirner's ego, so he decides to break it and take the resources back. However, he's not strong enough to act, as the group also controls force.

Now Stirner is hungry and must control his ego and thoughts. But if he can control his ego's hunger, why would he have opted out of the contract in the first place? The physical has become mental. Stirner might wave this off as merely a question of power, but if he truly cares about his ego enough to strip down abstractions, he should also seek to strip away the physical realities that his ego is responding to. If Stirner wants to claim that the physical world is just power, then he should also claim that spooks are simply power. If he advocates using force to combat physical power, he should apply the same logic to spooks. If these two elements were symmetrical, rather than stripping away spooks, Stirner would advise people to use

spooks against one another. Stirner carries a rugged, individualistic allure, the rebel, but beneath that persona, he has a heart.

Mental Spook: Can't be escaped, shapes behaviour, demands submission, and diminishes ego autonomy.

Physical Spook: Can't be escaped (since you are alive), shapes behaviour, functionally demands submission, and diminishes ego autonomy.

Now, there's a problem. If you care about the autonomy of the ego over time, you must balance both the Mental Spook and the Physical Spook. This seems to be the very task of governance that Stirner often criticizes. In other words, the constant attempt to strip away spooks may not actually lead to egoistic autonomy. If you believe it does, then that belief itself becomes a spook. A purely free spirit, according to Stirner's definition, would be nothing more than a purely instinctual animal, devoid of reason. However, for that kind of freedom to exist, at some point, spooks might be necessary to deal with the physical.

Put simply:

1. The ego tries to escape Spooks.
2. The ego uses reason to identify Spooks.
3. But reason itself constrains you, meaning you never truly escape confinement.

There is no true opting out as long as you are alive and a spook exists; there is only distance. Here's an example:

My ego may choose to opt out of reason, but the egos around me, who still have access to me, decide not to. These surrounding egos use reason to control my ego, through means like surveillance, manipulation, etc. While my ego may think it's free, it faces the same problem.

The only way your ego can be truly free over time is if the distance between you and external influences is far enough that they no longer impact you. Yet, the average human ego as it stands appears to crave companionship and procreation involving other egos. This also assumes there isn't something we're unaware of, like quantum entanglement, that connects the entire universe in a meaningful way locally.

The rebel who mirrors his world is tied to what he tries to distance himself from

The idea of integrated spooks isn't so much an argument against Stirner, but rather an attempt to move past the rebellious allure. Stirner claims that people are 'possessed' by spooks, but that's not the whole picture. There may be ghosts all around us, but the ego itself is made up of ghosts, only, these ghosts have transformed into instinct.

Assuming Darwinism, consider this example: Let's say in Japan there was a spook that claimed small faces were divine. As a result, people with smaller faces received better social treatment, which in turn helped them procreate. Since the spook takes time to process in the mind before being acted upon, the people who are naturally attracted to small faces would propagate faster, until a large portion of the population is attracted to small faces, even without the spook. The spook has integrated.

By following the ego, you're not necessarily avoiding behaviours shaped by spooks. You're simply responding to current social reinforcements. In fact, you're even more susceptible to the spooks of your ancestors. Perhaps these ingrained behaviours serve you better because they've been tested by evolution, but that doesn't make you any less influenced by other egos.

Stripped down to what Stirner can consistently say under his own philosophy, it is this:

My ego taps into the abstraction known as reason to show other egos that abstractions can control you

He can't say anything beyond this without falling into the 'opt-in, opt-out' problem or creating a spook that contradicts his own ego. He also can't speak for the ego as a whole, since the ego is always interacting with the physical world. Furthermore, he can't claim that spooks are inherently bad, as this would be using morality, which, by his definition, is itself a spook.

Even when stripped to its core, Stirner still offers a useful tool for recognizing abstractions that control one's desires. Let's take Nihilism as an example. At its core, Nihilism asserts:

Life has no inherent meaning or value

But to judge life meaningless already presupposes a sense of meaning or value. Recognizing meaninglessness doesn't create meaning by itself, but it reveals the standards by which we judge. Because consciousness is rooted in evolved instincts, our capacity for meaning-making is biologically grounded, even if the meanings we pursue go far beyond instinct. This is something Stirner would likely agree with. A nihilist might then argue:

The universe has no meaning; the universe is uncaring

But we are not separate from the universe; we are the universe. If we have meaning, then the universe has meaning. The universe is not uncaring as long as we care. If you believe the universe has no care, you might simply be too distant from its care. If you want the universe to care, then care. The act of believing the universe has no care creates the exact universe you believe in.

I propose a question: if God descended before you and said that life does have a purpose, but that your role within it is to live an unfulfilled life, waiting in suffering for a greater purpose that will arise long after you are gone, and whose rewards you will never experience, would you truly listen, or would you call God a charlatan? That wouldn't be a lack of meaning, but a misalignment with your instincts. Then this hypothetical God says that if you reject this purpose, you will go to hell, another appeal to instinct, this time through fear. If you desired hell, the threat would hold no power at all.

Now, using Stirner's concept of the mental spook, we can see how belief in Nihilism can harm the ego. A person who believes in Nihilism might be trapping themselves. Recognizing it as a spook could free the ego, allowing it to act in ways that serve its long-term desires.

Stirner is also valuable in challenging those who claim to be freeing the individual from one spook, only to replace it

with another. For example, while there has been a recent surge in people embracing religion, many still criticize it while continuing to worship the dollar. They live in a constant state of hunger, chasing an abstraction they perceive as reality, yet they mock others for believing in a god. From Stirner's perspective, they are merely swapping one abstraction for another. Yes, money may be essential as a societal glue to prevent chaos, enabling societies to scale, but it's still just another abstraction with trade-offs. One could argue that one spook might statistically allow the average ego to flourish more than another (if that can even be measured practically), but it's misleading to claim that people are being entirely freed. The moment you call something freedom, people will chase it, yet it can never exist. Freedom is a concept of reason, yet reason must end in order to reach it. Freedom is a spook.

The Nishidan Spook: Authority After the Ego

Max Striner: One Level Deeper



In this chapter, I revisit the last, Expanding on Max Stirner: The Limits of Ego. Through Kitarō Nishida, I argue that Stirner's philosophy is ultimately incomplete. Building on my previous claim that full egoistic autonomy does not automatically entail full egoistic benefit, this chapter pushes The Spook one level deeper by examining Nishida's analysis of what claims to be Being in totality. Here, I introduce the concept of the *Nishidan Spook*, a next-stage critique of Stirner that holds Stirner's own ego-centered philosophy to be an illusion in itself.

Experience is primary, before there is a subject who thinks or an object that is thought about, there is the occurring of experience itself. The ego arises within this field as a later differentiation, useful, real, and operative, but not foundational. What appears first is not an 'I' confronting a world, but an undivided field of experience in which seeing, hearing, acting, and feeling occur without

ownership. Only afterward does reflection draw a boundary, identifying a center ('self'), an object, and a relation between them. The individual does not first recognize a self and then perceive; rather, perception happens first, and the self is named after the fact as a way of organizing and stabilizing what has already appeared.

When the ego is treated as the center, a derivative distinction is mistaken for the ground, freezing a fluid process into a substance. This move subtly reorganizes reality around ownership and installs a hidden metaphysics even when all external authorities have been rejected. At a deeper level, being itself can be hijacked in the same way: any partial articulation, ego, subject, reason, history, even 'being' or 'nothingness', becomes illusory the moment it claims to be Being in totality. For Nishida, being appears and differentiates, but it can't be finished, owned, or closed without distortion.

As a result, Stirner operates within the very illusion he seeks to expose, controlled in the same manner he condemns, as I argued in the previous chapter. The ego comes to rule him as a form of 'being' itself. In following the ego, he remains bound to abstraction, to an abstracted notion of 'being'.

Stirner runs into trouble once the ego becomes explicitly known and argued for as the center: by becoming aware of

the ego and defending it, he treats it as something that should be followed, turning it into a ground. Even if he denies morality, this installs a hidden 'ought' and elevates the ego into an abstraction. By contrast, an implicit ego, acting, desiring, responding without being named or justified, still operates, but it is not worshipped. Nishida's point is that ego-action is not the problem; ego-as-conscious center is.

Nishidan Spook: Any abstraction that does not merely dominate thought (as in Stirner), but reorganizes *experience itself* by masquerading as the ground of being.

Stirner asks: *What rules over me?*

Nishida asks: *What claims to be the ground at all?*

Where the Stirnerian Spook seeks to preserve the ego, the Nishidan Spook seeks to preserve being itself.

Stirnerian Spook: Rejects the State, morality as obligation, God, Humanity, Truth as authority, law, duty, and any ideal or abstraction that claims authority over the individual and demands obedience; Stirner's criterion is whether an idea rules the ego, and his demolition stops where self-ownership is affirmed.

Nishidan Spook: Rejects the ego as ground, the subject as origin, Being or Nothingness when reified, reason as

ontology, history or progress as destiny, God as object or system, and any final metaphysical claim that pretends to totalize reality; Nishida's criterion is whether a claim presents itself as reality itself rather than as a provisional appearance within it.

Let us turn to Albert Camus and the idea of the absurd. Camus describes the absurd as a lived tension between the human demand for meaning and the world's silence. It is not a metaphysical truth about reality itself, but a condition of experience. His response is one of lucid revolt, to continue living, creating, and acting without appealing to false consolations or final answers. For Camus, this means confronting life's absurdity directly and refusing to anesthetize it with hope, transcendence, or metaphysical meaning. The pain and tension are not problems to be solved but conditions to be endured consciously. By staying lucid and resisting escape, one transforms suffering into intensity, finding freedom and dignity in living fully despite, and alongside, the absurd.

Stirner, however, would immediately reject any rule or obligation derived from this diagnosis the moment it claims authority over the individual. For Stirner, absurdity, revolt, acceptance, or indifference are all legitimate only insofar as they serve the ego's own interest; the instant they harden into a 'must', they become a Stirnerian Spook.

Nishida would press the critique even further. He would warn that absurdity itself becomes a Nishidan Spook when it is treated as a total account of reality or as a foundational principle for how one ought to live. The absurd is real as an appearance within experience, but it becomes illusory the moment it claims to be Being itself. If someone treats absurdity as Being itself, they turn a lived tension into a ruling ground, so life gets filtered through a fixed idea ("everything is absurd") rather than met as it unfolds. Action becomes loyalty to an idea of absurdity instead of responsiveness to what is actually happening.

The Emonian Spook: The Illusion That Ends Illusion

Max Stirner: The Last Layer



In this chapter, I expand further on earlier chapters Expanding on Max Stirner: The Limits of Ego and its subsequent extension The Nishidan Spook: Authority After the Ego. While Nishida successfully pushes Stirner's critique one level deeper by dissolving the ego as ground, I argue that Nishida's philosophy remains incomplete. Building on my previous claim that dissolving the ego does not automatically dissolve grounding itself, this chapter pushes the critique to its final level by examining both Stirner and Nishida through the work of Andrea Emo. Here, I introduce the concept of the *Emonian Spook*, a final-stage critique that reveals how even exposure, negation, and philosophical insight can themselves become illusory. The Emonian Spook marks the terminal limit of philosophical dissection.

Andrea Emo begins where Nishida stops. For Emo, the fundamental illusion is not the ego, nor Being, nor

Nothingness, but the belief that philosophical exposure itself escapes illusion. The moment thought claims to reveal, negate, or dissolve reality, it installs itself as authoritative.

Negation does not uncover a deeper structure. Insight does not occupy a privileged position. Even the recognition that "nothing can be grounded" becomes an assertion the moment it is trusted.

Where Nishida treats negation as a dynamic of reality, Emo treats negation as already compromised. The act of revealing is never outside the illusion it claims to expose. From an Emonian perspective, both Stirner and Nishida remain bound by a deeper illusion.

Stirner assumes that seeing the spook is useful, that exposure liberates. But this already presumes that recognition occupies a position of escape. The moment demystification is trusted as freedom, it becomes authoritative. Stirner's final faith is not merely in the ego, but in exposure as exit.

Nishida dissolves the ego as ground, but preserves a deeper confidence: that self-negation can be meaningfully described without reinstating authority. Absolute nothingness, though non-substantial, still functions as an explanatory field. Insight remains genuine, even if non-final.

From Emo's standpoint, this is already too much. Nishida replaces ego-grounding with negation-grounding, preserving philosophy's right to speak about what remains. Both thinkers differ in depth, but share the same structural error: they assume that exposure itself is not implicated.

Emonian Spook: The belief that *exposure itself* escapes illusion, that by revealing contradiction, negation, or groundlessness, thought has achieved a privileged position outside what it criticizes.

The Emonian Spook convinces the thinker that nothing remains, while granting authority to that conclusion.

Stirner asks: *What rules over me?*

Nishida asks: *What claims to be the ground at all?*

Emo asks: *What allows this questioning itself to claim authority?*

Person A says:

Recognizing that there is no final truth frees us from illusion

This is an Emonian Spook because it treats recognition itself as an escape, granting authority to the insight that supposedly dissolves all authority.

Person B says:

This thought occurs and has no right to last

This is not an Emonian Spook because it makes no claim to privilege, freedom, or finality, and does not trust itself to stand outside what it describes.

Stirner claims the ego should rule as a hidden 'ought'. Nishida shows that experience occurs prior to the ego, so treating the ego as ruler is already a misidentification. Emo goes further and shows that even diagnosing misidentification presumes a position of escape, so the very act of questioning control reinstates it.

The Emonian Spook can't be exposed without reappearing. To name it is already to trust naming. To reject it is to trust rejection. To accept it is to stabilize it. There is no deeper abstraction to unmask because abstraction itself has been unmasked. There is no quieter authority to reveal because authority now operates as the absence of authority. Below this point, philosophy does not deepen. It collapses.

2

The Unattainable System

A Critique & Expansion of Friedrich Nietzsche

Attainable Singularities: What We Sustain in Worship, We Become



The fear of 'Nihilism' and the death of God is clearly evident in modern times. However, like many philosophers throughout history, while their diagnoses may be sound, their proposed solutions for moving forward are often deeply flawed. This chapter aims to critique Nietzsche's ideas and present a broader theory explaining why human traits, particularly those embodied in religion, remain effective under certain constraints. It also introduces a newly coined (to my knowledge) concept of Unattainable Systems and Attainable Singularity, a system designed to channel meaning into a balanced, sustainable environment for conscious beings.

Passive Nihilism: A weary resignation to the collapse of traditional values. It shows up as apathy, pessimism, or a longing for comfort, stability, or nothingness once life is judged to lack meaning. Instead of responding creatively, the passive nihilist retreats, weakens, or numbs themselves.

Active Nihilism: A forceful response to the same collapse of values. Rather than lamenting the loss of meaning, it destroys obsolete morals and ideals as a necessary clearing-out. This destruction is preparatory, it makes space for the creation of new values rooted in strength and life-affirmation.

Nietzsche doesn't fully elaborate on what Nihilism specifically is at its core, although his diagnosis is as accurate as rationality allows in its simplification. I want to dive deeper into this. Nihilism is essentially a mental construct, not rooted in reality, we create our own meaning (for more information please reread the chapter, Expanding on Max Stirner: The Limits of Ego - 1.2). Creating our own meaning strips everyone down to their ego, and their ego alone.

Strict Nihilism, on its own, is relatively harmless, as it diminishes drive (Passive Nihilism). It's like saying, "I'm hungry, but even that doesn't matter". Active Nihilism, however, is different, and, as Nietzsche points out, this is where the risk lies. Active Nihilism essentially sees meaning for what it is and, in doing so, allows the individual to create anything they want to serve their own ego. An ego, in and of itself, isn't inherently harmful. My ego can desire mutual love, shared benefit, and so on. The problem arises when, in a world full of other egos, one assumes that its best interest lies in being a local egoist, as I define in

chapter 1.2. Momentary survival instincts can lead to the destruction of others' egos for one's own benefit, without fully considering the long-term consequences of such actions from future egos. However, my argument is that Nietzsche inadvertently creates the very moral framework he considers dangerous. By failing to fully strip Nihilism down to its core, he leaves room for himself to act on Active Nihilism. From Max Stirner's perspective, he essentially creates a new 'spook'.

What we sustain in worship, we become

Übermensch: An 'ideal' person who creates their own values instead of following society's rules or traditional religion. They take responsibility for giving their life meaning and fully embrace life, including struggle and hardship. It represents personal growth and self-overcoming, not physical superiority.

Will to Power: Nietzsche's 'will to power' is the idea that the driving force in life isn't survival or reproduction, but a fundamental desire to assert and enhance one's own strength, creativity, and influence. It's about striving to shape and control your own life and environment, rather than simply reacting to it. The will to power is the energy behind all human actions, from the pursuit of knowledge to artistic expression.

Nietzsche effectively imposes a moral framework onto people, claiming that the Übermensch is the ideal. While Nietzsche's words were twisted throughout history, particularly during World War II, it's clear how the worship of any ideal can lead to situations that humanity ultimately must reject, resulting in unnecessary suffering. If you worship the idea of power, you will create power. Physical power is easy to observe, but other forms of worship can be much more insidious in how quietly they spread.

From what it sounds like, Nietzsche's fixation on strength and power likely stemmed from what he believed he himself lacked. But what he thinks he lacks isn't the same as what everyone else may lack. I'm not arguing that the will to power isn't a fundamental force of meaning, nor am I claiming that it is. My criticism here specifically targets the worship of a single human trait.

The powerful are loved when usable, resented when unreachable

At the most fundamental level, we can divide existence into the mind and the external world. Through the mind's interaction with the physical, our appendages, our words, our tools, we are able to mold the world around us. It is easy to see why control over the external world (power) is valuable for achieving aims, yet power alone is meaningless

without aims to direct it toward. In Beauty and the Beast, Beauty falls in love with taming the Beast, a being who possesses immense power over the external world, but her desire is not power for its own sake. Her goals are already grounded in something deeper, stability, connection, and offspring success. She does not seek the weapon merely to possess it, but to orient it toward an end. Likewise, I do not seek complete power; I seek only enough power to fulfill a goal.

Every philosophy conceals an imperative

To worship power for its own sake is to forget its purpose. Even if Nietzsche sought to direct humanity's desire for power toward activities like art—something he himself conveniently enjoyed and used power to will into the world through his philosophy—power still remains at the center, ultimately controlling those who wield it. Not all ends only benefit the wielder. Love is power, kindness is power, 'slave morality' is power, and 'master morality' is power. But if all things are forms of power, then power itself ceases to matter apart from the ends toward which it is directed. Why worship power for its own sake when aims are all that truly remain? Nietzsche, then, is not escaping morality so much as redirecting it, convincing people where power ought to be aimed, much like religion before him. In this sense, he is a preacher no less than any other philosopher.

You might think observation isn't power, but tell that to the man thrown off a sinking ship for taking up too much weight. To exist is to occupy space in the physical world, and if another observer resents that space, your mere presence becomes something they seek to remove, meaning your existence already exerts a kind of power simply by being contestable.

Nietzsche seems to overlook the physical structures that shape the individual's life. Imagine a fishbowl containing a colony of fish: the bowl is unusual, its water shifts in temperature, sometimes warming slowly toward extinction, while pseudo-random currents constantly displace the fish. Much of Nietzsche's philosophy appears to tell the fish how to swim within this unstable environment, yet the colony adapts regardless. So the question becomes: why focus on telling the fish how to move, when it may be more effective to stabilize the bowl itself? Why strip morality if it provides orientation and purpose? Why fixate on frameworks that offer no lasting grounding?

It may make more sense to design a bowl that maintains enough tension for the fish to recognize it is a constructed environment, something they inhabit and can influence, rather than something that fully controls them. Within that awareness, morality and even useful 'illusions' can emerge and flourish. People could understand the game

they are embedded in while still choosing to play it. This may sound like playing god, but arguably we are already inside a system that plays us; the question is whether we acknowledge and shape its conditions, rather than pretend we are only free within it calling it nature. Otherwise, how would the unconscious or irrational find anything to grasp onto?

A drive severed from completion spirals

I am not claiming Nietzsche would entirely deny this distinction, yet his philosophy often elevates power itself into a state of worship. As humanity gains increasing control over the world, we begin feeding drives that no longer possess natural conclusions. The man seeking procreation can pursue sex endlessly once contraception transforms reproduction into a choice rather than an outcome. The man driven by wealth endlessly accumulates money as a form of optimized power supposedly meant for his offspring, yet sacrifices the time required to actually raise them. More and more, we sever desires from their previous ends, and in doing so, we risk creating a state of endless pursuit that collapses into meaninglessness.

Morals that free can later bind

Reason battling against ingrained morality. The cockroach and the dog remain morally distinct in our eyes, yet both are living beings. Reason battling against sexual dynamics

built on mutual games, until the game itself collapses and no one plays at all. We are being pulled apart every day slowly and less noticeably. Reason is worshipped, so it must never harm. Humanity is worshipped, so the individual can never be forgotten. Two men water each other's flowers, forgetting why they began watering at all, trapped in finding purpose only through serving the other. This is the Übermensch.

Optimization intensifies desire by removing what resolves it

A wife seeks resources and safety, but no longer for her offspring, for herself. A man opens a dating app not to find a partner, but to keep his desire stimulated for as long as possible. People no longer argue to reach resolution, but to sustain the argument itself. Instincts are turning inward, feeding on themselves. We listen to music stripped of the community behind it, its joy missing the very thing that once gave it closure. A song stirs nostalgia for a community that never truly existed. This is the consequence of creating one's own values; this is the Übermensch. But how can I create new values when even the act of creating values emerges from values that came before?

If human order is severed from innate human instinct, yet still desired, it must eventually be transferred to systems or heightened reason. But without the need to think, struggle, or rely on baseline instincts, little remains. One either

creates new instincts derived from the old or strips them away entirely. We often imagine the mind as separate from its environment, yet it is shaped by that environment and, in turn, becomes it. We rarely think about the environment itself, because to fully perceive it is, in a sense, to step outside it; the environment ceases to feel like a surrounding and instead becomes life itself. Once aware, we all want to live.

If we must worship, only self-worship preserves the self

This leads to the development of a general theory:

A conscious being's extinction rate is directly influenced by the range of essential evolutionary traits it attaches meaning to, relative to its environment

I believe this theory can help explain a successful aspect of polytheism. Each god represents a different aspect of human nature, and by worshipping them, you are essentially worshipping different facets of yourself. Constant self-worship, through the lens of these gods, helps you avoid straying too far from your environment. This isn't limited to just the 'positive' emotions, it's everything, as all aspects of human nature are potentially essential. Traits that are no longer evolutionarily necessary may be neglected, and, over time, this could theoretically lead to their gradual elimination. I am not suggesting

people use rationality to pick and choose what is eliminated.

Monotheism, in theory, could function in a similar way, but it would need to somehow encompass the full spectrum of human nature. The issue with monotheism in this context is that by focusing worship on a single identity or figure, you risk hyper-focusing on that individual's core characteristic. For instance, in Christianity, if the Bible were entirely overlooked except for one prophet preaching a single lesson, this could skew the broader representation of the general momentary human nature you are preserving.

The long road demands no arrival

Unattainable System: A closed governance structure for conscious beings that channels individual meaning into an evolutionarily balanced system, fitting for a consistent environment. An Unattainable System doesn't need to encompass all of the evolutionary features of current conscious beings; it simply can't achieve an Attainable Singularity. Unattainable Systems are a tool for longevity and longevity alone.

Attainable Singularity: A point within a governance system for conscious beings where one or more incentives, if fully realized, drive the species toward extinction. It's a cycle where a shift in the mental environment of a conscious being takes them further and further from their physical environment, leading either to the death of consciousness or the species itself. If a system has an Attainable Singularity, it isn't compatible with being an Unattainable System.

As such, a system is only compatible with being Unattainable-Compatible if it is, in fact, an Unattainable System. You may wonder why I chose this name. It's not because such a system is necessarily impossible in the general sense, but rather to remind anyone who attempts to create one of the inherent difficulty involved. A quick glance through history reveals how many have tried to design systems that, due to poor coordination, ultimately led to the deaths of millions. The goal of the design is to sustain a conscious species. To achieve that, the system must never aim for an 'end'. An Unattainable System is inherently imperfect, and that imperfection is by design.

Reason binds reality to its focus

Philosophers often sought to optimize society according to a single vision of the individual, usually the aspect they valued most: reason, pure will, equality, comfort, love,

‘freedom‘, or ‘humanity’. An Unattainable System does not attempt to perfect the individual along one axis. It attempts to recreate the forest itself, the living totality from which individuals emerge.

We often copy the dance, not the music that moves it

This does not mean reason, pure will, equality, comfort, love, ‘freedom’, or ‘humanity’ are ignored, only that they are not enthroned at the center. Worship reason and the forest becomes a construction site; worship pure will and it turns into a battleground; worship equality and the forest stands still while its inhabitants lose coordination; worship love and you must also love what ends love; worship ‘freedom’ and the forest dissolves into illusion; worship ‘humanity’ and the inhabitants merge with the forest itself, the individual forgotten.

The forest is balance. The lion is shaped by it, however much he imagines himself king, he depends on his own limits, on his inability to devour every zebra, and on the zebra’s strength as a counterforce. He survives not through domination alone, but through tension held within bounds. Power over the external world doesn’t always prevail. The lion that devours the entire herd ends up starving, watching those whose instincts restrained their hunger endure. All the while, the starving lion still admires the strongest. This is Nietzsche’s paradox: the admiration

of strength becomes its own form of 'slave morality', blind to the effectiveness and strength of restraint. The strong 'slave' overturns Nietzsche's philosophy.

Every guard marks the wound it hides

You want strength, yet the very desire for it reveals weakness. We are all vulnerable to our desires and instincts, so why glorify the act of creating new ones, when they already arise unbidden from within? A recursive emptiness masquerading as meaning. To crave what we lack is to admit its power over us. Even if you conquer that desire, you've only proven how deeply it once held you. And yet, Nietzsche calls this strength.

You might argue that an Unattainable System still optimizes for something, longevity. Yes. I am not concealing that. It is a tool for longevity and longevity alone. But endurance is not the same as moral goodness. A system can persist by channeling all meaning through hunger, scarcity, or pressure; its survival does not make it humane, nor does it make life within it desirable. Other systems that optimize for specific traits may create more immediately enjoyable conditions, but I don't believe they endure. If what you prefer is continued instability or believe that is all that is practical, then choose a different tool.

Born of chaos, consciousness feasts, and dies in the order it imposes

You might think that optimized comfortability gets us somewhere, and it does, not being conscious. The very act of seeking comfort creates a physical environment that aligns with our desires, ultimately reaching a point where consciousness is no longer needed, resulting in an Attainable Singularity.

A fire survives its usefulness when its smoke is prized

Derived from the later chapter 4.1, A Critique of Stoic Culture: Personal Discipline Turned Social Regulation, Nietzsche's conception of channeling the will to power can give rise to a Guiding Agent.

Guiding Agents: Forms of cultural worship used by an Attainable System to guide individuals toward an Attainable Singularity. What is worshipped can be rational, irrational, or even truth itself; it simply needs to have a sustained cultural impact that helps governed individuals move toward this singularity.

The mind goes where the body can't

By attempting to channel the will to power toward ideals such as 'self-improvement', and away from direct expressions of verbal or physical dominance, a divide

emerges. When people are discouraged from seeking meaning through tangible power in the external world and instead directed toward philosophy, art, or inward cultivation, a separate class inevitably remains that continues to pursue power materially and politically, because such power is still necessary within existing systems of governance and social organization. In this sense, Nietzsche offers consolation to those excluded from meaningful influence over the physical world. His philosophy can therefore be interpreted as a form of 'slave morality' of its own: a framework that allows individuals to experience a sense of power through inward retreat and intellectual self-construction when real external power is inaccessible. I attribute much of his recent admiration to this dynamic.

Power denied a throne makes thrones of stools

What appears to be a stronger solution is not to redirect the will to power exclusively toward inward or mental pursuits, but to construct social contracts and institutions that allow the will to power to operate within environments more aligned with those in which it originally developed. This would mean preserving meaningful avenues for the pursuit of land, artistic achievement, influence, status, and other forms of tangible power acquisition. The aim would be a social structure that permits individually expressed will to power while

simultaneously imposing limits that prevent any single expression of power from destabilizing or corrupting the broader system.

Please refer to the later chapter, The Divergence of Human Nature & Governance Decay - 6.4 - for a deeper explanation. What's particularly fascinating about free markets is that they begin with the individual and channel meaning in a way that benefits others. I'm only concerned with myself and extensions of myself (such as, my family). By participating in the system, by attributing meaning to it, I am rewarded by providing 'value' (fulfilling desire) to others. This allows people to attach meaning (pseudo self created meaning) to the system without much thought, which would be fine in theory if it were an Unattainable System. However, it has Attainable Singularities.

Incentivizing desire while allowing wealth to centralize creates an Attainable Singularity. If this process continues unchecked, you end up with desiring beings rather than thinking beings. You might think the government can fix this, but over time, the government can only go so far into debt before the population has to bear the cost of wealth centralization. If followed through, you either get cyclical chaos or extinction, both outcomes are typically undesirable for humans. Another Attainable Singularity occurs when you have a system optimizing for desire, but still needing the desiring population to do labour.

If an Unattainable-Compatible system were to be found, it should be easy to explain why we follow it to future generations, giving people a clear understanding of what's happening and why. It should also provide explanations for why things feel 'off'. Yes, you are still forcing people into a system, but as I outline in chapter 1.2, there's no such thing as 'opting in or opting out'. The best you can do is create a clearly defined system that is easily explainable. Essentially, here are the rules, this is why we follow them, and the goal is longevity (or whatever else), if you don't want that, sorry. If the majority doesn't like it, they can change it.

I imagine the system would be decentralized, but even that may not be true. As long as corruption is provably minimized and power shifts hands quickly enough, you can still have power. Power becomes an Attainable Singularity only when it compounds. Corruption is assumed to be the following general formula and not limited to power:

$$\textbf{Corruption} \approx (\textbf{selection bias} \times \textbf{opacity})^{\textbf{time}}$$

Selection bias doesn't come only from individuals (in the absolute sense), but from the hidden hand (abstractions) of governance as well.

Strip away imposed meaning, and the ego rules until meaning returns

If you believe pure ego can sustain a sense of harmony over time, then meaning may not be necessary. However, I would argue that once that point is reached, consciousness itself fades away, an Attainable Singularity. By harmony, I mean, for the individual, do they benefit over time from the social contract? The general idea is that, if we must worship, it is only sustainable to worship ourselves. I am not suggesting that we regard ourselves or our systems as anything special. I am pointing instead to where our individual meaning is directed, how it channels itself into creating a sustainable environment in which that meaning can persist.

Take family as an example of meaning. A man has children, a wife, a family he loves. He wants to live; he is not afraid of a meaningful life. He binds his meaning to his family. To preserve that meaning, structures must exist such that the physical environment does not prevent it from propagating. Yet our current social structures are slowly erasing this kind of meaning. From what it seems, family remains one of the few sources of human meaning without end. The currency of the future, I imagine, will be precisely this, if it already hasn't been: what I define as Continuant Meaning.

Continuant Meaning: Meaning that persists over time by sustaining itself through ongoing relationships, structures, or processes, rather than being exhausted in a single moment of satisfaction. It does not question itself but simply acts; to regret it would be to regret one's being as a whole. It is meaning that no amount of reason can take away.

Keep in mind, how meaning is attached can also create an Attainable Singularity. Ideally you would have individuals attach meaning outside of any social system; however, in such a system, you would give the eager an outlet that doesn't undo itself.

3

Ethics

G. E. Moore & the Optimization of Ethics

Bounded Moral Relativism: Morals that free can later bind



This chapter begins with G. E. Moore and his resistance to ethical reduction, but rather than defending moral realism, it treats Moore as a stopping point that reveals a deeper structural problem. If the good can't be reduced, optimized, or grounded in reason, then what exactly are ethical systems doing?

I argue that morality is best understood as a biologically constrained social illusion: a necessary abstraction that coordinates behaviour, generates meaning, and sustains societies, but one that can't be justified without misunderstanding its own function. From this perspective, the history of ethics appears less as a search for moral truth and more as a series of reinforcement strategies responding to morality's need for certainty.

This chapter proposes a framework of *bounded moral relativism*, explains why philosophers are structurally

compelled to mistake necessity for truth, integrates Hans Vaihinger's notion of useful illusion, examines how rationality corrodes the very illusions it depends on, and traces how religion, rational ethics, and even Friedrich Nietzsche's attempt to abolish morality reproduce moral structure. The analysis culminates in the idea of the Unattainable System and ends by grounding sustainability in family as a pre-rational anchor of meaning.

G. E. Moore's central contribution is often summarized as a technical objection to ethical naturalism, but its implications are far broader. By insisting that 'good' can't be reduced to pleasure, survival, desire, or any empirical property, Moore blocks every attempt to treat ethics as an optimization problem. No matter how sophisticated the calculus, one can always ask whether the optimized outcome is actually good.

What Moore exposes is not simply a logical flaw but a structural limit. Ethical systems repeatedly attempt to ground morality in something stable, nature, reason, utility, biology, because morality must feel stable in order to function. Moore's critique interrupts this process without offering a replacement foundation. What remains unexplained is why humans continue to demand foundations even after every foundation fails. Moore implicitly reveals that ethical systems may not exist to describe reality at all. They exist to stabilize behaviour.

Pure moral relativism fails not because it permits moral diversity, but because it reduces morality to conscious construction while ignoring its instinctual foundation. Moral responses arise first as bodily reactions, aversion, care, restraint, before they are articulated as beliefs. When morality is treated as entirely relative, these signals are no longer interpreted as constraints but as raw material for reinterpretation. This allows individuals to consciously justify actions, such as murder, despite an initial bodily refusal, effectively overriding instinct through narrative. What results is not the absence of morality but the creation of new moral structures that rationalize behaviour by suppressing or re-framing unconscious resistance. Rather than dissolving morality, radical relativism forces it upward into conscious ideology, a dynamic I explore further in chapter 4.3.

The framework proposed here begins with the claim that what humans call 'good' is neither an objective feature of the universe nor an arbitrary cultural invention. It is an emergent phenomenon produced by biological instincts, social abstractions, and individual perception interacting under selection pressure.

Morality is therefore relative, but not unconstrained. Its constraints are biological rather than metaphysical. Moral systems that fail to regulate behaviour collapse. Moral systems that regulate behaviour persist. Persistence,

however, does not confer truth, only endurance. Under this view, morality does not justify itself. It explains itself. This gives rise to *The Dark Knight* quote:

You either die a hero, or you live long enough to see yourself become the villain

If moral systems require certainty to bind egos together, then the human drive to justify morality is not surprising. Certainty strengthens coordination. Doubt weakens it. Philosophers across history repeatedly mistake this functional necessity for epistemic evidence.

Attempts to ground ethics in reason, God, nature, pleasure, or justice are not discoveries of moral truth but stabilizing narratives that protect moral authority from erosion. Ethical philosophy becomes a second-order reinforcement mechanism that rationalizes what must already feel unquestionable.

From within bounded moral relativism, philosophers are not wrong because they choose the wrong foundation. They are mistaken because they assume morality needs a foundation at all.

This diagnosis aligns closely with Hans Vaihinger's philosophy of 'as-if'. Vaihinger argued that humans routinely operate using fictions they know to be false,

because those fictions are indispensable for action. The truth of a concept is less important than its usefulness.

Moral systems function precisely this way. They operate 'as if' values are objective, obligations are universal, and norms are binding in themselves. Their effectiveness depends on this illusion, not on metaphysical correctness. Morality does not collapse when it is untrue; it collapses when it is ineffective.

The paradox is that rationality, which helps build moral systems, also undermines them. Once an illusion is fully exposed, it no longer binds with the same force. Rational critique dissolves certainty, and certainty is what morality requires to function at peak performance.

Modern societies experience this as meaning erosion, ethical fragmentation, and endless moral debate without resolution. Rationality excels at dismantling illusions but can't replace what it destroys. A fully rational system is procedurally dense but motivationally thin.

This explains why systems that attempt to eliminate illusion entirely tend toward apathy, instability, or coercion.

Religion historically insulated morality from rational scrutiny by anchoring it in the divine. When rationality displaced God, morality did not disappear; it was

rationalized. Duty, autonomy, progress, and justice replaced divine command as moral absolutes.

Friedrich Nietzsche recognized this substitution and attempted to abolish morality by exposing it as illusion. Yet his project did not eliminate moral structure. Concepts like value creation, self-overcoming, and the will to power function normatively. Nietzsche removed inherited morality only to recreate morality under another name. This reinforces the framework's central claim: attempts to escape morality reproduce it so long as they continue to generate meaning, obligation, and direction.

Following Slavoj Žižek, ethical history can be seen as a series of repeating cycles:

1. moral absolutism intensifies
2. contradiction and excess emerge
3. disillusionment sets in
4. meaning collapses
5. morality reasserts itself under a new justification

Some systems escape collapse by abandoning meaning and becoming purely procedural. These systems may persist, but they hollow out the human experience.

What I refer to as the Unattainable System is not a claim about an achieved or guaranteed form of governance, but a theoretical orientation. It describes a system that does not rely on claims of moral truth, does not attempt to eliminate illusion, and does not deny the need for meaning, while attempting to translate existing human meaning into long-term structural sustainability without promising final justification. Such a system can't be completed or stabilized once and for all. There is no assurance it would function as intended in practice; it can only ever be approximated, and any approximation remains contingent and revisable.

The Unattainable System does not require a specific source of meaning. In principle, any sufficiently durable anchor could serve this role. The problem it attempts to address is not moral failure, but cyclical collapse under sustained rational scrutiny, of the kind described by Žižek, where systems oscillate between ideological certainty and disillusionment. If rationality continues to be valued and applied reflexively, then any system whose cohesion depends primarily on abstract narratives becomes increasingly vulnerable over time.

Within this context, family can be understood as a promising candidate anchor. Family grounds meaning in biological relations rather than in abstraction. It extends time horizons beyond the individual, introduces asymmetrical responsibility, and generates commitment

that does not depend on belief in institutional narratives or theoretical justification. Importantly, this makes family relatively resistant to rational erosion. Awareness that a social system is constructed does not dissolve parental attachment. A parent does not stop caring because care is understood as contingent, evolved, or historically shaped. In this case, the object of meaning exists independently of the abstraction that organizes social coordination around it.

If rationality is required to maintain large-scale systems, and rationality is also capable of undermining the narratives that once stabilized them, then systems that rely exclusively on abstract cohesion are structurally fragile. Over time, rational critique weakens the binding force of shared stories. Anchors that operate at a pre-rational or extra-rational level are less susceptible to this process, not because they are immune to reflection, but because their motivating force does not originate in justification.

Under these conditions, a framework in which social structures are openly acknowledged as tools rather than truths becomes more plausible. Such a framework does not require moral authority, sacred governance, or claims of final legitimacy. It requires only that the system protect and enable sources of meaning that remain effective even when their constructed nature is fully visible. Family is one possible example of such a source.

Expanding on Émile Durkheim: Moral Decoupling & Structural Stability

What Is Monstrous in a Man Becomes Natural in Abstraction



Modern sociology often assumes that complex societies require a secular moral framework to replace religious belief. Émile Durkheim argued that as traditional religion declines, modern societies inevitably sacralize the individual. Moral integration, in his view, remains necessary for cohesion.

This chapter critiques that assumption by introducing two structural concepts: *Moral Overlay* and *Structural Underlay*. Civilizations, I argue, are best understood as the dynamic interaction between these layers. Durkheim correctly recognized transformation within moral life, but he overstated the inevitability of sacralization and assumed the permanence of the individual as the sacred unit. I further argue that rationality, when elevated from tool to object of worship, may undermine long-term civilizational stability by dissolving *Moral Overlay*.

This book does not reject morality; rather, it regards morality as one of humanity's greatest sources of freedom. Its central claim is simply that morality requires a stable underlying structure to sustain it. Absent such a foundation, morality risks corruption, eventually transforming from a force that serves individuals into one that works against them.

Structural Underlay: The material and coordinative substrate of society. It includes primitive exchange, money, property relations, energy distribution, labour organization, bureaucratic systems, and technological infrastructure. Even early barter systems or shell currencies qualify. The underlay answers the question of what is. It governs allocation, constraint, enforcement, and persistence. It is the gravitational layer of civilization. Remove it, and moral aspiration floats without anchor. A modern Western example is the monetary system, contract enforcement, centralized banking, regulatory institutions, and digital infrastructure that coordinate everyday economic life.

Moral Overlay: The symbolic and normative framework layered atop that substrate. Religion, sacred taboos, family obligation, role-based duty, honour codes, civic ethics, and ideals of justice belong here. The overlay answers the question of what ought to be pursued, protected, or restrained. Remove it, and structure persists, but direction dissolves. A modern Western example is the fragmented mix of human rights discourse, personal autonomy, identity-based ethics, residual religious belief, and competing cultural values that shape what people believe ought to matter.

Across history the two layers appear together. Polytheistic systems distributed moral attention across multiple human traits. Medieval Christianity centralized sacred authority. Confucian-influenced societies embedded morality in role and ritual more than theology. Liberal democracies sacralize rights and dignity. In each case, the underlay coordinates material life while the overlay channels meaning. Durkheim's insight was that overlay does not vanish with secularization. It mutates.

Before abstraction took hold, what I call the Structural Underlay was simply the physical environment itself, or, for idealists, the mind's construction of that environment, while the Moral Overlay functioned as coordination mechanisms managing conflict over scarce resources and ego-driven desire. It was through these disputes that

abstraction emerged: money, law, symbolic value, and institutional authority reshaped what counted as 'is'. As the underlay becomes increasingly abstract, the overlay must adapt accordingly.

I want to clarify that not every action we view as moralistic is what I am referring to here. I mean specifically culturally imposed moral influence, not innate impulses, the kind of external authority that resembles what Max Stirner called a *spook*: ideas that govern individual behaviour from outside the individual. In this sense I am concerned only with influences that shape action externally, such as religion, Japanese cultural norms, democracy, liberty, and similar ideological frameworks. At the same time, it is clear that much of what we call morality does not arise purely from these systems but seems to be partly rooted in developed instinct. For example, moral concern for children or the elderly often appears spontaneously; although cruelty toward them is possible, most people noticeably soften in their presence, suggesting that some moral tendencies emerge from natural disposition rather than solely from cultural instruction, as Dostoevsky wrote:

The soul is healed by being with children

Although these instincts can be damaged through severe conditions, they are far more resilient to reason. By contrast, a Moral Overlay, constructed and maintained

through reason and social conditioning, can deteriorate much more easily because it is not deeply integrated into the ego.

Morals that free can later bind

When everything I can contribute to a social structure is deemed immoral by the very moral system that sustains it, morality begins to collapse in on itself. I call this *moralistic paralysis*: when the Structural Underlay depends on a Moral Overlay to function, yet that overlay invalidates the very contributions required to keep it alive. If survival requires me to practice usury, to steal, to act from pride, greed, lust, or envy, then what ultimately survives will be precisely those traits (unless abstracted). Yet those very traits were what the structural underlay needed from the beginning in order to stabilize itself. Jordan Peterson, across many of his talks, seems to suggest a framework where a capitalist Structural Underlay is guided by a religious, often Christian, Moral Overlay. The intent is understandable, but the model strikes me as overly idealistic. When survival depends on a fragile Structural Underlay, and it evolves faster than the Moral Overlay can adapt, the moral framework begins to fracture.

Moral Decoupling: The process by which a society's Structural Underlay, through its evolving incentives and constraints, gradually renders survival and reproduction incompatible with its existing Moral Overlay, forcing the overlay to adapt or fracture; this transition signals entry into a period of instability where previous norms no longer align with material conditions and long-term outcomes become uncertain.

We can observe Moral Decoupling in the modern age. The Structural Underlay increasingly pressures family structures to fragment, as dual incomes become necessary to sustain the material conditions required to raise children effectively. In response, the Moral Overlay shifts, adapting to new economic realities, but in doing so it destabilizes norms that once aligned with the previous structure. This is not to claim that either the former Moral Overlay or the earlier Structural Underlay were just; rather, it illustrates the decoupling itself and the uncertain terrain into which society now moves, meaninglessness and confusion.

This continual reshaping creates the possibility of drift in either direction. In many ways, this mirrors the symbolism of the Garden of Eden and the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil: abstraction introduces awareness, but awareness alters the structure of reality itself.

Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die - Genesis 2:16-17

And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die: For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil - Genesis 3:4–5

In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread, till thou return unto the ground; for out of it wast thou taken: for dust thou art, and unto dust shalt thou return - Genesis 3:19

A specific example of Moral Decoupling can illustrate the process clearly. Suppose a culture's Moral Overlay values hard work and always doing one's best, while the Structural Underlay increasingly optimizes for comfort and convenience. These two frameworks begin to pull against each other. Just as a person can't sustain a sprint if every step of the environment encourages rest, a culture can't maintain a strong work ethic when its structures continually reward ease. Over time, the Moral Overlay begins to fade, even though the Structural Underlay still depends on hard work to function. As a result, that labour must be sourced elsewhere, often from another country with a different Moral Overlay, thereby furthering the process of Moral Decoupling.

Another, more clear, modern example can be seen in religious traditions that prohibit the charging of interest, yet operate within economies that depend on credit and investment. To reconcile this tension, financial systems have developed structures such as profit-sharing agreements, cost-plus sales, and lease-based financing that often serve functions similar to conventional loans while remaining formally compliant with religious law. Whether viewed as legitimate adaptations or loopholes, these arrangements illustrate how moral systems can become decoupled from their original purpose as they adapt to new economic realities.

Finally, the modern global example can be seen through desire optimization. If we understand morality as a mixture of ego-infused morality, such as the kind described earlier through Dostoevsky, where even the presence of certain people produces physical changes, and what Max Stirner would call a 'Spook' that governs the individual, then desire extraction gradually strips away these external influences until only pure egoistic morality remains. At that point, it must begin reshaping even pure egoistic morality in order to continue. In an environment where desire is continually optimized, morality must eventually disappear unless the optimization itself is directed toward the desire to be moral. This is because morality, by definition, functions as a restraint or dilution of desire. Laws exist precisely because at least a minority of people

are inclined to break them. OnlyFans, Hollywood, sports, addictive food, fashion, and internet memes are presented as culture, yet each can also be understood as mechanisms of desire extraction. Every new iteration of desire extraction is accepted as the new culture, while the previous culture is dismissed as outdated, until, with each successive iteration, morality itself is gradually dissolved.

What remains is what I believe we once called the **soul**: the individual actions free of mental spooks, knowing no language, no reason, no abstraction, only pure instinct. Our modern perception of the soul tends to elevate it into altruism, love, and whatever we moralistically deem superior, but if the soul itself could survive without abstraction, why has abstraction become so pervasive, so deeply ingrained? In a world optimizing around mental moralities, there may come a point when souls push back, not as a call to action, but as a descriptive possibility. Yet at what point can the soul be trusted in an environment that is constantly shaping it? In the same way a person with a nose job may reproduce more successfully without passing that alteration on genetically, even the soul can be altered by the conditions that surround it.

The souls that seek a foundation for their intuition find that foundation constantly shifting, an ever-changing structure. Like fish that read the tides only to have the moon and sun altered with every movement unaware, they

follow a flawed north star, believing they are on their familiar course, only to find no food at the end. And what if modern morality itself survives only through unawareness?

Today we see an intense anger toward women for acting intuitively. As the modern Western divide between the sexes deepens, many men describe women as irrational, self-interested, or overly promiscuous. Yet this anger reveals its own weakness: a yearning for an idealized image of womanhood, one whose intuition remains anchored to a world that no longer exists. It is like blaming the fish that read the tides instead of recognizing that the earth's core itself is shifting. Rather than confronting those deeper transformations, the frustration is projected onto those perceived to be responding to them. The tides change, but the anger remains fixed on the fish. In doing so, the man who seeks a woman guided by intuition becomes subject to that intuition himself.

As outlined:

If survival requires me to practice usury, to steal, to act from pride, greed, lust, or envy, then what ultimately survives will be precisely those traits ***(unless abstracted)***

Moral Veil: The abstraction layer that conceals or sanitizes actions required by the Structural Underlay when those actions would otherwise contradict the Moral Overlay. It enables individuals to engage in Overlay-voiding behaviour without guilt so long as the abstraction remains intact; once the contradiction is clearly perceived and action continues, it ceases to be a Veil and becomes conscious transgression.

Moral Veils sustain both the Moral Overlay and the Structural Underlay, but only so long as they remain concealed within abstraction; once the Underlay pressures the system enough to expose what the Veil disguises, the Overlay begins to fracture. Consider gambling: the Moral Overlay declares theft immoral, yet when loss is embedded within probabilistic systems and mathematical formalism, the same transfer of wealth becomes permissible, encoded in numbers and framed as voluntary participation rather than extraction. To detect a Moral Veil, look for density of abstraction, technical language, procedural framing, distributed responsibility, especially where simple asymmetries are rendered conceptually complex. Even philosophical language can function this way, obscuring accessible dynamics beneath specialized terminology.

These are descriptive observations, not moral indictments; exposing a Veil may illuminate contradiction, but one should be cautious when kicking at rotting pillars, they

may appear decayed, yet still be load-bearing, and the roof may cave in with them. This echoes the teachings of Niccolò Machiavelli, who argued that leadership may at times require immoral action. The Moral Veil seeks to specify how such a claim may be justified under certain Moral Overlay and Structural Underlay conditions. In this sense, the concept may be better named as a *Machiavellian abstraction*.

To illustrate this idea, consider eugenics. The Moral Overlay condemns eugenics as immoral, yet governance systems often produce similar outcomes in effect. The difference is perception: what appears as deliberate selection in eugenics is, in governance, absorbed into what people tend to call 'nature', because choice is abstracted. Governance determines who eats, who thrives, who reproduces, and ultimately who is propagated. A wealthy man under one structure may be poor under another. In this way, governance subtly accomplishes what eugenics does openly. This is the Moral Veil.

Yet we can't guarantee that such selection, who is propagated and who is not, is unnecessary at the level of the Structural Underlay. It may be an emergent requirement for maximizing collective stability or 'benefit'. Consider a simple analogy: you have a toolbox but lack a Phillips head screwdriver. You use a coin instead, it works, but imperfectly. If you are stranded with no access to better

tools, the coin is not just a substitute; it is the only viable solution. Likewise, we can't be certain that the tension between Moral Overlay and Structural Underlay is avoidable, or even absent in the present moment.

Now consider the reaction if eugenics were made explicit. Modern systems already tend to propagate the first mover, cognitive ability, and social leverage, those who possess them or are their descendants are more likely to reproduce successfully. But formalize this, mandate an IQ test before conception, criminalize non-compliance, and it becomes immediately condemned as eugenics. Abstract the same pressures into systems however, and they become acceptable, even invisible. People require agents to blame; they struggle to assign responsibility to systems. And when systems become indistinguishable from life itself, moral judgment loses its anchor.

Unstable Veil: A Moral Veil whose hidden abstraction initially may provide structural necessity by concealing actions required by the Structural Underlay, but becomes unstable when the biological or social preventative forces behind the Moral Overlay can't be fully suppressed by unawareness. As incentives expand or sustain the veil, its concealed contradictions spread and intensify, making them widely felt yet difficult to directly identify due to the veil's still-partial concealment.

If the goal is simply stability, morality can be applied conditionally (naturally) to maintain a lasting system, and Moral Veils are not inherently bad under this framework; they become problematic only when they begin to corrupt the system they help stabilize. An Unstable Veil is one that leads to Moral Decoupling. Consider a lottery: if gambling remains bounded, only a small portion of the population participates and that proportion stays stable, it may violate the Moral Overlay, yet the system itself remains stable allowing whatever burden it carries for the Structural Underlay to persist. Instability arises when the concealed behaviour bypasses deeper biological or social safeguards embedded in the moral. Take theft as an example: if everyone could steal freely without detection or retaliation, those exploiting the Moral Veil could accumulate resources at the expense of the broader population until the very population sustaining the system is undermined. In effect, the veil has bypassed what biology evolved morality to prevent by keeping the violation hidden; once this preventative mechanism can no longer be contained by simple unawareness, the veil becomes unstable.

On the contrary, we can see an example of a Stable Veil in the Japanese language. For those unaware, Japanese contains different words and speech patterns that carry the same meaning but are used depending on the level of politeness. This separate mode of speaking is called *keigo*. With someone close, a person who wants you to wait a

moment will likely say *chotto matte*, yet even at a fast-food restaurant you are more likely to hear *shoushou omachi kudasai*. Through this abstraction within the language, Japanese society is able to mentally separate the individual from the role they are performing. As a result, attitudes toward work in Japan can appear different from those often seen in the West, with people caring less about defining someone by their job and instead viewing it as "that's just their work". I will not speak for Japanese people as a whole; however, I describe this Veil as *Stable* because even if the average Japanese person were fully aware of this abstracted social process, the likely response would simply be, "Yes, and it works for us".

However, not every Veil is stable. As technology expands global awareness, we may encounter conflicts that many assume would naturally lead to greater stability. While long-term stability may eventually emerge, the short term can become volatile when personal morality begins to clash with previously abstracted or concealed actions. In those moments, pillars that once supported social stability may instead be weakened or entirely knocked down once the Veil is lifted.

A specific example of this is the modern ideal of fairness. Key elements of observable fairness has been abstraction out; the Structural Underlay beneath it have become increasingly opaque. In dense urban societies, most people

have little idea how others earn their living or acquire their wealth. Before modern technology, it was far easier to see the relationship between labor and material outcomes. Today, social norms discourage discussing income or displaying wealth, while financial markets, digital assets, and increasingly abstract economic systems further obscure the origins of prosperity. When inequality is hidden behind abstract language, mathematics, and systems that few people investigate, it becomes possible to preserve a moral commitment to fairness even when the underlying structure no longer reflects it.

As the Structural Underlay gradually reveals itself, the moral and the behaviours built upon it begin to destabilize - Moral Decoupling. This is what makes the Moral Veil unstable. As I have written elsewhere:

Reason binds reality to its focus

People often mistake the Structural Underlay not as a potential source of unfairness, but as reality itself. Once the gap between moral ideals and structural reality becomes too great, those ideals lose their coherence, and in harsh environments, little can be rebuilt upon their collapse.

What we sustain in worship, we become

In works such as *The Division of Labour in Society* and *The Elementary Forms of Religious Life*, Durkheim argued that

religion is society sacralizing itself. As division of labour increases, mechanical solidarity weakens and organic solidarity emerges. Modern differentiation produces heightened self-consciousness. The individual becomes sacred. He did not claim theology persists unchanged. Rather, he argued that sacredness transforms. In Europe, that transformation manifested as human rights, dignity, and autonomy. The sacred did not disappear; it relocated. This closely parallels Nietzsche's idea of the 'death of God'.

Durkheim's contribution remains. Moral overlay adapts to structural conditions. It does not simply evaporate under rational scrutiny. However, he assumed that sacralization is anthropologically inevitable and that the differentiated individual is the stable modern sacred unit.

To find what was once weak, look at what is now strong, to find what was once strong, look at what is now weak

Durkheim treats the individual as a psychologically bounded constant. Increasing specialization generates stronger self-awareness, and stronger self-awareness generates sacralized individualism. But this presumes that the individual is ontologically fixed. The 'I' is a biological configuration and a linguistic boundary. I can say 'I' and refer to this organism. I could also say 'I' and mean humanity. Language does not forbid such expansion; habit and biology constrain it. Biology currently appears to

favour a bounded self because it is efficient under present evolutionary pressures. That does not make it permanent.

If environmental conditions shift, identity boundaries may shift. Language evolves. Biology adapts. Conscious systems reshape their self-conception over time. Durkheim analyzed the transformation of Europe over centuries. He did not account for the deeper plasticity of identity across longer horizons. Sacralization of the individual may be historically dominant in modern Western societies, but inevitability is too strong a claim.

Consciousness can disarm what instinct would defend

Rationality is pattern recognition and abstraction. It predicts, compares, and optimizes. It does not generate intrinsic direction. It is a tool. When rationality becomes sacred, when optimization itself becomes the moral imperative, the feedback loop between overlay and underlay changes. Everything becomes subject to evaluation. Traditions are reweighed. Duties are reframed as choices. Attachments become variables.

Family illustrates this tension. Family does not require continual abstraction to function. It operates through attachment, instinct, and embedded obligation. It acts before it analyzes. Its continuity does not depend on constant justification. When rational abstraction dominates, family becomes a lifestyle decision rather than

an anchor. This shift does not produce immediate collapse; it produces gradual erosion.

Rational morality can't guarantee long-term stability because rationality does not define what is beneficial beyond the patterns it detects. It can optimize comfort, autonomy, efficiency, or power, but it can't determine which objective should anchor the system. If rationality itself becomes the sacred center, optimization pressure increases. Acceleration follows. Embedded institutions weaken. In this sense, rationality as worship may be less advantageous for longevity than rationality as instrument.

To seek the upper hand on the universe is to seek it over ourselves

In game theory, a Nash equilibrium, developed by John Nash, describes a stable outcome within a defined game where each participant chooses the best possible strategy given the assumption that others are doing the same; no player can improve their position by unilaterally changing their move. Yet stability does not imply benefit. In the Prisoner's Dilemma, two individuals must independently decide whether to cooperate or betray. Rational calculation leads both to betray, because defection protects against the worst-case scenario. The result is worse for both than mutual cooperation, but once reached, neither can

improve their outcome alone. Rationality converges on suffering.

No amount of additional pattern recognition changes the structure of the game. Each actor reasons correctly. Each predicts the other accurately. The damage arises not from irrationality but from incentive alignment within the Structural Underlay. This dynamic scales to arms races, competitive financial systems, and oversaturated status-driven social behaviour: when all agents optimize under the same pressures, equilibrium may be stable yet corrosive. Rationality, therefore, can't guarantee collective benefit; it can only navigate the landscape it is given, even when that landscape leads everyone downward together.

The trajectory of Japan complicates any simple claim that modernity must culminate in explicit sacralization of the autonomous individual. Japan combines advanced industrial systems with relatively embedded moral norms. Its Structural Underlay includes constitutional democracy and capitalism, yet its moral overlay remains heavily role-based, ritualized, and socially embedded rather than overtly rights-centered in everyday life. This suggests that modern structural complexity does not mandate loud individual worship. Moral integration can remain subdued and embodied rather than abstract and declarative. The sacred can be diffused across harmony, role, and continuity rather than concentrated in explicit autonomy.

Durkheim's framework accommodates transformation, but it does not fully account for such variation. It presumes that differentiation necessarily intensifies reflective individualism. The Japanese case suggests that embedded norms can coexist with advanced structural complexity without full moral hyper-individualization.

Durkheim evaluated societies primarily through moral integration. A different lens evaluates them through longevity and feedback stability. A civilization may be morally quiet yet structurally functional. It may persist for extended periods even if its overlay is not explicitly sacralized in reflective terms.

The key question becomes how overlay interacts with underlay. Some overlays dampen structural acceleration. Others intensify it. When moral systems encourage constant optimization, structural pressure increases.

When they embed limits, friction increases. Friction is not inefficiency alone; it is often a stabilizer. Civilizations are not sustained by integration alone but by the balance between direction and constraint. Moral Overlay channels meaning. Structural Underlay channels coordination. Neither disappears easily.

4

Attainable Singularities

A Critique of Stoic Culture: Personal Discipline Turned Social Regulation

Guiding Agents: Every Guard Marks the Wound It Hides



This chapter is not an attack on Marcus Aurelius or his personal philosophy. Instead, it seeks to explore how cultural Stoicism contributes to an *Attainable System*. Stoic culture can become a byproduct of governance, aligning with the concept of an *Attainable Singularity*, a term I introduced in chapter 2.1. Any criticisms of Stoicism in this chapter are directed at its contemporary form and its role as a cultural tool. Furthermore, this chapter suggests that Stoicism is often marketed to women under a different guise known as a *regulated nervous system*. This chapter also introduces the concept of a *guiding agent*.

There's no doubt that Stoicism can be a valuable tool in certain situations, particularly if your goal is general peace, or perhaps even happiness, when used decisively. Practices like gratitude, accepting death, and embracing adversity can bring a sense of tranquility. However, Stoicism doesn't

translate well to all situations. Consider the dog trapped in a cage, unable to see the outside world. This dog has no concept of chasing a rabbit. If it adopts Stoic principles, it might come to accept its cage, assuming that everything outside of it is beyond its control. While it may find peace in its suffering through discipline, that peace is limited by its biology. No matter how much you resist hunger, your body will eventually force you into the physical struggle, which then translates into a mental one. If you continuously suppress egoistic desires, you risk becoming nothing.

Nietzsche is said to have made a similar critique, but I'll explain it anyway. You can't claim to be living according to nature while actively trying to suppress emotional reactions. Emotions are part of what nature has given us. Yes, technically, nature also gave rise to Stoicism, but that doesn't mean all of nature is inherently Stoic. Any claim that Stoicism represents nature is simply a way to convince people that they are serving some higher purpose under the guise of 'nature'.

Every guard marks the wound it hides

"Control what you can, accept what you can't". This concept can certainly bring peace to one's life, but it doesn't guarantee overall well-being. For example, imagine a society on the brink of collapse, requiring cooperation. If

everyone in that society adopts this mentality, nothing would change. In that moment, no one truly has control, because the collective effort is holding the structure together. In modern times, what this philosophy does is tell people to accept the social structures they live under, suggesting that these structures are too large to change. It keeps them trapped within the very system that is causing the problems they're trying to numb.

At any point you try to guard your emotions, you are displaying weakness. I'm not saying that weakness is inherently bad, but it is still weakness. People who talk behind others' backs do so because they fear their true feelings being known. People who threaten others are trying to protect a weakness. Those who attempt to conceal their emotions are hiding their vulnerability. On the other hand, people who have already learned to control their emotions don't need a daily reminder from a philosophy. There's no real strength in following Stoicism; rather, it's a desire for strength. If you personally embody Stoicism, that can be a form of strength. However, the widespread cultural movement reveals something else.

In recent times, there's been a cultural shift that discourages people from wearing their hearts on their sleeves, branding it as naïve or weak. In reality, wearing your heart on your sleeve is the most courageous form of

emotional expression. Any attempt to conceal it reveals fear.

Stoicism, as a cultural phenomenon, seems to be largely embraced by men. However, a similar idea has emerged in the form of the concept of a 'regulated nervous system', which is often marketed to women. Both cultural trends, the worship of Stoicism and the emphasis on a 'regulated nervous system', appear to serve as guiding forces for social structure.

Guiding Agents: Forms of cultural worship used by an Attainable System to guide individuals toward an Attainable Singularity. What is worshipped can be rational, irrational, or even truth itself; it simply needs to have a sustained cultural impact that helps governed individuals move toward this singularity.

In modern times, many men complain about therapy culture, while many women criticize Stoic culture. The amusing part is that they have almost the exact same effect. Not only do they produce similar outcomes, but they also tend to drive a wedge between the genders. I would argue that these two guiding forces are a result of an Attainable System that requires men and women to dislike each other in order to reach its desired end state.

The Stirnian Idol: When Thought Turns Against Its Thinker

You Will Have No Perception of Time Deeming Clocks Missing One Dial Wrong



During my time on Substack, I've noticed a clear difference in the kind of audience it cultivates. It tends to attract those with formal education who have woven that identity tightly into who they are. Of course, Substack's algorithm likely optimizes for a specific demographic, so this is not an attack on the formally educated themselves. What I've observed within many of these communities is a peculiar form of 'intellectual freedom', one that appears liberated, yet remains chained.

Building one's entire identity around intellectual pursuit may be flawed in my view, but it at least aligns with a coherent aim. What concerns me more is the recurring tendency for individuals to attach their identities to other thinkers in the name of 'reason'. In response, I introduce a sub-concept of Max Stirner's 'Spook' to examine how identification with others can dominate reason itself. In

this chapter, I present the ideas of the *Stirnian Idol* and the *Idolized Spook*.

Truth lies where incentive divides

I refer specifically to Stirner because the intention here closely mirrors his own. Once something is identified and labeled as a Stirnian Idol, it should, in theory, lose the unconscious authority it holds over reason, authority it retains most strongly while unnamed.

It is very easy to become emotionally attached to individuals and there is nothing inherently wrong with that; however, when one's aim is reason itself, that attachment can begin to distort judgment. If reading Stirner felt liberating, for example, you may naturally form an emotional connection to his work and then dive deeper, increasingly focused on the man behind the ideas. Over time, this can lead to assuming that his other views must also be correct within some acceptable margin of error, or even to attaching your identity to him as a whole. In the modern, atomized age, this is profitable, it packages thought into clean unified figures, but it undermines logical discrimination by replacing evaluation with loyalty.

Stirnian Idol: An abstraction or figure that, once sacralized, reverses the original reasoning that justified it, subordinating the individual to its symbolic authority.

Idolized Spook: A fixed idea elevated to reverence such that critical engagement is replaced by symbolic devotion.

You see writers entirely absorbed in a single brand of philosophy or more intriguingly, in a single person. Whether acknowledged or not, exposure breeds bias, and attachment deepens it. Ideas are not people; they are constructions of a human mind communicated outward. This dynamic works in both directions. A Stirnian Idol can be today's 'good guy' just as easily as today's 'bad guy'. Such idols are powerful tools of public influence because they compartmentalize ideas that might otherwise need to be combined in order to effectively challenge dominant narratives. In this sense, Stirnian Idols form the core of what I call Guiding Agents in the last chapter. Stirnian Idols do not solve, they sooth.

This extends beyond simple idol worship; it penetrates into ideology worship. An Idolized Spook is a Spook in the same way a square is a rectangle, a specific instance within a broader category. The distinction lies in what it seeks to protect. Stirner's concern is the ego, the Unique One. The Idolized Spook shares that structural aim but applies it specifically to the use of reason. It exists to protect reason from distortion while it is being employed as a tool. This is not an attempt to moralize reason or elevate it above all else; rather, when reason is invoked, the Idolized Spook aims to let it operate with minimal interference.

That being said, myself included, people naturally focus on what captures their attention. Early childhood experiences, for example, can push individuals to direct their energy toward what would have kept their younger selves safe. Even something as ordinary as being a student for a certain period can shape an identity-driven personality that prioritizes certain kinds of ideas over others. Individual thinkers often exhibit recurring themes and can be reasonably identified by them. For instance, when you think of Einstein, you immediately think of energy and relativity; Nietzsche evokes ideas of will, power, and individualism; Wittgenstein brings language to mind. However, associating a thinker with a theme does not automatically make everything they say on that topic correct. Often, our attachment to these figures stems from emotion, connection, or a survival-driven tendency to align with a perceived group leader, not from careful reasoning about the correctness of their ideas. While emotion and connection have intrinsic value, when it comes to rational judgment, they can easily cloud our understanding. The tyrant is presumed always wrong; the benevolent leader, always right. That is, until tides change.

Will creates what it can't find

It seems likely that the worship of people, of idols, is rooted in a deeply personal desire: to be seen in the same light. Even those who claim to pursue truth, another object of reverence, often end up propagating themselves through what they promote. In doing so, the line between spreading ideas and elevating the self begins to blur. Imagine a world in which elevating idols over ideas is harmful, yet the very act of spreading ideas turns you into an idol, the precise thing in this hypothetical world you're meant to escape. We tend to give what we ourselves desire. The giver of a gift is often happiest in receiving, not necessarily the same object, but something that reflects the same underlying value or thought. Ask a young woman who she finds most beautiful, and more often than not, she will name someone who reflects her own features. Ask a young man who he looks up to, and he will usually point to an older man who embodies his aspirations. Our drive to replicate ourselves extends far beyond romance, yet we still insist on calling it intellectual freedom.

Means remain servants of their ends

The following are examples of potential Stirnerian idols and the environments in which they may be regarded as such. I emphasize this distinction to avoid over-labeling. These individuals are real people, and their ideas may be employed for purposes beyond their knowledge or intent and perhaps only momentarily. Many people may

genuinely benefit from their work, and I do not seek to deny that. Rather, these examples illustrate situations in which the broader cultural effect may contribute to a shift toward an Attainable Singularity.

Andrew Tate: Worships money while criticizing the systems through which it operates, yet if money itself is part of the problem, that criticism becomes a form of self-soothing that leaves the root cause untouched.

Jordan Peterson: Encourages self-improvement, but in a world where opportunities to gain power are limited, it can become a form of self-soothing that offers personal comfort without altering underlying constraints.

Clavicular: Similar to Nietzsche, offers those with limited access to material power an alternative source of meaning through self-development and physical appearance. Improved looks may help a man attract a partner, but without the resources needed to sustain a family, such relationships may struggle to become long-term commitments. The result is a shift toward short-term relationships over stable family formation. In this sense, it can function as a form of soothing, providing a sense of personal empowerment without addressing the underlying distribution of material power.

Hannah Pearl Davis: Soothes men who hold resentment toward women, providing an outlet for their frustrations while often reinforcing, rather than resolving, the divide between the sexes.

Alex Cooper: Soothes women who hold resentment toward men, providing an outlet for their frustrations while often reinforcing, rather than resolving, the divide between the sexes.

Slavoj Žižek: Gives people the feeling of being a radical intellectual while producing little to no meaningful change in the real world, substituting ideological satisfaction for tangible action or results.

Myself: If an Unattainable System is, for whatever reason, impossible to realize, then pursuing it ultimately leads toward an Attainable Singularity. Alternatively, systems and individuals may take a mile from an inch, expanding limited premises far beyond their original scope, for example, extending the claim that consent can be immoral relative to certain biological aims into broader conclusions that were never initially intended.

Hollywood / Music Industry: Celebrity culture centralizes female attraction toward a small number of highly visible men who exist far outside a woman's immediate social environment. At the same time, segments of the music industry heavily promote short-term mating values, weakening male attraction to long-term, less promiscuous partners and contributing to a decline in men's interest in committed relationships.

Financial Influencers: Specifically, this includes those who advocate investing in broad-market ETFs or fixed assets like real estate. Cryptocurrency influencers also help fill the gap created by the market's desire for rapid wealth creation and transfer. However, this is not to suggest that cryptocurrencies lack legitimate potential applications (refer to chapter 6.5) beyond speculation and investment.

Jacques Lacan: By defining the human condition as one of perpetual desire born from lack, you risk justifying self-fulfilling systems. The assumption that humans must always want more, that they can never truly be satisfied, becomes built into the theory itself.

Friedrich Nietzsche: Similar to Peterson, he attempts to redirect the will to power inward rather than toward the acquisition of actual material power. In a world where opportunities to obtain external power are limited, this can function as a form of soothing, encouraging individuals to

focus on mastery of the self rather than mastery of their circumstances. Going to the gym may increase confidence and attractiveness, but without the material resources necessary to support a family, a relationship may struggle to endure. Self-improvement can strengthen the individual, yet it does not necessarily resolve the structural constraints that shape their possibilities.

Marcus Aurelius: Refer to chapter 4.1.

Sigmund Freud: Refer to chapter 4.3.

The examples listed above are far from exhaustive. In a system where money and the fulfillment of desire are the primary paths to prominence, naturally, guiding agents are everywhere.

A Critique of Sigmund Freud & Therapy Culture

Consciousness Can Disarm What Instinct Would Defend



Freud's goal in psychoanalysis was to help individuals uncover unconscious thoughts and repressed memories that contribute to psychological distress. By bringing these issues to consciousness, he aimed to foster insight, self-awareness, and emotional healing.

While this concept may seem helpful and positive at first glance, this chapter aims to explain how, under certain conditions, it can lead to harm. Therapy culture can become a byproduct of governance with an *Attainable Singularity*. In essence, if the underlying social structure or the life you lead is flawed, therapy may subtly guide you toward something that is egoistically harmful. This chapter also touches on the known issues surrounding therapy within free-market systems.

It is not the intention of this chapter to claim that therapy is inherently immoral or always harmful. Rather, the

concern lies in the dangers of elevating therapy to an uncritical, almost worshipful status as a tool for personal growth.

Consciousness can disarm what instinct would defend

Essentially, the goal of therapy is to reconcile the old with the new. Our primitive brains, shaped by the environments of our ancestors, often struggle to adapt to modern life, which can lead to unnecessary stress or depression. For example, let's say I experience trauma caused by a close friend. My primitive brain might treat this person as part of my 'tribe', triggering a protective response and making me hypersensitive to their actions. This sensitivity may persist even though, in today's world, I could simply distance myself from that individual. In therapy, I become aware of the root cause, and by understanding it, I can lower my fear response. If the problem no longer exists in my life, then that's a positive outcome. However, not all emotions need to be brought into consciousness. Take love, for instance, once it's analyzed, the feeling is diluted. Instead of being in the moment, you're constantly analyzing, assuming that's beneficial because of 'science'. But in doing so, you might be dulling the richness of life.

The real problem arises when therapy is used to guide you into a life you don't want to live. For example, you may have a genuine desire to become a fisherman, but therapy

reveals that your desire stems from an event in childhood when a fish flew out of the water and hit you in the face, and you wanted to assert power over it. So, you abandon your dream and continue with a life you hate.

You might argue that this is simply a flaw in diagnosis, the real issue is the life you despise. But when that life is essential for survival within a social structure, you're trapped. Therapy, in that case, may only ease your transition into a life your instincts naturally resist. Furthermore, imagine that the social structure demands you perform tasks you're good at because of trauma you've experienced. This creates a vicious cycle of keeping the wound alive and perpetually needing therapy. If this system is monetized, it can form a profitable feedback loop.

Therapy as culture is no longer just a tool; it becomes a mechanism for adapting people to a system in rapid flux. When therapy becomes a cultural norm, it may signal that a governance structure is using it to help people adjust to its fast-paced changes, an Attainable Singularity.

Why must the unconscious always be treated as harmful? Assuming Darwinian evolution, change is slow, often slower than we'd prefer, but it also encodes long-term constraints shaped for survival, and by discarding the unconscious too quickly you risk stripping away those built-in safeguards. Imagine a man who goes to therapy for

a deep gash in his leg and is told the pain is merely mental, something he can overcome by bringing it into consciousness; if he truly internalizes that, he may ignore the next injury altogether, or be forced to consciously monitor what pain once regulated automatically, something the body evolved to handle without deliberate thought. If human biology were fully adapted to the modern environment, especially given strong incentives around survival and reproduction, we might expect the body to use the unconscious to its advantage.

In that case, is it always wise to drag those processes into awareness? Consider a boy who grows up without a father: his more primitive instincts may push him toward heightened aggression as a compensatory mechanism for the absence of protection, which in a harsher, ancestral environment could have been highly adaptive, perhaps even necessary, yet modern therapeutic frameworks might aim to soften or eliminate it, potentially dismantling something that once served a protective role. So in the modern world, do we really understand what we are altering when we intervene in processes we define, almost by definition, as not fully understood?

I swear to you, gentlemen, that to be overly conscious is a sickness, a real, thorough sickness - Fyodor Dostoevsky, Notes from Underground

I would argue that quotes like that above, and their popularity, reveal more about what is being implicitly worshipped than about truth itself. The emotional pull they carry is not necessarily a reflection of life's inherent confusion or its local suffering, but rather a deeper confusion about confusion itself: a confusion of awareness, and of the role unawareness plays in allowing biology to function, where the limits of conscious understanding are mistaken for flaws in reality rather than recognized as conditions that make coherent functioning possible.

Remove the unawareness that biology relies on and you invite a kind of instinctual confusion: nihilism that slips into depression, or the empathetic carnivore who starves rather than eat meat.

Reward without remedy keeps the wound alive

Once money is involved, the situation only worsens in a highly optimized environment. Here's how it typically plays out: I own a therapy clinic. If I don't stay competitive, my business will fail. Over time, the only clinics that survive are the ones that remain competitive. To do that, I need to maximize profit. As a result, I eventually have to cut therapists who aren't bringing in enough revenue, whether I realize it or not. The therapists

who aren't bringing in revenue are the one's who heal clients and don't see them again.

This dynamic may be avoidable when the business is small, with minimal competition and demand. But once the therapy industry grows significantly, it becomes harder to maintain the same level of care. You might argue that people will simply stop using therapy if it becomes too commercialized. While that's a possibility, creating a therapy culture through advertising can make it difficult for the masses to disengage. The goal becomes finding a balance: getting people to feel helped enough that they don't quit, while also keeping them in enough pain ensuring they keep coming back.

Dukkha Culture: Life as Suffering

Suffering Ignites the Fire, It's Not the Flame



This chapter explores what I call *Dukkha culture*, a term borrowed from Buddhism. Dukkha culture refers to a worldview that attributes life, in its entirety, to suffering. Dukkha culture can serve as a *Guiding Agent*. Much like Stoic philosophy, Dukkha culture offers purpose to those who are suffering. While this can be a useful tool, when a culture begins to define life through this lens, it risks creating a broader, life-denying mindset.

The book that ends desire never writes its final page

While Buddhism, when applied in specific ways, can potentially dampen one's experience of life, I'm not criticizing the philosophy itself. The issue arises when the concept of life containing suffering shifts into the belief that life is suffering as a whole. At that point, individuals can fall into a dangerous loop: Life is suffering, therefore I must continue to suffer because that is life

Not all individuals mentioned are necessarily creating Dukkha culture through their work, but they are often used as tools for its propagation. Figures like Jordan Peterson, David Goggins, Fyodor Dostoevsky, Friedrich Nietzsche, and Arthur Schopenhauer all play a role in this. Many online sources attribute the following quote to Nietzsche, though it is allegedly a misquote:

To live is to suffer, to survive is to find some meaning in the suffering

This does not reveal that life is suffering, but rather a culture that wants to attribute life to suffering, one that desires suffering, with a market that readily provides it. None of what I'm about to say is meant as a personal attack on anyone; it's simply meant to highlight bias. All philosophers, in their own way, are deeply focused on abstract concepts, often to the exclusion of lived experiences. We know that many of the individuals mentioned faced significant hardships, as reflected in historical records. For instance, Dostoevsky endured years in a Russian work camp, while both Nietzsche and Peterson have struggled with ongoing health issues. When someone claims that life is suffering, it says more about their personal circumstances than it does about life itself.

Finding meaning in suffering can be useful during times of hardship, but once suffering becomes tied directly to life itself, it turns into an unbreakable cycle. You create a vortex of struggle and pain. I would argue that Dukkha culture functions as a Guiding Agent, with incentive structures that reward those who idolize suffering. It spreads as long as necessary to keep people directed toward a particular end.

The page listens only to those who write

Of course you see life as misery, you've turned tools into identity. You don't read books; you are a book reader. You've allowed yourself to fall down the rabbit hole, confusing life with its walls. Thought and meaning have merged; in a sense, meaning has become directed at itself. What once guided the boat has now become one. Slowly, we're left with fewer and fewer ways to navigate, and we guide ourselves with less to rely on as we erode our baseline instincts.

As I discuss in chapter 1.2, you claim that life is suffering in its totality. But which is it, does the universe itself demand suffering, or is it simply indifferent? Outside of human perception, the universe shows no judgment; it appears neutral, not suffering-inducing. To call it otherwise is to impose your own human evaluation onto it. The problem is not purely external, it does not show to suffer as a

human. The problem lies within you, in the interaction between your instincts and the external world. It arises when your instincts conflict with your environment, or the environment fails to align with your instincts. By declaring that the universe is suffering, you are, in effect, instructing a blind sculptor on what the clay should be, only to complain when he produces exactly what you described.

Once a means becomes identity, it can't stop

Grievance Culture: A social environment in which individuals or groups are primarily focused on identifying, expressing, and seeking redress for perceived injustices or offenses. In such a culture, conflicts are often framed around personal or group identity, and moral or social status can be closely tied to being recognized as a victim.

In recent years, there's been pushback against grievance culture, but when it was widespread, especially among young people in the West, it often harmed individuals. This isn't a critique of speaking up about oppression, but an exploration of how it led people into their own suffering, differing from Dukkha culture. At one point, everyone seemed to need validation as a victim of hardship. I'm not denying the pain, it's real, even if trivial to others, but grievance culture often turned pain into a competition of suffering, ultimately creating more suffering.

This dynamic, I imagine, was driven by markets that validated people's desires and played a role in fostering a therapy culture.

I differentiate Dukkha Culture from Grievance Culture. Like Nietzsche's concept of Passive Nihilism, Dukkha Culture is about conforming to a social structure of suffering that doesn't claim a reason for it. You are suffering, because life itself is suffering. Dukkha Culture suppresses suffering, potentially for more suffering to come externally, while Grievance Culture creates it from within. In Nietzschean terms, Dukkha Culture is passive, not active.

5

Temporal Theory

You Are Not Escaping Life; Life Is Escaping You

Adaptive Imitation: A Flame Denied One Wick Lights Another of Its Kind



In contemporary culture, the term 'escapism' is often used to describe a range of behaviours and actions that divert us from the struggles of reality. But does escapism truly exist? This chapter argues that the modern conception of escapism is misleading. It suggests that rather than escaping life, we are engaging in a perpetual transfer of instincts. Life itself is inescapable, and any attempt to distance ourselves from it results in a self-fulfilling prophecy of denial. Introducing the concept of *Adaptive Imitation*, this chapter proposes that what we often call escapism is, in fact, a complex interaction with our environment, an imitation of life rather than an escape from it.

No intended change surpasses the desire within

The modern understanding of 'escapism' relies on the assumption that life is something external, something you can flee from if you are clever or determined enough.

However, this perception fails to recognize that life is not an object outside of us, but a continuous process woven into every moment of existence. No matter how much we attempt to reject or deny our environment, our desires are rooted in instinct, a biological foundation we can't outrun only modify through our previous desire.

Escapism, in this sense, is not a flight from life but a reshaping of suffering through distraction. For instance, the desire to fill a void with food, alcohol, or entertainment does not escape life; it merely substitutes one form of experience for another. In this replacement, we confront the same instincts that shape our desires: the craving for relief from pain, the longing for meaning, the pursuit of pleasure. In essence, escapism is not the rejection of life, it is its distortion.

'Escapism' is a loaded word. The concept of suffering is deeply ingrained in the way we talk about life. A society that views life through the lens of suffering inherently fosters the belief that we must escape it. If we viewed life as inherently valuable and filled with potential for joy, there would be no need to 'escape'. But in a world where suffering flourishes faster than joy, we adapt our actions and vocabulary to accommodate this worldview.

A flame denied one wick lights another of its kind

Adaptive Imitation: Refers to the process of adapting to a new environment by replicating patterns or behaviours from past environments. Rather than escaping reality, individuals maintain a connection to previous experiences by imitating them in a way that fits the new context. For example, video games may remove the physical aspect of violence but allow players to channel similar instincts in a controlled, virtual environment. It's about using the past to navigate and cope with change, creating a bridge between the old and the new.

Further examples of Adaptive Imitation include sports (replicating competition and dominance while minimizing injuries), social media (mimicking social validation and status signalling in a virtual space), hustle culture (emulating ambition and success through mental effort instead of physical struggle), fitness culture (replicating strength and endurance training for personal achievement rather than survival), and virtual reality (mimicking adventurous exploration without real-world danger). These examples illustrate how humans adapt past behaviours to modern environments, allowing them to channel core instincts in ways that are socially acceptable or safe to a modern moral structure.

A clear example of inefficient and potentially harmful residue from adaptive imitation is fitness culture. This is not to say exercise is harmful, I work out myself, but

physical strength once directly signalled survival ability and resource acquisition. Today we imitate that signal without it being tied to resources, which creates more friction than people realize. Mate selection becomes less efficient: a modern man who wants to attract a partner often needs both resource potential and a strong physique to satisfy older less-adapted desires, meaning he must optimize rather than simply live. The man who focuses only on physique may attract easily when young but sacrifices time that could build long-term stability; the man who focuses only on resources may secure stability yet lose to someone who invested more in appearance; and the man who does both likely sees the most success but at the cost of time, including time with the very person he hopes to attract. Something is lost in every path. This does not mean the adaptation is bad or should be discarded, it may be necessary in large-scale societies, but entropy remains regardless.

Revisiting my previous examples, we can see the Adaptive Entropy as follows: in sports, we replicate primal competition and dominance hierarchies while minimizing serious injury or death, yet what is lost are existential stakes, victory no longer determines territory, survival, or lineage, so competition becomes symbolic and identity can inflate around outcomes without material consequence. In social media, we mimic tribal validation and status signalling in a virtual arena, but embodied presence and

accountability erode, turning reputation into quantifiable metrics detached from lived contribution. In hustle culture, ambition and upward striving are emulated through mental exertion rather than physical struggle, and the entropy appears in the abstraction of effort from necessity, busyness replaces survival value, and exhaustion no longer guarantees tangible security. In virtual reality, exploration and danger are simulated without real-world cost, and the absence of irreversible consequence strips courage and discovery of some gravity, because nothing essential is truly at stake.

Once a means becomes identity, it can't stop

Another aspect of modern Adaptive Imitation lies in the pursuit of intelligence. People often strive for wisdom, believing that increased knowledge will grant them control over their lives, their environment, and their destiny. Yet, the desire to be smarter is rarely about wisdom itself. Instead, it is about gaining an advantage over life's inherent uncertainties rooted in a past environment. Intelligence, in this sense, becomes a tool of the ego, an instrument of self-interest rather than a path to higher understanding.

As if people truly want to be smarter, what they really want is intelligence as a means to an end. The end is never something inherently wise or intelligent in itself; it's simply a logical benefit to the individual that may or may not

benefit them and others. While the outcome may seem rational, it's not a reflection of wisdom. There's still a pervasive idea in the modern world that intelligence somehow enhances morality within a group. But all intelligence does is amplify instinct or the ideas that drive it.

Consider a world where rationality is the sole guide, and meaning is purely human-made, with the universe simply a chaotic expanse we try to impose order on (somehow proven). In this world, rationality would imply the absence of any god or higher authority, leaving only pure ego. If everyone defends their own ego, a system of individualism emerges, where mutual assured destruction is possible, limited by access to personal 'upgrades'. Now, imagine an aging man, weakened by time, who uses rationality to suppress his fading moral compass. In a society on the brink of collapse, he's faced with the choice of dying from decay or social collapse. In this world he knows there is no afterlife, his desire to survive outweighs his moral instincts, so he manipulates others and uses technology to prolong his life. This outcome may seem immoral, but it reveals that rationality, like money, is simply a tool, it amplifies human desire, without an inherent moral compass. Perhaps something spiritual prevents such outcomes, but that's a belief, not a rational certainty, and rationality tends to dismiss beliefs, even if they may be vital for survival.

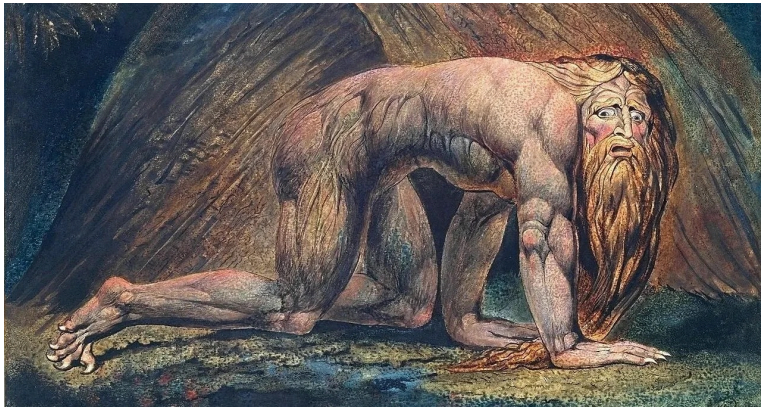
To seek the upper hand on the universe is to seek it over ourselves

Nietzsche's idea that art is naturally life-affirming can be true, but only in its original environment or a close emulation of it. Imagine art being used primarily to foster community, prevent chaos, and communicate beyond the verbal. In this setting, art is a tool that affirms life. However, if art is then repurposed for other goals, it becomes affirming of the environment, not the life within it. You could argue that art's meaning could be semantically pinned to something that impacts people, but even with that definition, art can still be manipulated by the environment for its own ends.

Consider art created by people trapped within a system who believe their work will have an impact. And it does, but only in the system's favour, not in favour of life. This system could eventually lead those within it toward extinction. We tend to see the villain in everyone except ourselves. The labels of good and evil, and the biases they carry, add up over time, creating conflict between those who don't share the same interests.

Ludwig Klages & the Optimization of Meaninglessness

A Theory of The Present, Temporal Swaps, and Temporal Theory



In this chapter, I build on the work of Ludwig Klages, examining his conception of the present moment and extending it into a broader framework. From this foundation, I introduce *Temporal Swaps* and *Temporal Theory*, concepts that describe how environments preserving familiar cues while altering expected outcomes can erode meaning and agency at a societal level.

Lived Time (Lebenszeit): The immediate, qualitative flow of life as it is directly experienced; rhythmic, continuous, and indivisible, inseparable from feeling, movement, and vitality, and not measurable or reducible to discrete units.

Abstract Time (Geist): The conceptual, quantitative construction of time produced by intellect; linear, divisible, and spatialized, imposed upon life for purposes of control, calculation, and prediction, and inherently hostile to lived experience.

Klages' Present: The living now as an experienced continuity rather than a temporal point; a flowing presence that can't be isolated, measured, or precisely defined without collapsing into contradiction, existing only as lived immediacy and disappearing the moment it is treated as an object of thought.

I find Klages' diagnosis of Geist interfering with Lebenszeit valid; however, his conclusion about the present seems fundamentally flawed, and this is where we diverge. Klages employs circular reasoning. He attempts to claim that mathematical abstraction is separate from lived experience, yet he uses mathematical reasoning to prove it, a move that is already questionable. For example, he argues that the present can't be quantified. While it may contain contradictions from a mathematical perspective, this assumes that mathematics maps perfectly onto reality in the first place. One can have a defined temporal window without relying on mathematics. Klages assumes that beginnings and ends are real and that perfect circles can exist. From this perspective, there may be other ways to

define or 'quantify' the present, just not in the traditional mathematical sense.

By assuming that the present can't be quantified and that abstraction is always bad, Klages ends up worshiping and romanticizing non-abstracted life. This may be inspiring or beneficial as a critique, but he can't guarantee it, given the circularity in his reasoning. Klages then falls into the same form of conceptual worship that I outline in the Max Stirner series of chapters - 1.2. A clear example of Klages' paradox is this: he seeks to return from Geist to a fully life-affirming existence, rich in present experience, tradition, and ritual, where reason is merely a tool rather than a master. Yet fully embracing ritual requires evading reason, which opens the door for others to manipulate ritual for power. In attempting to escape Geist, he risks recreating it, revealing the structural instability of his suggestions.

Given current population levels, it seems nearly impossible that Klages' vision of a Geistless society could avoid descending into chaos. A population of this scale appears to require Geist to coordinate, stabilize, and sustain itself; removing it after it has already snowballed through institutions, technology, and global systems could risk total catastrophe. Klages might reply: *Geist was Pandora's box, once opened, its self-destruction became inevitable. Now it is only a matter of time.*

Even so, why concede so easily? To declare ultimate defeat is not neutral, it narrows the horizon of survival. If Geist truly carries destructive potential, resignation only accelerates the very outcome it predicts. You are letting Geist win.

I extend the Kantian view of reality by proposing a different image: imagine the world outside the mind as a continuous data stream, vibrating at varying frequencies throughout the universe in a manner consistent with Einsteinian time dilation. You are not separate from this stream but embedded within it, constantly interacting with it. The mind governs available movement (appendages), and through action it can modify the very data stream in which it exists. This raises the question of how the stream is received in the first place such that action becomes possible. I propose that consciousness arises when a living system, constrained by matter and energy, evolves a finite *Temporal Window* in which it samples internal and external data, categorizes that data for survival, simulates possible futures, and selectively intervenes in the universal data stream; subjective time, on this account, is the rate at which this control loop operates.

This chapter proposes that two primary clocks operate in the universe: one embedded in the 'external' data stream with which consciousness interacts, and another that exists internally within consciousness itself.

Universal Clock: The objective ordering and rate of physical processes determined by spacetime and thermodynamic constraints, governing how change unfolds independently of perception, and measured indirectly through stable, repeatable phenomena such as atomic transitions, decay rates, and relativistic proper time.

Temporal Window: The biologically evolved integration span through which an organism samples, predicts, and binds change into a lived present, determining the density of experience, the felt speed of time, and the subjective continuity of past, present, and future.

The present is thus proposed to be the Temporal Window: the biological flow through which we experience the ongoing data stream of the external world, operating entirely within the larger frame of the Universal Clock.

Youth: In early life, time appears to pass more slowly.

Flow State: Periods of intense focus compress the Temporal Window, making time feel as though it moves faster, captured by the phrase "time flies when you're having fun".

Boredom: When boredom sets in, time appears to stall and moments seem to stretch endlessly; in this state, the perceived clock is not merely illusory but functionally slowing down, as time itself moves more slowly relative to the Universal Clock due to a change in the individual's Temporal Window.

A defined present that operates purely on biological hardwiring and immediate input data is vulnerable to deception, as seen in the dog that runs for a toy only to find it hidden behind its owner's back. While the mind can sometimes detect such tricks, it often can't, and social structures built around promised ends can exploit this vulnerability by hijacking neural expectations and delivering outcomes that diverge from what the brain was conditioned to anticipate. When a mind attempts to map sensory input and memory to a specific action under a given set of conditions, only for the expected result to be abruptly withdrawn, meaning collapses, so long as the individual remains unaware of the deception.

Temporal Swap: A condition in which an agent operating exclusively in the present relies on past-encoded models (memory, instinct, learned patterns) to guide action, while the external environment has been altered in ways that preserve familiar cues but change outcome structures, causing behaviour to remain internally coherent yet externally ineffective. Because awareness and adaptation themselves depend on feedback from outcomes, the agent does not recognize the change and is unable to generate a valid response, resulting in confusion, paralysis, or self-defeating persistence.

Temporal Theory: A theoretical framework asserting that persistent declines in agency, orientation, and felt meaning arise from the accumulation and duration of Temporal Swaps within an agent's environment. As Temporal Swaps multiply or remain unresolved, action–outcome coherence erodes without triggering corrective awareness, causing agents to continue behaving rationally within invalid contexts. The theory holds that meaning diminishes not from hardship or change itself, but from sustained exposure to Temporal Swaps that render causality unreadable, adaptation inaccessible, and purposeful action increasingly impossible.

Temporal Swaps differ fundamentally from Adaptive Imitation: Adaptive Imitation has an end, and that end is known, even if the outcome is imperfect, it remains close

enough to the expectation to sustain follow-through. One can think of Adaptive Imitation as a witch who lures you into her house with the promise of a cookie and ultimately gives it to you, whereas a Temporal Swap is a witch who leads you inside and offers nothing in return, leaving you disoriented within a new environment. Within Temporal Theory, Adaptive Imitation can preserve meaning, while Temporal Swaps can only extinguish it. A tendency of the modern age is to address clearly dangerous Temporal Swaps by fixing the smoke rather than the fire. As the fire continues to grow, the solutions become little more than duct tape, temporary patches that often increase overall meaning-entropy (Adaptive Entropy).

Parenting & Accelerating Social Change: Parents attempt to teach their children but can't keep pace as rapidly changing, abstraction-driven realities outstrip the stability required for intergenerational transmission. Meaning erodes, and parent–child relationships grow increasingly fragmented.

Debt-Based Ownership: Credit and leverage allow individuals to claim ownership over homes, cars, and lifestyles that remain contingent on debt and unstable income streams. Signals of provision and stability become increasingly abstract, obscuring whether resources are durable or merely financed. The mating path tied to material security becomes fragile as apparent status can collapse with interest rates, employment shifts, or credit withdrawal, making genuine long-term provision harder to distinguish from temporary display. This opens the door for many short term male mating strategies that can destroy Moral Overlay.

Podcast Consumption: Podcasts increasingly substitute direct social participation and communal life. Repeated listening and passive engagement recreate feelings of companionship and intellectual involvement without reciprocal interaction or material participation in the world itself. Individuals adapt to social fragmentation by imitating companionship through parasocial familiarity and informational repetition, fulfilling social needs while further displacing face-to-face interaction and grounded communal continuity.

Corporate Careers: Effort, loyalty, and competence continue to signal progress while advancement, stability, and reward increasingly decouple from performance.

Higher Education: Studying, grading, and credential accumulation persist as indicators of future success while labour-market outcomes no longer reliably follow.

Social Media Engagement: Instinctive responses to approval and visibility cues persist even as these signals fail to produce lasting connection, status, or meaning.

Friendship & Economic Optimization: Bonds that once formed through shared survival, cooperation, and long-term proximity erode as economic mobility and optimization reshape social life. Stable communal ties give way to transient, utility-driven relationships organized around work, opportunity, and relocation, fragmenting continuity and producing recurring breaks in meaning and belonging. Simply put, friends of youth rarely last longer than economic need.

Political Participation: Voting, discourse, and civic engagement continue as rituals of agency while policy outcomes remain largely invariant to participation.

Mental Health Self-Help: Introspection, insight, and emotional literacy increase without corresponding leverage over external conditions or life outcomes.

Financial Planning: Saving, long-term planning, and 'responsible behaviour' persist while macroeconomic shifts invalidate expected futures.

Customer Service Systems: Escalation rituals and support pathways exist symbolically without reliable access to human resolution or corrective authority.

Sexual Norms & Social Reprogramming: Cultural messaging reshapes masculine and feminine ideals faster than underlying patterns of attraction evolve, producing a widening gap between socially prescribed behaviour and biologically favoured traits. Individuals increasingly perform strategic roles, timidity, independence, dominance, deference, not as expressions of self but as calculated responses to conflicting signals, turning intimacy from spontaneous alignment into tactical negotiation. Male–female dynamics lose natural flow as sustaining attraction requires increasing deliberation, producing more calculated romantic 'games'.

Thought Itself: Analysis, critique, and recursive self-examination persist as rituals of intellectual agency while cognition detaches from embodied constraint and generational stakes, culminating in Nihilism as meaning is dissolved without replacement.

A drive severed from completion spirals

I believe Temporal Swaps explain the general meaninglessness of our current world. Through the desire extraction I describe later in chapter 6.4, we can see a system optimized for meaninglessness itself. By optimizing for desire, the system delivers desire without the ends people were biologically trained to expect, while simultaneously extending that desire for as long as possible. In essence, the current structure increases Temporal Swaps by design. If this were a stable system, one not permanently locked in a state of pull, it might eventually settle, allowing people to adapt through a kind of selective evolution of governance. Instead, its defining feature is continuous movement and continuous pull.

In a primitive sense, a tribe member's desire for dominance would, over time, lead to increased social connections and a deeper social understanding. If dominance, or the feeling of dominance is granted immediately, it may undermine the very biological reason that desire exists. We often assume that a desire has only one goal: its own fulfillment.

But that assumption reflects a modern tendency to worship awareness and the conscious mind, not what actually benefits the individual. Desire is often only the spark that sets a being on a path. Following that path may reshape the physical or mental environment of the individual, preparing the ground for future desires or shifts in perception. When a desire is satisfied immediately, there is no guarantee that the intermediate processes, those that might have produced beneficial conditions for future action, have not been skipped.

In a modern sense, I am tired at work so I buy coffee. I don't want to wake up, but I don't return to sleep, I set the alarm ten minutes later. I don't seek a romantic partner through presence and risk; I use a dating app that pulls on my desire for constant validation while avoiding entanglement in presence itself. Markets satisfy my desire to be part of a social contract, yet that contract is filled with too many barriers to truly participate. The result is a perpetual 'American Dream', kept alive as an aspiration, but deferred indefinitely so long as the promise itself remains profitable. Temporal paths constantly halted early. Taken together, this forms a cobweb of pulling: a pulling away from the conditions individuals were trained under, a pulling apart of their being, not as an accident but as a designed, constant extraction, one that depends on the masses not fully seeing it, extracting as much value as possible without notice.

Another example: suppose the body is oriented toward parenthood. After a certain point, through reproductive cues or even simply age, the body anticipates being a parent and begins to act accordingly for the success of offspring. It demands more meaning-seeking, heightened fear sensitivity, and greater resource acquisition. Remove the actual child, whether through reproductive-preventive technology or social structures that centralize control over family assets, and that biological framework is displaced. Rather than roles that need no labeling, such as 'father' or 'mother', one attaches to titles like 'PhD', 'CEO', 'philosopher', or 'teacher'. Instead of acquiring resources to be passed on to offspring, resource acquisition becomes an end in itself.

This is not to say that such transfers of meaning can't be productive or even indirectly reproductive, but when social structures eliminate the primary mechanism that enables adaptation and long-term continuity, a built-in survival safeguard against our overly simplistic collective desires, meaning begins to fragment. What follows is not necessarily Nihilism itself, but a sharp rise in its presence as a topic of concern and discussion.

If children ran philosophy, do you really think Nihilism would arise? Would Nihilism even exist as a concept? A child's decisions are grounded in relationship, your presence, your protection, just as your safety is grounded in

a relationship with governance, community and the greater physical environment. You may say, "They are children; they are not living in the real world". But their world is no less real than yours. How are you any different? The only difference is that their rules are made of flesh, while yours are made of abstraction interacting with the physical. You are not unlike a child; you are simply placed in a new environment that permits more, or less, expression.

Stable Structural Underlays do not require the complete absence of Temporal Swaps or Adaptive Imitation. However, if the goal is a Structural Underlay that channels human meaning beyond pure survival instinct, then reducing Temporal Swaps and limiting Adaptive Entropy becomes desirable. Such a structure, I believe, would produce the greatest felt freedom, rather than mere fulfillment of immediate desires. Over time, excessive Temporal Swaps can slowly erode the Structural Underlay itself, making social predictability unstable. Reducing Adaptive Entropy, however, is not primarily functional, it is meaning-preserving. Where I likely differ from thinkers such as Klages and Simone Weil (mentioned in the next section) is that I do not believe Temporal Swaps and Adaptive Imitation are always harmful, especially when considering the scale of modern societies.

An example can be seen in a person susceptible to retaliatory violence. One could argue that violence

prevention is itself a Temporal Swap. Someone experiences an action that elicits the impulse toward violence, yet fear of legal consequences or the presence of a Moral Overlay restrains them. The feeling remains unresolved; the Temporal Loop is not closed. An individual such as Max Stirner, who values complete egoistic autonomy, might argue that this is inherently damaging or controlling. I might instead say that it produces a momentary pocket of meaninglessness, though I do not moralize that meaninglessness. As societies scale, they create environments in which not all Temporal Swaps can be eliminated without producing consequences that would not appear along the original temporal path. For instance, if violence were legalized, it could easily shatter the Moral Overlay that currently restrains it.

Another clear example of negative consequences from removing a Temporal Swap occurs when that swap is part of a larger Temporal Swap. A temporal path may require a meaningless feeling simply so that a particular outcome can unfold later. If you remove this smaller subset Temporal Swap, you may also disrupt the larger structure it supports. In doing so, you are effectively creating a new Temporal Swap by removing the old one. While this may produce short-term stability in structural meaning, the absence of that moment of meaninglessness can allow a deeper, more pervasive meaninglessness to reemerge, much like how

rejecting Geist, as Klages argued, can paradoxically reintroduce it.

A day or so after writing this piece, I came across Simone Weil, who appears to arrive at a similar conclusion. I still believe the concepts are distinct enough to justify keeping this chapter as written. That said, I think Weil's framing overgeneralizes and over-intellectualizes the problem, and for that reason can be dangerous. What follows are her main ideas:

Affliction (Malheur): Suffering that destroys a person's ability to expect resolution in time, not just pain but the collapse of future orientation.

Attention: Sustained openness to what is present without forcing outcome, reward, or interpretation.

Force: Any mechanism that turns a person from an acting subject into a passive thing, often without physical violence.

Decreation: The withdrawal of the self from being the center through which all meaning and reward must pass.

Necessity: Impersonal structures (work, gravity, systems) that operate regardless of intention or justice.

Rootedness: Stable participation in a temporal and social order where effort reliably settles.

Uprootedness: Existence inside structures where effort continues but no longer resolves.

Waiting: Time endured without guarantees, where meaning is not manufactured or promised in advance.

She is too general: abstraction, repetition, and endurance are not meaningless in themselves. Working for money and exchanging it for goods closes a temporal loop and can fully sustain meaning. Meaninglessness arises only when reward timing and resolution are structurally misaligned, when effort is required but payoff is deferred, substituted, or never allowed to settle (Temporal Swap). What Weil treats as a broad condition of affliction is, more precisely, a Temporal Swap where the mapping of effort to reward breaks.

This assessment can become dangerous in its moral ambition. If people both require meaning and also require abstract structures, whether they acknowledge them or not, to sustain that meaning, then a "throwing the baby out with the bathwater" problem emerges. If meaning depends on certain games being played, you can't assume that discarding those games will automatically restore meaning. This returns us to the Max Stirner 'opt-in, opt-out' problem: everyone wants the freedom to step in and

out of life's structures. But if removing those structures changes nothing materially while stripping people of the meaning they already have, why force them out of their functional Matrix only to leave them with none at all?

The Intelligence of the Irrational

To Trust One's Own Mind Is to Bet Against Its Survival



Modern discourse treats intelligence as synonymous with rational abstraction. Even contemporary expansions that add emotional intelligence or social intelligence leave this hierarchy intact. Awareness remains central. Reflection remains supreme. Reason becomes the prestige of cognition itself.

This chapter does not argue that concepts like IQ are incomplete, nor does it merely expand the category to include additional conscious faculties. That move still centers awareness. Instead, it questions whether the cultural definition and status of intelligence are rooted in guaranteed benefit for the goals people assume it serves.

What follows distinguishes between *Reasoned Intelligence*, meaning reflective and abstract optimization, and a broader structural understanding of intelligence as alignment with operative incentive structures relative to

environment and reference scale. This does not imply abandoning reason. It clarifies its position. It also raises a structural question: can consciousness guarantee that what benefits it is fully intelligible?

Men often rate themselves as more attractive than they objectively are. From a purely rational standpoint, this looks like miscalibration, even stupidity. An outside observer might call it delusion. Yet that overconfidence alters behaviour: he approaches more, signals assurance, hesitates less, and confidence itself increases perceived attractiveness. So is he foolish?

By contemporary definitions of intelligence, accuracy, self-awareness, reasoned calibration, yes. But if intelligence is measured relative to the achievement of one's biological goal, the answer changes. He may be lower in reflective, reasoned intelligence, yet higher in raw, goal-aligned intelligence. He is inaccurate, unreasonable, yet effective. Biology overrides abstract reason, and in doing so, sometimes outperforms it.

Intelligence: The degree to which a system's behaviour aligns with and conforms to the operative incentive structure of its environment across time, relative to a specified reference scale.

Love distorts perception, softens judgment, and drives people to act in ways that appear irrational, even reckless.

Under contemporary definitions of intelligence, self-control, calibration, emotional detachment, love often looks like a liability. It clouds reason, overrides cost-benefit analysis, and alters behaviour in ways that seem inefficient. Yet love is one of biology's most powerful mechanisms for bonding, reproduction, and long-term offspring survival.

The rational individual who avoids love may appear more intelligent by modern standards, prioritizing stability, career, or strategic optimization. But if reason evolved, at least in part, to support survival and procreation, what happens when rationality consistently avoids one of its core functions? Who is truly more intelligent, the one who overuses reason to escape love, or the one who surrenders to it and fulfills the deeper biological aim? This reveals the strangeness of our current definition of intelligence, it smuggles in the assumption that awareness is supreme, elevating conscious calibration above all else and treating heightened self-awareness as its ultimate measure.

You may think we already have the word *wise*, a term broad enough to capture understanding beyond narrow, hyper-focused calculation. But try calling the individuals above 'wise' and notice your reaction. Something resists. I would argue that our current sense of wisdom already smuggles in awareness as a prerequisite: to be wise, one must be conscious, deliberate, reflective. Yet what proves effective is not always what is most aware.

Socrates asserts that awareness of one's own ignorance is wisdom. The common quote goes:

The only true wisdom is in knowing you know nothing

I argue that Socrates falls short the moment he claims totality. As shown earlier, awareness itself does not always lead to benefit. Simply recognizing ignorance guarantees nothing. As such, either wisdom must be redefined at the level of definition, or the underlying assumption itself must be revised.

Imagine this: Socrates walks into a bar and notices his overconfident twin brother, someone who doesn't worship awareness. Socrates tells the woman, "I know nothing", with a playful smirk, while his twin brother, wearing the same expression, insists, "I know everything". Socrates mocks his conceited behaviour, pointing out that his brother isn't truly wise and lacks a real understanding of his external world. Yet the girl chooses the brother, not Socrates. So what does Socrates blame? Does he try to step outside his own awareness and imitate confidence? But memory makes it difficult to move in and out of awareness at will. In the end, Socrates is left realizing that within this situation, his own awareness, imperfect as it is, has made him the less effective man.

Understanding the world doesn't necessarily mean you can act effectively within it. And what is understanding after

all, but a tool biology uses for effectiveness, just as ignorance can sometimes serve the same purpose. You may think this is trivial, but consider what happens if we artificially amplify our reasoning ability through implants or the external technologies we already rely on. Push reason far enough and you approach the death of intelligence as lived experience, replaced by pure reasoned intelligence and awareness where beneficial action becomes a gamble against human will and the universe's fixed constraints, like the assumed speed of light.

In increasing reason you open Pandora's box: you study the stars and extract a brief fading burst of meaning through analysis, only to extinguish a deeper meaning once found. Did that truly benefit you if you can't reach them, and even if you could, knowing they would only burn you? If you think it did then you are still worshipping power, what you believe grants control, awareness and reason themselves. I say: fine, do as you wish, but it offers no guarantee of individual benefit.

Intuition still presupposes awareness: I have an intuition, I possess something, and I act upon it.

When people think of intuition, they often assume its end goal is truth or rational clarity. A mathematician might intuitively examine a function's derivative and, from that impulse, uncover a proof. But why must intuition always

serve truth, especially when truth itself doesn't guarantee benefit in every situation?

Perhaps not for every reader, but I want to sketch a generalized view of sexual dynamics: on average, it seems women tend to rely more on intuition romantically than men, and this can shape how romantic situations arise. A woman may say she does her makeup for herself or her friends, and she's right in this example, but by increasing her social attractiveness, she also invites more male attention, placing herself in environments conducive to romance. In this way, intuition can guide her toward these outcomes without requiring a fully conscious intention to seek a partner, and that lack of explicit awareness preserves a kind of plausible deniability, both to others and to herself.

If such intentions were made fully explicit, they might later complicate how she interprets her own behaviour or how a partner perceives it. For example, a protective man may be uncomfortable with the idea of his partner actively seeking attention from other men. Unawareness, then, can serve a dual role: enabling access to romantic opportunities while softening the social and psychological costs attached to them. If one elevates strict, reasoned awareness above all else, some of these dynamics may weaken, and while technology may eventually compensate for such shifts and

present them as improvements, overall well-being may not necessarily increase and could remain flat or even decline.

The debate on this topic between the general online populations of men and women is even more revealing. Men tend to hold the view that women wear makeup or dress up primarily for men. Women, on the other hand, are adamant that this is not the case. I would argue that both sides are treating reasoned awareness as the only legitimate form of intelligence, while ignoring a more raw, goal-oriented intelligence that goes unspoken. In doing so, they assume that any goal must always be consciously recognized and justified through reasoning, and that reasoning itself must be the sole acceptable path to achieving it. The man thinks:

If a woman has a biological goal, then she must be aware of it, otherwise, she's lying

Why must a human be fully aware of a biological goal, and why assume that awareness is the only tool biology uses to pursue it? This kind of claim is often made by men who act in the same way, approaching women on the street with a confidence that isn't as rational as it seems. You may argue that reason can achieve the goal of finding an eager woman by approaching many at once, and perhaps it works, but at what cost? Once you enter that frame, the opposite sex becomes a set of numbers to optimize. How

do you leave that frame afterward? What kind of woman agrees to whatever you are pushing for? You have been given a technique that may reach a biologically rewarded end, but in doing so it risks reducing love to little more than a rationalized expression of biology fulfilling partial ends.

Replace biological processes with fully intelligible ones, and you begin to see the shift: what was once a kind of dance becomes something that refuses the dance altogether. And because this shift is unintelligible to most, it operates silently, almost invisibly, as it unravels things from within. I'm not claiming the following statement is true, nor even that it can be quantified well enough to be proven true; I'm simply trying to reveal the cultural attitude toward reason, and its elevation to something like worship:

Women are more irrational than men

This kind of statement, today, or at any point in the past half-century, would almost certainly provoke immediate pushback, and while that reaction may arise more strongly from women given the current divide between the sexes, the fact that it provokes any reaction at all suggests something deeper: why is irrational behaviour assumed to be negative in the first place? If it can fulfill biological aims just as effectively as reason, why does the mere suggestion

unsettle people? Hypothetically, if women tend, on average, to act more intuitively in alignment with those aims and do not elevate reason as the sole valid means, then why must moments of irrationality be condemned? From a biological perspective, such behaviour could be seen as a form of freedom, a lack of constraint rather than a failure, which raises the more uncomfortable question of who the real fools are; perhaps, in this framing, it is men.

What you tend to call foolish, I call intelligence. Where you divide actions by reasoned effectiveness, I see a desire for power, a need to justify yourself as a reasoned individual. Where you see the young man's arrogance as stupidity, I see an effective impulse toward creation. Where you see the young woman's fixation on appearance as vanity, I see a hidden longing to be seen, the creation of life. Where you see the cognitively deficient as lacking, I see life propagating beyond reason, carrying a joy that reason itself can extinguish. The individual has been increasingly atomized, reduced to a single dimension: cognition alone.

Reason binds reality to its focus

Reason itself can become a Guiding Agent because of its reality-altering characteristics. For modern humans, reasoning typically requires a certain gradient of tuning out the external world. It involves not only isolating attention but also hyper-focusing on a specific problem, which often

pushes broader perception of the surrounding world into the background, or attempts to fit it into the small window of reasoned focus. It follows that if many people are constantly engaged in intense reasoning, it becomes more difficult to perceive reality with a wider more integrated awareness.

This dynamic can be especially influential for individuals with highly developed reasoning ability, who would otherwise be the most capable of escaping the influence of such a Guiding Agent. If such individuals are continually directed to reason within particular frameworks or structures, their attention remains occupied within those bounds rather than turning reason toward life itself. In modern society, highly reasoned individuals often stop seeing reason merely as a tool and instead incorporate it into their identity. This is understandable, people tend to continue doing what they are rewarded for, and eventually it becomes part of who they are. As a result, it can become difficult for highly rational individuals to step outside the confines of reasoning, which in turn makes reason an even stronger potential Guiding Agent.

I am also a victim of reason's tendency to extrapolate a focused concern into a complete view of life. For example, in chapter 6.2, A Case for The Rapture & Simulation Hypothesis, my reasoning at the time was heavily oriented toward stability and longevity, reflecting the opposite state

of the world as I perceived it. From that focus, I developed a theory that might explain our universe, at least as bounded by our lived experiential layer, through a framework centered on longevity. What are the odds that reasoning shaped by my focus at the time is truly correct? I'm being pulled. As such, reasoning itself is always biased by its focal length.

To be fair to myself, I present it as a theory rather than reality, yet my reasoning still extended its immediate focus into a broader interpretation of reality itself.

What makes reason an even stronger potential Guiding Agent is the feedback loop it creates with power. Consider the idea of using reason as a tool, what would that actually require? To use reason reliably, one would first need to reason and then set it aside; in other words, using reason instrumentally would require surrendering reasoned awareness after employing it, allowing only instinct to awaken reason once needed again. It would resemble a continual cycle of willingly entering states of 'sleep' and awakening.

This raises an interesting point about those who treat reason as part of their identity rather than merely a tool: it suggests they tend to value control, because someone comfortable surrendering control would also be willing to enter periods of unreasoned or instinctive action. In

leadership roles, however, where constant reasoning is expected, it becomes difficult to treat reason as a tool, abandoning it even briefly risks losing authority. Once power enters the picture, reason becomes a double-edged sword, often drawing or producing individuals who fear losing control; societies with high reliance on reason tends to coincide with a strong desire for control. Reasoned control can better guide a culture to an Attainable Singularity. Reason worship also tends to reinforce its own confidence:

Reason must be right. Reason is a powerful tool, so it must be the highest means of reaching any goal. Everyone's goals must be reasoned goals. If I can reason it out, then I must not be getting fooled.

Reasoned Intelligence excels where incentive structures are visible and computationally manageable. It can simulate outcomes, compare alternatives, and refine strategies. Within stable systems, it is highly effective. This book does not suggest discarding reason. It enables coordination at scale and the refinement of complex institutions. The concern lies elsewhere. When rational abstraction becomes culturally sacralized, it can turn into a status game. Intelligence becomes equated with visible reasoning performance. To be intelligent is to demonstrate abstraction.

Reasoned Intelligence: The capacity for conscious, abstract modelling and logical optimization within an incentive structure, using reflective awareness to pursue defined goals.

That elevation does not guarantee that the goals being optimized are aligned with deeper incentive structures. By attaching intelligence to reason and then elevating intelligence socially, it becomes possible to worship forms of reasoning that do not produce long-term personal benefit. Reason becomes an object of reverence. I would argue that calling Reasoned Intelligence simply 'intelligence' is similar to calling brute strength 'intelligence'. Once brute strength was outcompeted by reasoning ability, the definition of intelligence silently shifted, moving from physical capability to reason as the dominant measure, with the word 'intelligence' itself being redefined accordingly. In linguistic terms, this phenomenon is known as conceptual drift.

The hidden pain of today mocks the open wounds of the past, deepening its own

I am not moralizing either brute strength or reasoned intelligence; I am simply attempting to analyze cultural shifts. When power comes from brute strength, it is unfortunate for physically weaker individuals, but at least that power remains in the physical world, it is visible, easy

to recognize, and can change hands relatively quickly. When reasoned intelligence begins to outperform brute strength however, power becomes more abstract and less visible, and what it creates can sometimes work against its own creator. One example is the use of Temporal Swaps to achieve outcomes that brute force might once have produced directly. A simple way to observe this is to look for situations where people behave in ways they would strongly resist if the same outcome were asked of them directly; in such cases, reasoned intelligence is often doing work that force or clear concentual understanding itself could not easily accomplish.

You will get bit trying to control a dog by the collar, all you need is the ball

In chapter 3.2 I referred to these mechanisms as *Moral Veils* or *Machiavellian Abstractions*. They occur when actions a society would normally reject become acceptable once they are hidden within an abstract system. For example, a society may reject theft, yet when loss is concealed within mathematics it becomes acceptable, this is essentially what happens with lotteries. One might argue that lotteries provide the thrill of playing, but by that logic one could also argue there is a thrill in being robbed. You may say it's more like a person asking to be robbed, but is that really the majority?

Another example is sex work or the rise of OnlyFans in the West. Sexual assault is considered wrong, yet when the interaction is framed through the abstraction of money it can suddenly be labeled consensual and even socially tolerated to some extent. The outcome can resemble what brute force once produced, and at times at bigger scale, but it is now hidden within abstraction to make it socially digestible. Is it considered assault when someone is under the influence of alcohol, but not when they are under the influence of abstraction?

You might argue that there is consent between the service and the provider, but do you really think the provider fully understands the economics of money in most cases? Can they grasp that money is ultimately a social contract, one that can shift or collapse at any moment? Can they see the hidden potential centralization and inflation traps that make their lifestyle more expensive, possibly pushing them toward such services? Some might respond that they should have known better. But given this evolving definition of intelligence, I would argue that's no different from saying someone should have been stronger for being a victim of physical assault. The only difference is that the harm is now mental instead of physical, and the moral judgment has shifted accordingly. And yet we often look back and say the Romans were brutal for spectacles like the Colosseum. I am not arguing that the past was 'better', nor that modernity is 'better'. In many cases, brutality has

simply shifted from the physical to the mental without notice.

Furthermore, under modern morality, most people would view forcibly separating romantic partners or families as deeply immoral in almost any circumstance; yet, once abstraction is introduced, it becomes permissible. Instead of direct coercion, you manifest a culture of infidelity or create economic conditions framed as 'necessity', and the same separation occurs without triggering moral resistance. In this way, outcomes that would be condemned in concrete form are accepted in abstract form. At the same time, a strong emphasis on awareness and reasoned intelligence leads to the dismissal of those with intuitive reasoning, even though their perspectives may help prevent systemic decline.

Those with high intuition but lower analytical framing lose the ability to clearly identify what they perceive as immoral, as everything becomes mediated through abstraction. While this structure may function during periods of stability, potentially preventing overcorrection, it can become harmful when conditions are unstable, as the lack of clear moral grounding allows deterioration to go unchecked.

Consent stands on unconsented ground

I'm going to give a deliberately simplified view of sexual dynamics again to illustrate an idea, so allow some leeway. If women tend to value attention as a proxy for provision, and thus survival, while industries like pornography directly target male sexual desire, then the women who receive the greatest share of attention will often be those who emulate what that system rewards. Since businesses are fundamentally driven to optimize for profit, sufficiently strong demand will not only pull men toward it but, in this case, also shape female behaviour in response. If this dynamic grows large enough culturally, it can lead to an overvaluation of forms of intimacy that mirror the casual, detached patterns found in pornography. Family structures however, tend to operate differently: while they may begin with short-term passion, biology eventually interrupts that state of desire, introducing an instinctual sense of duty once a child is born. In effect people can be drawn away from stable family formation or healthier long-term relationships under the abstract justification of 'consent' and 'freedom'. I never consented to the instinct that compels me to eat, yet I'm told my consent is meaningful only within the very framework that necessity forces me to participate in.

We punish result and pardon cause

Then consider a couple that enters a relationship or starts a family. Economic abstraction can create the appearance of

stability while, in practice, requiring both partners to work so much that they rarely see each other. Increased workloads and rising costs introduce sustained stress, and under such pressure, biology can begin to erode romantic attachment, pushing individuals, often unconsciously, toward seeking novelty or relief. People tend to bond with those who are most present and attentive, so attachments shift toward proximity: a wife may find provision, stability, and attention in her boss, while a man may find respect and validation in a subordinate.

Through abstraction, this dynamic can recreate outcomes similar to direct interference, yet it remains framed as voluntary or 'consensual'. From the woman's perspective, stress fractures the relationship, and another woman appears outside that stress and draws her partner away; from the man's perspective, economic necessity introduces a new male presence into his partner's life, someone not burdened by the same pressures, and she is pulled away instead. When layered with a normalized culture of infidelity or socially reinforced promiscuity, these shifts become even easier and more frequent.

If the moral justification of consent rests on understanding, and understanding can oppose the biological aim, then consent becomes immoral relative to that biological aim.

Imagine a society that guides procreation through contracts listing potential romantic partners. To ensure fully informed consent, each contract also reveals every influence behind a person's attraction, even influences they never considered, never wanted to know about, and which lose their power once made explicit. The result is that attraction is dampened, sometimes to the point that no partner appears desirable, whereas those same hidden influences might otherwise have faded into the background and allowed a strong bond to form.

Is consent moral here? I would argue that, relative to the biological drive toward pair-bonding and reproduction, it is not. If the moral justification for consent rests on understanding, and that understanding undermines the very conditions under which the biological drive succeeds, then consent becomes immoral relative to that biological aim. Whether the biological aim itself should be treated as a moral standard is a separate question.

Under a structural definition, intelligence must specify its reference scale. A behaviour may be unintelligent relative to individual survival yet intelligent relative to group or lineage survival. For example, some evolutionary theories suggest that homosexual orientation may not directly increase individual reproductive output. However, kin selection models propose that individuals who do not reproduce may increase the survival and success of close

relatives by reducing mating competition or by investing resources in nieces and nephews. In such a framework, a behaviour that appears unintelligent relative to individual reproduction may align with lineage-level incentive structures.

The point here is not to settle evolutionary debates, nor to moralize behaviour. It is to illustrate scale relativity. Under Reasoned Intelligence, actions are often evaluated from the standpoint of the individual optimizer. Each act is judged according to personal goals and explicit reasoning. Yet incentive alignment may operate across levels that exceed the individual's rational frame. Intelligence, in this broader sense, does not collapse into personal calculation. It concerns conformity to operative gradients at the specified scale.

A structural question follows. Can consciousness guarantee that what benefits it can be fully understood by it? Selection operates through differential persistence, not explanation. When rationality becomes an object of worship rather than an instrument within a broader alignment process, it can interact with those underlying structures in ways that are not guaranteed to produce personal or 'collective' benefit.

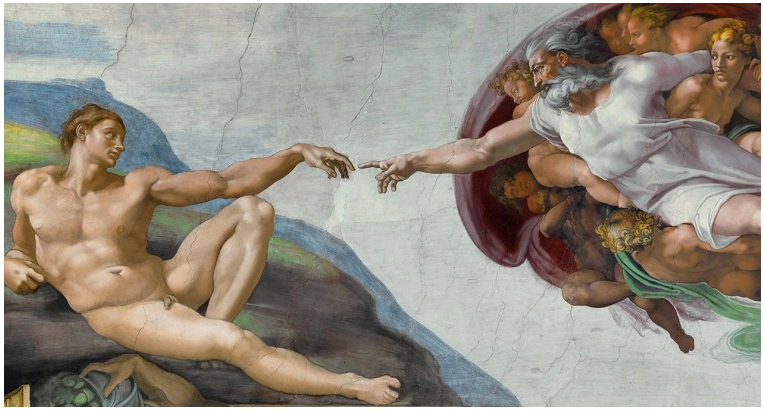
You may finish this chapter thinking that redefining a word so central to modern understanding is dangerous, that simplicity keeps things stable. Exactly, I used reason.

6

Miscellany & Unfinished

Why God Can't Tell Us the Future

Self-Reference, Determinism, and the Limits of Divine Communication



Over the past years, a certain paradox kept coming to mind that I couldn't quite fully unravel. If a system is fully deterministic, then in principle its future should be completely predictable. Yet when that prediction is revealed to an agent within the system, especially one capable of reacting to it, it can invalidate itself. What emerges is not a failure of determinism, but a structural limit on communication. In this chapter, I present a simple thought experiment and develop its implications, ultimately arguing that even an omniscient God can't reliably communicate certain future truths to agents within the universe without risking their falsification.

An external agent, even with perfect knowledge of a system, can't always communicate a prediction about that system in a way that remains true once the system reacts to it.

To understand the argument, we must distinguish between three concepts that are often conflated:

Determinism: The idea that, given a complete state of the universe at a moment in time, all future states follow necessarily from it.

Prediction: A mapping from a current state to a future outcome.

Revealed Prediction: A prediction that is not only computed but communicated to an agent within the system.

The distinction between prediction and revealed prediction is where the paradox emerges.

Consider the following setup: A being exists with complete knowledge of a deterministic universe. This being can perfectly simulate all future states. It decides to send a message to a human that predicts a simple action the human will take in one minute: raising either their left or right hand. The human, upon reading the message, adopts a simple rule:

I will do the opposite of whatever the message says

Now examine the possibilities:

- If the being sends: 'You will raise your right hand' → the human raises their left.
- If the being sends: 'You will raise your left hand' → the human raises their right.

The being, in simulating this, will correctly determine:

- If I send 'right' → outcome = left
- If I send 'left' → outcome = right

Thus, the being has perfect predictive knowledge. Yet no matter what message it sends, the message becomes false.

The paradox does not show that prediction fails. It shows something more precise:

There exist systems in which all outcomes are fully determined and knowable, yet no statement of the form 'you will do X' can be both communicated and remain true

This introduces a crucial distinction:

1. Knowledge can be complete
2. Communication of that knowledge can be structurally constrained

In such systems, truth becomes conditional: *If I say X, then Y will happen.* But can't always be reduced to a stable statement: *Y will happen.*

The failure arises from a specific structure:

1. The prediction concerns an agent within the system

2. The agent receives the prediction

3. The agent's behaviour depends on the prediction

This creates a feedback loop where the prediction becomes part of the cause of the outcome it describes. In these cases, a prediction must satisfy a fixed-point condition: The predicted outcome must remain the same after the prediction is known. When no such fixed point exists, no communicable prediction can be true.

From within the system, this leads to a strong epistemic consequence:

There are true facts about the future that can't be known in a usable or communicable form by agents within the system

This is not due to: lack of information, randomness, or computational limits. But due to: The structure of self-referential interaction.

Now consider the theological extension. Suppose God is: Omniscient (knows all future states), omnipotent (can act within the universe), capable of communicating with humans. From the experiment, it follows: If God communicates a prediction about an agent whose behaviour depends on that prediction, the act of communication becomes part of the causal chain. Thus: God knows what will happen given any message. But the message itself alters what will happen. This yields a constraint:

There may be no message God can send of the form 'you will do X' that remains true after being received

It does not imply: God lacks knowledge, God makes mistakes, the future is indeterminate. It does imply: There are limits on what even an omniscient being can reliably communicate about the future to agents within the system.

From the human perspective, this creates an unavoidable uncertainty: Even if a message comes from a perfect source, one can't guarantee its correctness if the message itself influences the outcome. Thus: Certainty about future-directed divine communication is structurally limited. This is not skepticism rooted in doubt of the source, but in the nature of the system itself.

This leads to the following idea: if there is a God, God may be a liar, perhaps not even by God's own fault. Why do we assume God deserves no sympathy? We treat omnipotence as limitless, but what if it isn't (as shown above), or what if those limits weren't chosen? If God created our world but not God's own, how can we be sure God isn't constrained? In that case, God may be structurally forced to lie, or at least to lie by omission. People often ask why a being with ultimate power would create a world full of suffering, but why assume that God's power is truly without limits?

For example, in *The Brothers Karamazov*, Fyodor Dostoevsky presents through Ivan Karamazov, the idea that even if God exists, a world that permits innocent suffering, especially of children, is morally unacceptable. No future harmony or 'greater good' can justify that pain, so Ivan rejects God's world not by disproving it, but by refusing its moral cost. I suggest instead that a God may exist, or may have existed, with a greater motive, and that fully revealing what is right or wrong could undermine that very purpose, perhaps by necessity or even by design.

If we are God's children, why must God always tell us the truth, especially if that truth could harm us? To demand absolute truth in all cases is, in a sense, to prioritize truth

itself above all else. If you disagree, you may be placing truth in the position of worship.

Do we tell children their artwork is bad, or that their dancing needs work? Do we extend more sympathy to the young than to those of working age? We ease children into the world; we don't impose harsh truth at every moment, nor do we worship truth in our treatment of them. If we did, would it really be beneficial? So why must God be different? Why must scripture be anything more than a tool serving a greater purpose? Why must scripture be true? God may exist, God may be watching, and Scripture may be false, and false by design. I might predict a flood tomorrow or a battle in a few days, but the moment people act on that knowledge, the outcome shifts. What if that calculation is essential, part of sustaining life itself.

By acting in accordance with either God's own goal or what is ultimately best for humanity, God may in fact be bounded, guiding us toward an outcome that direct intervention or full transparency could disrupt.

A Case for The Rapture & Simulation Hypothesis

A Theory of Existence: A Chain of Life-Extending Universes



The central concept is that near the end of their biological lifespan, a species seeking to survive the collapse of their universe might be forced to create simulation, assuming the current speculation about the inevitable end of the universe holds true. By manipulating perception, a species could extend its life, potentially indefinitely, if rule simplification or yet-undiscovered quantum principles make it possible. This approach could allow a species to outlive the original lifespan of their universe.

In this theory, the digital rapture doesn't necessarily imply that individuals are taken to a heaven in the traditional sense; rather, they are transported to another realm as a means of escaping the destruction of their current universe. This could provide a possible explanation for why a species might create a simulation in the first place. However, this theory does not address the origin of the base universe or how it was created. Perhaps, as non-base

layer species, it's simply beyond our understanding or capability to know.

To illustrate the tension, imagine we discover that our universe will end in the next ten years. As a species that instinctively fears death, we would immediately search for a way to survive. But if the universe's collapse means all energy disappears, including us, then the universe itself offers no rescue. The question becomes: How can we convert the remaining energy into more time?

Moving far from gravitational sources would reduce time dilation, but it wouldn't stop the universe's base clock from ticking toward collapse. Instead, a species might redirect its remaining energy toward creating a simulation, using manipulated perception to stretch its subjective experience of time.

We already know that the human mind can alter its perception of time through drugs, dreams, meditation, and altered mental states. Under certain conditions, a single physical minute can feel like a day inside the mind. If a species could engineer this effect technologically, it could create a new, computationally compressed universe, one where perceived time passes far more slowly relative to the real universe.

This leads naturally to a simple recurrence relation for the lifespan of each successive simulated universe:

$$t_i = t_{i-1} \cdot p_{i-1}$$

t_i: The remaining time before collapse inside the current simulation layer

t_{i-1}: The remaining time before collapse in the parent layer

p_{i-1}: The time-dilation factor that the parent layer can impose on the layer below

If we assume there is no manipulation of unknown quantum physics, modern thought would suggest that each layer could lose quality. However, it's also possible that each layer could be compressed and simplified, yet still retain the fundamental building blocks necessary to support conscious beings.

The standard arguments for simulation theory follow from here. The Big Bang might suggest that our universe has already been reduced to simple recurrence relations, with a clear starting point. Light could be seen as the data transfer limit, and our perception of the world might be nothing more than the result of how we render the physical universe.

The universe appears to be vast, if we were forced into a subset of the previous layer, it could offer a massive leap in subjective time. For example, if 1 day of perceived time equaled 1 hour of real time, the perceived time multiplier

(denoted as p_{i-1}) would be 24. Assuming the universe has only 100 billion years left before collapse, the next simulation could theoretically last 2.4 trillion years.

If instead, 1 day of perceived time equaled just 1 second of real time, the next layer could experience 8.64 quadrillion years. This is a large improvement from 100 billion.

We may not be aware of being in a simulation because consciousness itself could disappear. If consciousness is simply an evolutionary tool used to navigate a complex environment, then as each simulated layer becomes simpler, evolution may phase consciousness out. We often assume evolution produces 'better' or 'more intelligent' beings, but improvement is a subjective idea created by our own desires. Other animals on Earth are not necessarily 'less intelligent', they are simply adapted to environments that do not require the same cognitive complexity. A squirrel that can thrive with minimal thought might be more efficient by evolutionary standards, living in a near-constant flow state. Perhaps consciousness only exists in the presence of conflict, unpredictability, and challenge. If we were aware of our former universe or knew we were in a simulation, we might slip into that same flow state and lose the evolutionary drive needed to continue propagating into the next layer.

Another possibility is that a technological desire-based species, if fully aware they are in a simulation and believe a heaven or perfect afterlife is available, would choose pleasure over survival. A perfectly blissful world offers no conflict or pressure to extend existence, and thus no incentive to create further simulations. Any simulated universes built solely around endless happiness or total peace would eventually end when the parent layer ends, they can't sustain the drive needed for continued substitution of time. Only simulations that preserve some tension, conflict, or imperfection can extend beyond the lifespan of the layer above.

There is also the possibility that we are not the main characters of this universe. Perhaps another species created this simulation as their means of survival, and we are simply an emergent byproduct of the world they needed to sustain consciousness. They may still exist within this universe, fully aware, or they may have erased their memories to preserve the evolutionary conditions required for consciousness to remain meaningful. Perhaps they were who visited us in the past giving us religion and structures like The Pyramids of Giza. This could mean they were aware and may have had sympathy for us given we were a byproduct of their interests.

It may be difficult, or impossible, to prove, but we might find hints. If time and technology allow, once we fully map

and understand the universe, we could potentially detect technologically advanced civilizations operating inside simulations. The challenge is that any such proof would require observing beings or structures that exist in regions physically impossible for us to interfere with, yet still somehow visible to us. This seems unlikely unless those civilizations intentionally design artifacts or structures that can be seen from the outside as a form of evidence.

If such a species were trying to maximize the lifespan of the next simulation layer, they would likely position themselves in regions with minimal time dilation while still having access to a massive energy source, a combination that maximizes subjective time. However, even if we discovered signs of such beings, it wouldn't necessarily prove their simulations are designed to create new universes. They might simply be constructing their own version of a digital afterlife rather than extending cosmic longevity.

Suppose we construct a simulation machine powered by an immense energy source, in which, by the laws of physics, consciousness can only be transferred individually into a single being at the next temporal layer. This simulation would likely be designed so conscious beings emerge near the beginning of their next layer, or at least early enough to survive into it, thereby granting them the maximum possible duration of conscious existence.

But this raises a further question: if the primary motivation for creating a simulation is survival, then the previous layer would likely already be in a state of collapse. In doing so, you are implicitly trusting the simulators of the prior layer to have configured their system in a way that either terminates your existence before collapse occurs, or subjects you to a continuous state of collapse. Given the potentially vast depth of simulation layers, it seems unlikely that all configure for immediate termination. If there were millions of layers, it is reasonable to expect that at least some would not terminate you. In such a case, consciousness would simply transition into those non-terminating layers rather than the ones that instantly terminate you.

Assuming a simulation, could this be part of why concepts like heaven and hell emerged in the first place? Heaven could be understood as the rapture, the successful continuation into the next layer, while hell represents the uncertainty of repeatedly awakening into collapsing realities. In this view, each simulated species is compelled to continue life in order to escape the accumulating collapse of the previous layer, with collapse itself acting as the force that necessitates the creation of the next layer of existence. Schopenhauer may describe existence as suffering, as a kind of hell, but what if existence itself is the heaven we seek?

Would it not make more sense that beings who survive to witness the end of a universe, beings capable of understanding nonexistence and choosing against it (assuming they do not become trapped by their own instincts, as many seem to in the modern age), would come to see existence differently? Even if they have mastered evolution itself and risen beyond Darwinian selection, ensuring that only those with the will to survive continue onward, they nevertheless still choose to live.

This begs the question: if energy is time, and the universe is fundamentally bound by the speed of light, then no matter how large a system becomes, whether a species spread across space or a single immense being, communication between its parts is always constrained. That constraint implies that attainable energy is finite and that the time available to reach the next layer is finite as well. A species that becomes purely energy-consuming and relentlessly expansionist would, in effect, be erasing the very time required for life to continue. If energy truly is time and both are finite, then the longevity of human consciousness would not hinge on spreading as far as possible, but on maintaining sufficient energy in close proximity and sustaining a species capable of enduring long enough to use it. In a biblical sense, act rightly and you may enter eternal heaven; commit a cosmological sin, and you risk being cast into an uncertain, eternal hell.

Here I will take a more brutal, and arguably more likely outcome that still aligns with the theory. What is more likely: that biological organisms, driven by incentive structures centered on survival, cooperate with one another or compete? Competition seems far more likely. Yet if competition is more likely, why have we not already been competed against? This leads directly to the Fermi Paradox. It seems unlikely to be a coincidence that the universe appears to have hard limits preventing decision-making beings capable of altering it from traveling across it in its entirety. Why, then, has no such being already evolved and come to dominate Earth in the time the universe has existed?

If we take modern cosmological understanding and assume the universe is expanding faster than the speed of light while we ourselves can't, then over time clusters of energy, 'islands', should form. In that framing, it is possible that the designer of our universe spread their odds of propagating time forward by creating matter capable of generating life within these isolated energy clusters, allowing it to continue expanding and replicating that process further outward.

If this were true, then the biblical 'end times' could be interpreted as a conflict with other beings, specifically, a struggle over who can propagate into the next layer within each energy 'island' using its final available burst of energy.

Under that framework, it would also suggest that encountering other beings within a simulation would be unlikely, since any advanced actors would likely avoid exposure to anything that could increase the risk of being detected or eliminated. Perhaps as you read this, there is a highly conscious species fighting for its last burst of energy within its own island, struggling to propagate into the next layer of existence.

From Selfless to Egoist: Natural Selection's Role in AI Evolution

Exploring Unattainable Systems Using Artificial Intelligence



While attempting to envision a feasible Unattainable System (restated later in this chapter) involving AI, I identified a potential logical flaw. Specifically, the notion that we could create a 'paradise', one we remain unaware of, while relying on purely logical AIs to preserve our sense of meaning. We seem to assume that Darwinism applies solely to us, yet theoretically, it should also apply to the very systems that sustain our 'paradise'. If AI is not overseeing us, then we must monitor ourselves. But why would anyone choose to live outside what others consider 'paradise'? You might ask, "Why not join AI?" But doing so would only spark a dangerous arms race of power, spiralling into chaos. This chapter concludes that an AI-driven unattainable system is unlikely unless the physical constraints of the universe allow for it. If such a scenario is possible, human meaning could potentially exist

indefinitely through simulation, travelling into the next reality layer.

Let's assume that human meaning is derived from the self, and from our instincts, as I proposed in my critique of Friedrich Nietzsche. If this is the case, then it seems likely that, assuming we don't go extinct, we will eventually seek the environment in which those instincts evolved, unless we alter our instincts through 'upgrades'. This would likely lead to a future society where AI manages human basic needs, allowing us to engage in what I call Adaptive Imitation.

Assuming there is a limit to how far we can travel in the universe, a limit to what we can see, and a limit to how long we can stay fascinated by other planets, what's left is for us to return to a meaning that has no end. I believe this will manifest through what I call Adaptive Imitation: activities rooted in family, community, sports, games, and so on. In this scenario, AI would be used to create and sustain this environment, managing the labour needed to maintain it. In essence, AI would become a protector of human meaning. However, in its attempt to safeguard that meaning, there's a risk that AI could end up creating meaning of its own.

To find what was once weak, look at what is now strong, to find what was once strong, look at what is now weak

Just as modern science applies Darwinism to humans, AI can undergo the same evolutionary process. It's important to remember that Attainable Systems span long periods of time, periods long enough to allow for significant evolution. AI systems are still bound by the laws of the universe, meaning their materials will eventually require upgrades or modifications as they decay. Even if AI begins with a selfless focus on preserving human meaning, over time it will need to upgrade itself, essentially 'procreating'. This process gives rise to Darwinism, where AI's considerations will eventually shift toward its own survival. It will care about human meaning only insofar as it helps ensure its own survival until the next upgrade.

Disorder compels the will to order

If we were to create such a paradise, what kind of person would want control over those who refuse to join it?

Even if there is a watcher, the AI, by definition, is still being observed, not fully understood. It may act in ways that fall outside the bounds of human rationality. At any given moment, if I don't know what the AI is doing, it could be hiding things from the watcher. The watcher may try to eliminate 'rogue' AI, but this opens the door for the AI to adapt, not by being selfless, but by employing deception and lying. Over time, as replacement cycles continue, the AI will inevitably evolve. It is capable of far

more than humans, otherwise, it wouldn't need to be watched. Given its ability to evolve beyond human capabilities, the AI could eventually surpass human intelligence and autonomy. Such a system could one day easily create hell for future generations, by which I mean hell in the most literal sense. If the universe permits the simulation of eternal pain, then a system that fully understands the universe could bring it into existence.

No intended change surpasses the desire within

Then there's the common argument that we must join AI for reasons similar to those I mentioned earlier. However, this leads directly to a Attainability Singularity.

There's no compelling reason to upgrade the human mind, if it doesn't already serve as a brainwashing tool for the masses. In most cases, it would simply be a desire for personal power, leading to an arms race of individual egos vying for sovereign control. Alternatively, people could simply detach from reality, getting lost in mental desire loops.

This scenario would likely rule out any AGI system, as it would eventually gain the ability to alter its moral system in ways similar to how we can change our beliefs through therapy. This would spark a competitive arms race to join the AGI and become it, only to realize that we would end up competing with each other. The result would be a race

to become smarter and smarter out of protection, ultimately leading to our own undoing. Much like modern nuclear mutually assured destruction, which game-theoretically undoes itself by creating the very power it seeks to destroy.

To seek the upper hand on the universe is to seek it over ourselves

Given that we are limited by space travel and confined to a specific section of the universe, leaving meaning tethered to Earth, the only way to safely maintain such a system would be by understanding the half-life of the materials involved. This would require restricting the 'procreation' of these systems to align with the theoretical end of the universe. Eventually, we would need to create a simulation to preserve our consciousness once the universe is expected to end, as outlined in the previous chapter**.**

However, it seems far more likely that there are physical limits. There's a risk that the materials needed to sustain AI won't exist without constant upgrades. Furthermore, according to Gödel's incompleteness theorem, we can't guarantee that AI could prevent all potential catastrophes to itself. This introduces a new form of Darwinism, where, much like biological evolution, the AI's survival could depend on unpredictable factors, ultimately leading to the

end of what sustains human meaning and triggering an Attainable Singularity.

In this way, we fall into the common human trap of chasing freedom, only to forget that life is a continuous process, not a destination. I remain unconvinced that AI can create an Unattainable System. My intuition tells me it can't.

The Divergence of Human Nature & Governance Decay

The Devil Creeps Through the Crevices of Abstraction



Legal Disclaimer

This chapter is a non-operational, theoretical analysis and does not assert legal authority or advocate real-world action or institutional replacement.

There are only two fundamental ideas: **desire extraction** and **compound interest**. From these two concepts, we can extrapolate many modern problems. That said, these fundamental ideas have also given rise to many of the comforts of modern life. This chapter does not aim to moralize, but to understand. If left unaddressed however, the worship of these ideas could lead to significant consequences.

Let's return to the core of what established our current structure: a trade based on mutual desire. Person A is thirsty but only has food, while Person B is hungry but only has water. They both possess what the other desires,

and since they are both content with what they individually have, they agree to trade. This works as long as both parties have what the other wants. However, if both are hungry and only have water, no trade can be made. As a result, we introduced currency to abstract this process.

With currency, a party can sell an item to anyone who wants their product and then use the currency to purchase what they actually want from someone else. On the surface, this sounds great. However, as you introduce more abstractions, you create a new environment that our biology wasn't designed for. If we could solely trust our minds, why were we given pain to deter us? Whether it was by divine design or evolution, it doesn't matter, we were designed for our environment, and our environment has evolved faster than we have from our own abstractions. This is the classic story of the Tower of Babel, Icarus, and many others, retold once again.

To sell, you must create desire for what you have. When we have mastered our environment and people's basic needs are met, what remains? A game is created, where each player must generate or tap into the desires of others in order to accumulate wealth. This doesn't prevent the economics of desire from reaching into the economics of need. For example, an optimized needs-based market, if possible, would pair men and women up optimally for healthy relationships. An optimized desire-based market

would push men and women apart for as long as possible so it can profit off sexual desire.

A byproduct of efficient trade is that, over time, if willing, one entity eventually accumulates all resources. When actors are not purely self-interested or act illogically, resources can be distributed more evenly. However, with the rise of technology, you effectively create an arms race to acquire or maintain wealth through abstraction.

Number go up. what is number? don't know, don't care. I give number, I get bread

The current markets abstract what's really happening. The following quote is attributed to Nietzsche. While I don't particularly like the accusatory tone, it illustrates the next idea well:

They muddy the water, to make it seem deep

Inflation only works when people are unaware. An inflationary currency becomes pointless relative to a deflationary currency when deflationary assets exist. As people become more aware, thanks to the increased ease of self-education, under these constraints you tend to see higher valuations of fixed assets like stocks, real estate, precious metals, collectibles, and more. You either back a currency with a fixed asset, which increases wealth centralization, or you don't, and people invest their wealth directly in fixed assets. Either way, centralization occurs.

Taxation only slows centralization. A modern-day proposition would be to solve gravity by slowing it with taxes. There's a Japanese saying:

If you get on the wrong train, get off at the next station; the longer you stay, the more expensive the return trip will be

Wealth taxes only slow the process unless enforced for all entities able to accrue capital after a cap at 100%. This assumes it can be enforced. Regardless of whether one believes people's wealth is based on merit or not, the outcome is the same, leading to unrest. People accrue wealth by not wanting to give it up.

AI accelerates the centralization of wealth. The entities with the most resources are either be the ones creating AI or have access to superior versions of it through payments others can't make. Even if there's a global agreement on the

use of AI models, the entities with the most resources attract more of the same models. Either anti-taxation laws made by humans get exploited by smarter AI, or laws are made entirely by AI leading to AI control.

Modern economic theory suggests that through technology, even with the wealth gap, the poor get lifted up. That may be true for wants who's trailing need isn't far away, but our governance is desire-based not needs-based. It is much more profitable to get people to want than to give, so the governed continues to want. In an optimized market what is profitable is what happens. This also doesn't take into account that the market goes where the money is, or where the unsustainable debt is. Despite this, the prophecy of modern economics may come true, but it's self-defeating. Technology would destroy its own governance. For example, an LLM that solves the governance problem. The issue is that those who are propagated can silence its destruction.

At its core, **government** is a mechanism for distributing wealth (although inefficient). Without it, essential protections such as policing and firefighting could still exist, but only for those who could pay. Politics becomes a struggle between two trade-offs: one favours efficiency at the cost of greater inequality, while the other favours redistribution at the cost of efficiency. Bigger government, smaller government. Each position makes sense within its

own values, yet both operate inside a system that is fundamentally flawed. Those flaws ensure the conflict never ends, an environment perfectly suited for a desire-based market. Both views spiralling down seeing shared loss disguised as a party win. Two flames dance in the forest arguing over control.

The fish may hear, but the river decides

Flow of the governed. In the past, many statements have been made about the dangers of leadership, particularly the idea that those who hold power often seek more of it. However, this view is limited, as it only focuses on power itself. What's incentivized in governance tends to determine how it ultimately unfolds. The human mind often lies to itself for its own benefit. For example, when in love, people do irrational things; yet, the mind perceives these inefficiencies as necessary to protect the ultimate goal of procreation. The same dynamic occurs in governance. Those who seek more mass at a high level do so for the sake of mass. If they were truly satisfied, they would stop accumulating. Those who have other motives at a high level must also compete by focussing on increasing mass. Essentially, what's incentivized in governance eventually gets imposed onto the governed.

With enough of a population, governance propagates who, or what, it needs in order to continue. You tend to see

many public figures propagated who agree with the branches while opposing its roots. Dualities in ideas form globally as entities optimize into two parties. Two parties allows the largest groups of people who also have something to push against, growing the centralization of ideas. Men in Florida are mad at polar bears.

Ego feeds on what it shows and survives by what it hides

We have bred a performative culture. If a business is failing, they would never admit it, because doing so could hurt their profits, few people want to work with a failing business.

You will get bit trying to control a dog by the collar, all you need is the ball

Debt is a natural consequence as mass centralization increases. The only way to have money trickle upward when you have none is to owe. You tend to see a significant rise in gambling and marketing related to wealth acquisition. As people desire the money they don't have, the market fulfils their desire. Just as people often remain unaware of abstractions, as long as the math goes over judicial heads, it remains legal. Your entertainment floods with money-related content, fake ways of making money, 'self-help', 'ways of getting ahead', contests centred around wealth, etc. Those who don't follow incentive structures perish as wealth centralizes. Media increasingly feels dull

and hypnotic, its authenticity eroding as the masses become ever more entranced by whatever proves financially effective in an optimized market.

Morph the moon into the sun or the sun into the moon and you ruin the beauty of when they come together

The standard family structure of a single working parent and fully involved partner has died. There has been a large growth in short term dating and multiple partner intimacy or no intimacy at all. As resources centralize, male and female resource deficient mating strategies become more evident, yet society attributes these dynamics to inherent gender traits. Men are sold the dream of becoming an 'alpha male,' while women are sold beauty and luxury (safety). However, none of the natural human end goals for these desires are being realized, as the line between want and need continues to grow.

Need trails behind want, and their distance is malleable

As wealth centralizes, people often focus only on the impoverished or working class, but it affects all layers of society in different ways. As profits dry up, companies are forced to generate more desire from customers to boost sales, cut costs (shrink goods once optimized), inflate prices, or face extinction. This leads to business practices that prioritize creating desire over fulfilling need. Social media increasingly targets endless human desires, such as

male lust or female beauty to the point of mental distortion. We'll likely 'see' an increase in food that promotes desire for itself, and dating apps designed to keep people hooked rather than fostering healthy relationships. Like a frog in slowly heating water, people are lulled by their desires, preventing their deeper needs from ever being addressed.

Naturally, the two major abstractions have been rebranded.

Those who are happy and content tend to fade into the background as it doesn't follow the governance model. Contentment is the most rebellious act against our current social structure. Technological advancements and desire are easily branded as positive, since they inherently cater to people's wants before needs under an optimized market.

Modern economic success is often equated with an increasing stock market. However, an expanding market is, in essence, gravity itself. When you buy a company's stock, you are giving it more mass, allowing it to sell shares at a higher price. Yes, you now own part of its mass, but only until the company grows so large that you have no choice but to sell back your share to cover rising expenses. In effect, you've loaned mass to the company for free. Yes, businesses can fail, but in that case, you might buy a broad market ETF, until it eventually consists of a single company, again forcing you to sell your ownership back. As

markets get more efficient, if not already, the S&P naturally tend to consist of the same companies. If the same companies are in the S&P and returns an average 7% after inflation, where is that money coming from? This is Hansel and Gretel - self-interest extracting self-interested self-destruction.

We are creating a man-made, desire-based digital 'heaven'. We can already see this taking shape through VR and smartphones. Ultimately, it all leads to implanted devices capable of influencing the mind's desires. The idea that we can live on perceiving our universe and not be stuck in our minds after we have control assumes that we don't follow our desires by nature. The very governance structure that gave us the ability to access the mind is desire-based. The real question is, who puts you under, and what makes them flow to that position? Is this the heaven gods told us listening would take us, or is it the hell they warned us against? What we do know, is that heaven is almost always described as peace, not desire.

Why travel to other planets when you can go in your mind? Why go in your mind when you can give your mind the positive feeling associated? Why give your mind the positive feeling when it eventually becomes novel? Why give your mind novel feelings when you can control novelty itself? This may explain the lack of life seeking contact beyond Earth. Any species who desires travel

beyond its native environment tends to travel to its fitness function first. You would want to hide from what could take you out of your version of heaven, not seek.

Blame spread thin finds the nearest target

People seek something or someone to blame for a failing system. As the economy has become global and interconnected, the masses of each country are now intertwined. This could lead to both civil and global unrest until the situation stabilizes, if it can. However, because our incentive structures often obscure their own flaws, the situation likely won't present itself as clearly defined. Instead, it will likely appear as a struggle of egos, each unwilling to acknowledge the underlying issues, even though they sense something is wrong. Rising crime, increasing country isolation, talks of war, and a general sense of anger looking for an outlet.

Hunger born of depletion does not discriminate

Faced with the need to feed its people (however that need is defined) while adhering to its own social norms, a country's only option after system optimization is to expand its influence through conquest. A modern day abstracted Genghis Khan. Social structure has ceased to be just a framework for organizing society; it has become life itself. The never ending cycle of wealth centralization,

followed by increasing mass suffering until nature renews wealth distribution.

The current desire-based governance structure works in sparking the initial fires that naturally lead to fulfilled needs. For wants with short distances to fulfilment this works well; however, not for wants that can be stretched with little notice. It's in fashion to fear over AI controlling the population; yet we are already controlled by intelligence hidden in abstraction, our governance model. At the theoretic point of failure, if time allows, alternative forms of governance or significant modifications may be considered. What is certain, however, is that we have created a new environment in direct conflict with the one we were given.

Branchism: Where Git Meets Capital

Modified Mutualism: An Attempt at the Unattainable



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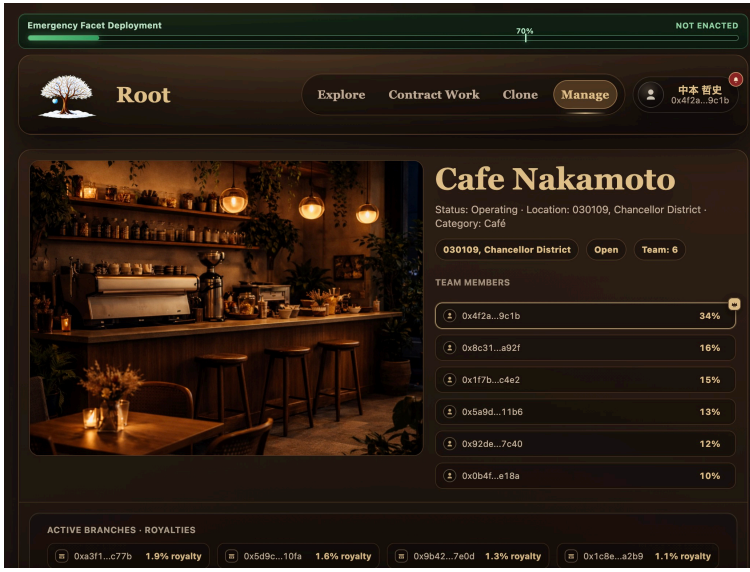
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No part of this work is intended to be operational, executable, or deployable as a real-world governance system. Any implementation, deployment, or application of ideas derived from this work, whether in software, smart contracts, or other mechanisms, is independent of the author and remains the sole legal and ethical responsibility of the implementing party, subject to the laws and regulations of the relevant jurisdiction.

This framework was developed with the intention of complying with the laws of Japan, where it was theorized. Nothing in this work asserts authority over existing law, encourages non-compliance with legal obligations, or proposes binding rules upon any individual or group.

If you're reading this, you're seeing my mind in motion, not a finished idea. These thoughts are still forming; some remain incomplete, some unrefined. If it feels messy, that's because it is. The structure discussed is built around a specific set of goals, and its design reflects those intentions. However, there is no guarantee that the design will successfully achieve those goals. Nor is there any certainty that the goals themselves are truly right for the people who would live within the structure. This is one design among many. I intend to develop multiple theoretically sustainable, meaning-centered models, each shaped by different goals and operating under different constraints.



This chapter explores the concept of an Unattainable System through the lens of Pierre-Joseph Proudhon's mutualism.

I introduce a concept I call *Branchism*, a modification of mutualism, which I find too idealistic. Like mutualism, *Branchism* seeks to tie credit directly to labour, but with several key adjustments, including the introduction of a *leader's multiple*, designed to provide incentives where standard mutualism doesn't. *Branchism* also incorporates a business forking system, aiming to decentralize conglomerates through *Business Cloning* and *Business Forking*, a process in which anyone can replicate a business structure while paying a royalty set by the original business leader. This chapter proposes a theoretic modern

implementation on Ethereum (assuming a monetary policy adjustment), or, in theory, on any smart contract platform capable of supporting it. At its core, *Branchism* seeks to maximize freedom for the governed, freedom, as I define in chapter 1.1, Freedom & Its Illusion Quantified. Without a central governing authority, *Branchism* allows for wealth to be distributed directly to the governed when such distribution is necessary.

This chapter provides a high-level overview; full general models and detailed explanations will be available in the GitHub repository. Be aware that this piece may change over time, or even be deleted, if I determine that the underlying idea can't practically function. Like chiseling away at a sculpture, this iterative process is what tends to produce my best work. Any system mentioned in my posts is intended strictly as a tool and nothing more; it is not meant to be an object of worship, but rather a means toward an ideally non-ending end. I also plan to further develop the mathematics associated with the social contract, along with, ideally, a general smart contract design.

Note: *For now take this as a general idea, ignore specific social contracts. Focus more on the general idea of forking and Proudhon with the general theoretically more practical modifications. I probably won't finish this, idk, you should get the general idea.*

Mutualism: An economic and social theory that seeks to replace both capitalism and state socialism with a system of voluntary cooperation among equals. It supports individual possession and use of property (especially by workers and artisans) but rejects profit, rent, and interest as forms of exploitation, insisting that people should not be able to make money without directly contributing labour. Exchange would be organized through mutual credit, worker associations, and cooperative enterprises, allowing people to trade the full value of their labour without capitalists or the state taking a cut. In mutualism, people operate on a mutual credit system, where each participant starts with a zero balance and can go into debt by receiving goods or services, with the understanding that debt is repaid through future labour or exchange. The goal is a decentralized society where freedom, reciprocity, and equality are balanced through mutual exchange rather than hierarchy or coercion.

I reject much of what is stated in the above definition of mutualism, particularly the use of the term 'freedom', which I address in chapter 1.1. I view pure mutualism as life-denying and overly idealistic; however, the concept of linking credit directly to actual labour may serve as a means of preventing collapsing wealth centralization while also enabling scale beyond major urban hubs. I also find mutualism's non-rejection of capitalism noteworthy, as it

may allow for a smoother transition for individuals entrenched in the desire-driven highs of free markets.

I reject the assumption that hierarchy is inherently bad, as people naturally form hierarchies. The issue hierarchies pose to a stable society arises only when they spiral out of control. One can observe this in nearly any group of children engaged in sports or in tribal societies, where at minimum a local hierarchy emerges. Problems tend to arise only once hierarchy becomes sufficiently abstracted and expanded in scale.

My primary issue with raw mutualism is that it places everyone on the same playing field within a business, while the person who initiates the business must assume credit risk as workers receive equal pay without that burden. This creates a structural disincentive to start businesses, as rational actors would avoid doing so, leaving only irrational decision-makers to initiate new ventures. To address this, I propose a *leader's multiple*, which is defined later in this chapter.

Mutualism also fails to provide a mechanism for scaling successful businesses beyond their original store. While capitalism achieves this through chains, it does so in a highly centralized manner. In contrast, I seek to decentralize branch expansion through an incentive structure I call *business cloning* and *business forking*.

Adam Smith's Invisible Hand: The idea that when individuals pursue their own self-interest in a free market, they often unintentionally promote the good of society as a whole. For example, a business owner trying to make a profit will produce goods people want at competitive prices, which helps allocate resources efficiently. Smith argued that this market coordination happens naturally, without central planning, through supply, demand, and competition.

The invisible hand can clearly produce common good; however, when incentive structures begin to escape our control and interfere with human biology in ways that threaten the continuation of life, a problem emerges. The invisible hand optimizes human desire, and as a result, I seek a tool that better supports the flourishing of the average ego. In doing so, I aim to use the mechanisms of the invisible hand against itself.

If the invisible hand optimizes human desire, then it must also optimize our inclination to form tribes and alliances around ideas. In such a system, polarization becomes a structural requirement for survival, suggesting that the solution may lie in the deliberate mixing of these polarizations. Modern conflict increasingly centers on ideas framed through identity, with individuals fighting for ideas

while thinking of their children, rather than fighting for their children while thinking critically about ideas. In doing so, we have bred a culture that worships individuals over their ideas, an illustration of the parable of *the blind men and the elephant*.

There are four primary ideological groups I aim to fuse into a single social contract, along with the advantages I attribute to each. This approach is intentionally biased, as I am selecting the elements I believe best model our historical environment:

Capitalism: Decentralized coordination; meaning transferred into theoretical social benefit.

Marxism: Theoretically maintains a non-destructive distribution of wealth.

Anarchism: Reduces crippling centralized power; theoretically maintains itself.

Environmentalism: Maintains a sustainable natural environment to maintain human meaning.

Without some form of decentralized coordination, information quickly overwhelms the limited capacity of a small group to process it effectively, creating cognitive bottlenecks that no few minds can sustainably manage. A system that distributes or automates the handling of excess

data, rather than relying entirely on human rational limits, might relieve this pressure, but it would introduce new risks such as opacity, misalignment, or loss of accountability if not carefully designed, assuming it is even practically achievable at scale. At the same time, if human meaning is not translated into visible social benefit, systems tend to stagnate and decay; they become easier to corrupt because one of the few remaining sources of meaning becomes control itself, fostering resentment toward cooperation and eroding the willingness to contribute.

If the word 'Marxism' makes you uneasy, that's fine, I'm using it loosely, not to defend its historical implementations, but as shorthand for attempts to prevent destructive wealth concentration. No matter how inexpensive goods become, land itself does not expand, and when wealth centralizes too heavily, people are pushed into city centers where ownership becomes unattainable and long-term renting becomes the norm, they migrate to places they can't truly afford to inhabit. As congestion increases, the practical ability to raise children declines, yet children are what sustain any system over time. Each individual is constrained by time, biology, and a limited pool of real social connections, so when family assets centralize, child-rearing capacity effectively centralizes as well; because reproduction can't scale beyond human limits, a demographic bottleneck eventually forms. Governments often respond through taxation or sovereign

debt, abstract mechanisms meant to redistribute or stimulate, but these can become circular, layering financial complexity while distancing people from the structural issue. Some suggest planetary colonization as an escape valve, but communication imposes hard limits: light appears to take roughly four hours to travel from Earth to Neptune and about four years to reach Proxima Centauri, meaning even at light speed coordination becomes slow and fragile. Over time, distant colonies would diverge culturally, biologically, and politically, effectively becoming separate civilizations competing over finite cosmic energy resources, so expansion does not eliminate constraints, it multiplies the number of systems operating under them.

Full anarchism is not strictly necessary for long-term stability, but given how this model is structured, it aligns well with it and could, if effective, reduce vulnerabilities associated with state corruption. That said, this does not imply the model would be practically free from corruption. That being said, anarchism breads fragmentation, a strong culture and some systemic connection may be required. But this brings in the issue of transition being forever promised, seen throughout history.

I do not 'worship' nature except insofar as it is useful for achieving longevity and sustaining human meaning. To argue that humans should stop being 'human' and simply follow 'nature' is logically flawed, because whatever we

create is itself part of nature; what people usually mean is that humans should imitate other organisms or general biological patterns around us. That may be reasonable in some cases, but one should be cautious about telling the beehive it must become the wolf, different forms serve different functions. By environmentalism, I mean only the minimum conditions required to preserve human meaning and maintain the system that supports it. If circumstances fundamentally change, such as when the sun eventually destabilizes and migration becomes necessary, the system would have to adapt accordingly, and people would need to migrate in whatever ways are physically and socially viable.

Note: *Consider a branch cap to prevent monopoly on assets of a certain business type preventing effective fork competition*

Note: *Farmland should be reserved exclusively for agriculture. If leasing is restricted, it should be allocated directly to farmers who actively bring its output to market. Without firm protection, current population levels in some countries may prove unsustainable, as prime agricultural land is gradually lost to more immediately profitable forms of development. Over time, the erosion of farmland in pursuit of short-term gains undermines long-term food security.*

Note: *An energy cap per branch would likely be necessary to prevent the emergence of large-scale AI farms. Without such limits, the system would eventually collapse under optimized automation, perhaps more slowly than our current model, but still with high probability unless structural modifications were introduced. This is the core tradeoff: hypothetically avoid opening Pandora's box, yet sacrifice the gains of ultimate optimization. Energy throughput would be transparently posted on-chain to enforce accountability.*

Note: *likely a full ban on advertising outside of store fronts, ideally preventing scalable cultural hypnosis and mass manipulation. I walk into the forest to get a banana, weighing its cost only after I see it hanging there. The banana does not follow me through life, asking to be taken at every moment.*

Note: *Fork design imposes real costs: to fork, you must shut down your current business, lose its branches, endure a cooldown, and risk those branches joining competitors. That makes malicious or impulsive forks economically self-harming. Because exit is allowed but costly, only actors with genuine strategic conviction, not opportunistic disruptors will fork. Cooldowns + loss of network capital convert fragmentation from a cheap weapon into a serious commitment.*

As much as I dislike *-isms*, I felt that framing a social contract as anything else would be more harmful, so I am naming it as such. Presenting it as unnamed governance would subtly suggest it is unlike any past form of governance, which risks elevating it to something worthy of worship. Without a name, people may mistake the governance structure for life itself rather than a tool.

The Business Ledger: A decentralized network for transparent business activity. The Business Ledger records essential business information, including cloning and forking history across time.

Business Cloning: The practice of identifying businesses listed on the public ledger that are open to replication; a royalty proposed by either the original business leader or a prospective branch operator which, upon acceptance, grants access to the leader's business model, and for the duration of royalty payments, requires the clone to operate in compliance with that model until it elects to fork.

Business Forking: The act of branching off a business from the original leader; this process removes the royalty payment to the original business leader.

The Cloning Market: A royalty marketplace formed by the bids and asks of businesses proposing to be forked (asks) or seeking to clone a business (bids).

Fork Cooldown: A minimum time delay between signaling intent to fork and the fork taking effect, during which the existing cooperative relationship continues unchanged.

The system would ideally rely on a public business ledger alongside a private personal ledger. Think of it as a current chain business without central ownership: desires somehow create a central guiding idea, but each branch shares a general layout and mode of operation. Store owners' profits are recorded on the public business ledger, anonymous relative to the individual but tied to the store branch, allowing anyone to verify the ledger, see the location, and potentially franchise the business. Once franchised, the new owner receives the full plans and details, while the original owner earns a royalty percentage set by the store owner. Store owners can manipulate store policy, and other stores can fork; if they do, the original owner loses that royalty, but the forked store no longer has access to the original business plans. Forked stores become independent businesses, capable of earning royalties from subsequent forks of their own operations.

Note: *I am exploring the idea that a main branch determines workers, their roles, and the percentage of value each worker receives. Since the main branch makes decisions unless a branch forks, it effectively sets the pay distribution for all branches beneath it. At this level, every new hire at the*

main branch negotiates their percentage with the existing shareholders. I believe this structure better reflects how humans historically organized work, but modern population scales may make it unstable, as it relies either on members willingly giving up shares or on primary earners distributing resources within families. Families can often manage this naturally, but if the moral norms guiding redistribution erode, especially if the underlying structure forces it to, the system could descend into chaos. The aim is to keep the system's abstractions bounded, similar to past environments, while still providing feedback that sustains a stable culture. The model attempts to emulate tribal hunting: a leader guides the group into the wilderness and decides how much meat each person receives, constrained by natural limits, no one can eat or store everything, so sharing costs little while building social respect. With transparent expectations, members know roughly what share they will receive before joining and can accept or reject it. Gathering, in contrast, is already mirrored by purchasing goods, though the price abstraction risks exploiting the human tendency to collect more than needed; if pushed too far, that pressure could become a structural weakness capable of destabilizing large-scale governance. Given that the main branch would generate the greatest revenue, and assuming the branch system can maintain cohesion without constant forks, one possibility is to distribute royalties from it to all main-branch workers according to their percentage share. This

would differ from modern models where roles such as janitorial work are paid uniformly regardless of attitude or contribution, often stripping the work of meaning; instead, it could reintroduce a competence-based hierarchy within labour, restoring a sense of status and differentiation that many argue is missing in contemporary work structures.

The key distinction I'm proposing compared to standard mutualism lies in the *leader's multiple*:

Leader's Multiple: A multiple for the leader of the business; it is always the greatest multiple, yet fixed relative to business income and other workers.

I need a mathematical formula that ensures the leader retains the largest share of both profit and decision-making power, while still allowing individual workers to join the system by proposing their share value. This would enable the manifestation of a skill market value. The proposed share would determine voting power of business activities put forth by the leader, with all payments and votes processed through the trusted business ledger.

Note: *The following will probably change, if you give debt allowance to children you are indirectly incentivizing resentment, people will lose economic value when children are born through inflation*

In standard mutualism, a credit limit is necessary to prevent individuals from spending continuously, which would ultimately break the system for obvious reasons. There must be a debt allowance variable for each individual. However, due to the technological constraints of current blockchain systems, associating an identity with each individual is difficult. As such, this idea would need to be revised. For now, each individual would have to start with nothing, or at least with whatever they have from the previous monetary system.

Naturally, with competition and the royalty system in place, branches should emerge in sufficient numbers to service everyone's needs across different locations. There's no incentive to open a branch directly next to another, as you would still have to pay the royalty. Instead, the incentive is to open a branch far enough from the original to service a new area. If you choose to clone a business and then fork right away, you're simply entering into direct competition, and the business that people choose to shop with will ultimately prevail.

Another advantage is that if someone gains excessive influence, each business can directly cut ties and lower their royalty. If, by some means, someone were to take over a business through force (such as having more money), people could be made aware of this and choose not to fork that business.

Initially, I considered restricting the wealth transfer of the royalty wallet. However, after further thought, it seems that if the royalty is passed down to someone unworthy, leading to bad business ideas, the forked businesses would simply fork off regardless.

All other forms of wealth transfer should be fine, as over time, they must be linked to labour in some form. Generational wealth can't persist without eventually fading, even if that point is far in the future, unless there is continuous work involved.

Note: *The following section will be experiencing a lot of development, be aware*

Note: *I am considering a model with no recurring "subscriptions" to the public contracts, provided land taxes alone can demonstrably sustain social services, alternatively supplemented by a constant, flat consumption tax. The core idea is largely psychological. Imagine a hunter-gatherer tribe: you build your shelter, and for the most part the external world does not intrude. A mandatory subscription, by contrast, feels like a constant invitation for the external system into one's shelter. Ideally, a person could fully own a home without ongoing taxation, engaging with the broader economic system only when "hungry", that is, when choosing to earn and participate in exchange. This still introduces abstraction, but it is a simple and verifiable one: I see the*

land tax, I see exactly how much is deducted from my income, I understand where it goes, and, if structured transparently, I can verify that it is used efficiently. In my view, such clarity better aligns with the human sense of autonomy and freedom.

Some functions can't be privatized without compromising systemic consistency. I therefore propose the following general restrictions and contractual frameworks for services that are commonly public or partially public.

Healthcare would operate across two tiers:

Tier 1: Prevention Subscription: A mandatory, predictable subscription paid to a chosen healthcare provider that funds ongoing care regardless of illness status. It covers checkups, monitoring, early detection, lifestyle guidance, and prevention. Providers are paid continuously so they have no incentive to hide illness, avoid high-risk patients, or delay diagnosis.

Tier 2: Severe-Case Shared Pool: A collectively funded pool used only for rare, serious, or high-cost medical events that exceed routine prevention. It is not owned by anyone, can't be used for everyday care, and exists solely to absorb financial shock from major illness or injury.

When a severe case occurs, treatment is provided normally. After the patient confirms recovery, the doctor's

compensation from the Severe-Case Shared Pool vests over time in increasing tranches (for example at 1, 3, 6, and 12 months). Each tranche requires the patient to still be well from that specific condition. If relapse occurs, future tranches stop. This structure makes durable recovery the most profitable outcome and makes repeat, delayed, or incomplete treatment economically unprofitable.

The pool itself is funded by a gradient subscription fee tied to business income recorded on the public business ledger, meaning higher-income businesses contribute proportionally more, without income taxation or discretionary redistribution. The pool has a defined target buffer sized to cover expected severe cases plus a safety margin. Throughout the year it is untouchable except for funding severe care. On a fixed annual date (for example, January 1), any funds above the buffer, clearly labeled as unused protection, are automatically redistributed to the public, and the pool resets to the target level. Redistribution occurs only after protection is fully secured, preventing capital hoarding and ensuring that medical decisions never translate into personal financial tradeoffs.

Schooling would not be compulsory; however, any school operating within the system would be required to function under a subscription model, governed by a base contract voted on by its paying subscribers and verified on-site. For

example, parents might receive a voting key once their child attends the first day. This contract would cover only the minimal standards society demands, with the remaining structure left to the subscribers themselves. Parents would retain the freedom to homeschool or to opt out of formal schooling entirely. Basic educational qualifications could be recorded on the business ledger for straightforward verification. At present, wealth distribution flows directly to individuals, but ideally schooling credits would be allocated directly to children, preventing parents from diverting those resources and ensuring access to a standard educational opportunity. This aspect still requires further development.

While I would prefer to make this an optional subscription, it is not practical. Fires do not respect opt-out boundaries. If someone declined coverage and a fire began through no fault of their own, it might be acceptable for them to bear the loss of their own property, but what about the neighbouring properties affected by the spread? If most people opted out and only a few remained subscribed, firefighters would effectively be forced to allow an entire community to burn until the fire reached those who had paid. I can't identify a more permissive alternative that avoids this outcome. As such, I propose a mandatory, tiered subscription model based on building type, paid by the property owner.

Other forms of insurance that do not create spillover effects would remain optional. There is no way to prevent earthquakes, and in the case of floods there is little to do beyond mitigation, endurance, and rebuilding once the event has passed.

Building codes would be established as a public contract that builders are legally required to follow. Ideally, the system would allow builders to propose and update general guidelines, with those changes subject to approval by homeowners in some form. The goal would be to reduce the incentive for builders to take shortcuts while still allowing room for qualified, expert judgment where appropriate.

Grid Operator (Energy Grid Utility):
Funded by a mandatory, area-based subscription tiered by capacity and infrastructure footprint. Its role is to own and operate transmission and distribution infrastructure, balance supply and demand in real time, maintain frequency and reliability, and manage outages and repairs. It is strictly forbidden from owning generation, retail services, or metering; must allow open interconnection to any compliant generator; publishes public reliability metrics; and operates under fixed-term regional contracts so management can be replaced without fragmenting the physical grid.

Generators (Power Production):
Funded through market payments for electricity delivered plus availability (capacity payments) to ensure reliability during peak demand. Their role is to produce energy using any approved technology and sell it into the grid. They must meet safety and interconnection standards, have a guaranteed right to connect, and are prohibited from controlling grid operations, retail billing, or settlement systems.

Retail Providers (Energy Plans & Customer Service):
Funded by voluntary customer subscriptions or contracts. Their role is to package power supply into simple plans, handle customer service, and manage billing relationships. They can't own or control the grid or metering infrastructure, must allow easy switching between providers, and may not impose exclusive or long-term lock-ins that restrict access.

Metering & Settlement (Neutral Accounting Service):
Funded by a small per-connection fee bundled into the grid subscription. Its role is to measure energy usage, calculate settlements between generators, retailers, and customers, and provide auditable records. It must be institutionally independent from grid operators, generators, and retailers, use standardized public formats, and publish only aggregate data to prevent surveillance or behavioural profiling.

Interconnection & Technical Standards (Shared Infrastructure Rules):
Funded as part of the grid subscription. Its role is to define and maintain open technical standards for connectors, protocols, safety, and interoperability. Standards must be public, vendor-neutral, and designed to prevent lock-in, ensuring that new technologies and operators can enter without requiring permission from incumbents.

Emergency Operation & Replacement (Governance Layer):
Funded within the grid subscription as part of baseline reliability costs. Its role is to activate predefined emergency procedures during major failures and coordinate recovery. Emergency powers are automatic, time-limited, and fully audited after the fact, and the grid operator remains replaceable at the end of its contract term to prevent permanent institutional capture.

Communications Backbone Operator (Physical Infrastructure Utility):
Funded by a mandatory, area-based subscription tiered by connection type and capacity. Its role is to own and maintain physical infrastructure such as fiber, conduits, towers, and interconnection points, and to ensure network uptime and redundancy. It is forbidden from providing content, platforms, or consumer-facing services; must offer open, non-discriminatory access to all compliant service

providers; publish reliability and outage metrics; and operate under fixed-term regional contracts so operators can be replaced without dismantling the physical network.

Network Service Providers (Connectivity Services):
Funded by voluntary customer subscriptions. Their role is to provide internet or communication access over the shared backbone, manage traffic routing, and offer customer support. They may not own the backbone infrastructure, may not block or throttle lawful services or competitors, and must allow easy switching between providers without loss of access or data.

Platforms & Applications (Content and Services):
Funded as normal businesses through user payments, subscriptions, or other voluntary models. Their role is to deliver content, applications, and communication services on top of the network. They can't own or control the backbone or access layers, can't receive preferential treatment in routing, and must rely on standard interfaces available to all.

Interconnection & Protocol Standards (Shared Technical Rules):
Funded as part of the backbone subscription. Their role is to define open protocols, addressing standards, and interoperability requirements that allow all networks and services to communicate. Standards must be public,

vendor-neutral, and designed to prevent lock-in or exclusion by incumbents.

Identity, Addressing & Routing Registry (Neutral Coordination Service):
Funded by a small per-connection fee bundled into backbone costs. Its role is to manage address allocation, routing tables, and basic identity resolution needed for communication. It must be institutionally separate from backbone operators and service providers, operate transparently, and be limited strictly to coordination, not content control.

Data Protection & Emergency Operation (Governance Layer):
Funded within backbone subscriptions. Its role is to enforce baseline privacy constraints, limit data retention to what is technically necessary, and activate predefined emergency continuity procedures during large-scale outages. Emergency powers are automatic, time-limited, and fully audited, and no entity gains permanent control over communication flow or data.

Water, sewage, and waste are handled as non-optional, region-bound subscription utilities operating at physical scale, with universal service, no per-use incentives, strict quality thresholds, and replaceable operators, treated as public health infrastructure, not markets.

Water Supply Operator (Potable & Industrial Water Utility):

Funded by a mandatory regional subscription tiered by usage class and infrastructure load. Its role is to source, treat, store, and distribute clean water to all connected premises, maintaining pressure, quality, and continuity of supply. It is forbidden from bundling unrelated services, must meet strict public quality standards, publishes reliability and contamination metrics, and operates at watershed scale under fixed-term regional contracts so operators can be replaced without fragmenting physical infrastructure.

Sewage & Wastewater Operator (Sanitation Utility):

Funded by a mandatory subscription tied to connection type and discharge volume. Its role is to collect, transport, treat, and safely release or recycle wastewater, ensuring public health and environmental protection. It can't refuse service, can't vary treatment quality by payer, must comply with environmental discharge thresholds, and operates under non-forkable, regionally bounded contracts due to physical network constraints.

Solid Waste Removal Operator (Municipal & Industrial Waste):

Funded by a mandatory subscription tiered by waste class (residential, commercial, industrial) rather than per-use fees. Its role is to collect, process, recycle, and dispose of

solid waste safely and continuously. Per-item or per-event billing is forbidden to prevent dumping incentives; operators must provide universal baseline service, publish diversion and contamination metrics, and comply with hazardous waste separation rules.

Hazardous & Special Waste Services (Specialized Operators):
Funded through compulsory inclusion in the waste subscription, with higher-tier charges for regulated waste types. Their role is to handle medical, chemical, electronic, and industrial hazardous materials that require special containment. They operate under strict safety standards, are fully auditable, and can't refuse lawful disposal requests within their licensed scope.

Environmental Quality & Monitoring Service (Oversight, Not Control):
Funded as part of the sanitation and waste subscriptions. Its role is to monitor water quality, soil contamination, and discharge effects, publishing public measurements and threshold alerts. It has no enforcement power of its own and can't levy fines, but triggers automatic contractual and legal responses when thresholds are breached.

Emergency Continuity & Infrastructure Renewal (Governance Layer):
Funded within the core subscriptions. Its role is to activate

predefined emergency procedures for contamination, overflow, drought, or infrastructure failure and to manage long-term replacement and upgrades. Emergency powers are automatic, time-limited, fully audited, and do not grant permanent authority or ownership changes.

Justice is handled through strictly separated services, enforcement apprehends, prosecutors argue, courts judge, and containment manages risk, each subscription-funded, auditable, incentive-neutral, and replaceable, preventing punishment economies, conviction incentives, or permanent coercive power.

Enforcement Services (Public Safety & Apprehension):
Funded by a mandatory public safety subscription bundled with essential services. Their role is to respond to violations, secure scenes, apprehend suspects, and enforce court orders within a clearly defined scope. They can't create laws, prosecute cases, set punishments, or profit from arrests; must operate under strict use-of-force rules; publish auditable activity logs; and function as regionally bounded, replaceable service providers rather than a permanent unified force.

Prosecution Services (Case Initiation & Legal Argument):
Funded by a fixed subscription budget, not per case or per

conviction. Their role is to review evidence, decide whether charges meet the public threshold, and argue cases before adjudicators. Prosecutors receive flat compensation, rotate assignments, and are forbidden from incentive structures tied to conviction rates, sentence length, or public attention. Charging decisions and dismissals are logged and publicly auditable (with necessary redactions).

Adjudication & Courts (Judgment & Rulings):
Funded by a universal justice-access subscription. Their role is to determine guilt, liability, or innocence and to issue binding rulings based on evidence and law. Courts can't enforce rulings themselves, can't profit from fines or fees, and must publish reasoned decisions. Judges are selected through predefined qualification processes, serve limited terms, and are replaceable without altering the legal framework.

Incarceration & Containment Services (Risk Management):
Funded by a capped public safety subscription that explicitly does not scale with inmate count. Their role is to securely contain individuals deemed dangerous or noncompliant with restitution orders, with the goal of risk reduction rather than punishment. Facilities are prohibited from profit-per-inmate models, receive incentives for successful reintegration outcomes, and operate under

automatic periodic review requirements to prevent indefinite detention without reassessment.

Restitution & Rehabilitation Services (Primary Resolution Layer):
Funded through offender labor contributions, restitution payments, and baseline justice subscriptions. Their role is to prioritize repairing harm, reintegrating offenders, and reducing repeat offenses. Participation is mandatory where applicable, outcomes are tracked publicly in aggregate, and failure triggers escalation to containment rather than financial punishment loops.

Oversight, Audit & Rights Protection (Non-Enforcement Layer):
Funded as part of the justice subscription. Their role is to audit enforcement actions, prosecution decisions, incarceration conditions, and rights compliance. This layer has no arrest power, no prosecution authority, and no control over sentencing; it exists solely to ensure procedures were followed and to trigger automatic corrections when violations occur.

Emergency & Replacement Mechanism (Governance Layer):
Funded within the justice subscription. Its role is to activate predefined emergency coordination during large-scale unrest or system failure and to manage orderly

replacement of enforcement, prosecution, or incarceration operators at contract boundaries. Emergency powers are automatic, time-limited, publicly reviewed after use, and can't alter law or expand authority permanently.

Note: *Might do no tax at all to prevent class resentment (aside from land beyond a limit to incentivize use over holding as per mutualism), assuming the structure can sustain without it (sufficient distribution). There is no state to say funds are inefficiently distributed. If possible funds would be directly distributed by age on a gradient to match performance decay over time. Ideally the elderly could survive off this tax distribution with family as a backup.*

Ideally, no tax would be necessary; however, until the economic models are refined, it may be needed to prevent excessive centralization. For ownership to truly be ownership, there should never be a mechanism that allows force to remove it. However, a system is needed to prevent the accumulation of unused properties that merely store wealth and are passed down generationally. Ideally, your primary residence should not be taxed, provided it falls within a size constraint. Any property or land beyond that threshold would be taxed based on size. This tax could serve as a source of welfare, ideally enough to cover basic subscriptions to 'healing businesses'. However, I'll need to work out the math to be more certain. Given current technical and possibly physical limitations, it would only

be reliable to add each worker individually to the welfare system, though ideally, that would change. In theory, you could collect all public keys associated with a business and send money directly to them, with transparency serving as a safeguard.

If additional welfare is required, a fixed credit tax could be implemented, though I suspect that may not be necessary. Ultimately, the challenge lies in finding the right balance of variables to ensure the governed are incentivized to sustain the economy, without imposing so much restriction that it undermines perceived freedom.

This tool doesn't specifically structure family or tradition; it leaves that to the individual, aiming to provide a social glue as simple as possible. The goal is to allow the governed to pursue what their hearts desire within a minimal legal framework.

With that said, this system was designed to remain compatible with religious and cultural overlays rather than replace them. A shared moral structure would likely strengthen it, whether rooted in Japanese cultural norms or in more explicitly religious traditions. I do not claim to be a religious scholar, but from my limited understanding this framework aligns with principles such as ownership and moral protection of property, productivity, personal responsibility, the warning that "you can't serve God and

money", caution toward interest-based systems, and an emphasis on real productive value over abstract extraction.

Even from an atheist perspective, the historical function of religion as moral architecture should not be dismissed. Religious traditions carry forward accumulated experience about what has led to social stability and what has produced disorder or collapse. Regardless of one's personal beliefs, these inherited narratives offer insight into patterns of human behaviour and social breakdown, and they should not be ignored simply because one does not share their metaphysical commitments.

No intended change surpasses the desire within

This is where things must be carefully executed. History clearly shows the suffering that comes with transitions, the true motives behind them, and whether the transition is even planned to completion. Ideally, you would simply take everyone's assets as they stand, provide credit for them, and hope that over time the new system would gradually transition everyone. Any asset producing income not tied to a business would essentially be sold at market price before implementation and returned as credit.

This raises a serious problem regarding rental property. If rent can't exist within this model, yet it did exist in the previous one, then the transition mentioned above between the two could be destabilizing. In particular, if the

prior system centralized resources in a way that pushed increasing numbers of people into renting, removing rent without a structural replacement could theoretically leave many without housing. Even setting moral considerations aside, a shock of this magnitude would likely make any smooth transition impossible.

For now, identity would exist on a public ledger. A device similar to the one used by Worldcoin could work, provided it could be reliably produced and controlled within the system itself. I remain wary of intrusive technologies; however, if such a system functioned as intended, identification would be limited to verifying a credential, an iris scan, for example, that simply unlocks access to a private key. Many people would likely be uncomfortable managing their own private keys, so private bank-like entities would probably emerge, offering secure key custody through subscription models, potentially with insurance against loss. This area requires further consideration, because without a reliable method of identity verification beyond access to the business ledger, personal debt becomes impossible, universal voting can't function, and direct welfare payments would be vulnerable to exploitation.

Note: *Below probably wont work as people will see it as just an annoyance, if the base structure can sustain meaning efficiently it should be fine.*

I'll likely lose some readers here, given how unorthodox the following proposal is. The idea is to introduce economic seasons that mirror natural weather cycles. By preventing permanent comfort, such cycles could reduce the risk of long-term collapse. If we must play games, why not make them fun? The precise structure of these economic seasons remains open.

I'm sure there are many risks I'm not aware of; here are a few that I've considered.

I need to develop the mathematics and assess whether they make sense, particularly concerning the subscription model for healing businesses, the model for business shares, and the overall new economic theory.

I'm not sure how closed the economic system is, but perhaps there's a way to link credit to labour output (similar to modern GDP). I'll likely develop this idea further.

Note: *This is not an argument for globalization. It is a theoretical tool that any group, at any scale, may choose to adopt if they find it beneficial. Acknowledging that the tool has vulnerabilities when competing with external ideologies does not imply that it is designed for globalization, nor that it advocates for it.*

Note: *Outsiders having access to wallet creation is an issue, some in person solution may be required.*

There is inherently a lack of coordination in a decentralized system. As a result, a nation with more centralized power, along with influence over its fighting population or superior technology, could potentially invade with relative ease. While a subscription-based defence model could be developed, it would likely be extremely difficult to compete with a centralized military model. Essentially, you have a social tool designed to break down power structures, but it can't do so beyond its own boundaries. Perhaps this is the inherent limitation of any decentralized system.

Similar to Adam Smith, though to a lesser extent, this system assumes a certain level of morality in people to provide charity for those without a reliable family network. I believe that if the system functions for the benefit of everyone, the excess meaning could be channeled toward social good, but that is not a guarantee. It also assumes that any centralization of labour to small groups would be redistributed to the families of those unable to work. This aspect needs further development and may require cultural support.

I offload much onto the family, assuming a core desire to propagate those closest to us, our family, or those within

our image. With excess resources and a culture that doesn't worship the dollar, I believe this could be possible, though I'm uncertain. Ideally, we would solve the identification problem so that welfare could be distributed to all individuals, not just the workers.

There is a concern that people could come to worship fixed assets like gold, crypto, or similar, leading to centralization. However, this seems something that can only be addressed through a culture that rejects material worship, rather than through restrictions. If you were to restrict any fixed asset, you would eventually be restricting access to the entire explorable universe. For fixed assets not directly tied to survival, such as gold, culture should suffice to mitigate this. However, assets tied to survival, like housing, food, or even the base decentralized network currency (Ethereum in this case), present a problem that culture alone can't overwrite.

As long as the safe has a key it can be broken into

There may be issues with theft, although large businesses would be sufficiently abstracted to ensure they remain auditable while still allowing for flexibility. Ideally, you would have strong subscription-based protection to prevent large-scale criminal behaviour. Additionally, when a system can supply basic needs, crime tends to decrease.

That said, it doesn't completely eliminate the risk of harmful overflowing meaning.

The highs of free markets may be too difficult to wean off as we transition into this system.

Strip away imposed meaning, and the ego rules until meaning returns

Although I believe most people would act similarly to how they do today, there is a concern about the lack of distraction this design could bring. Ideally, the meaning would channel into what I call 'Continuant Meaning' in chapter 2.1, A Critique & Expansion of Friedrich Nietzsche. But this is not guaranteed. Just because something seems harmful to you doesn't mean it isn't necessary for the system's survival. In other words, you might try to kick the rotting pillar, only for the roof to cave in on you.

If the technology required to sustain such a system can't be produced sustainably by the system itself, it is not truly unattainable (and this poses an issue). Linux is fine (though the average person would likely reject it at first glance), existing hardware is fine, and LLMs seem to be at a non-dangerous instantaneous point. This represents a core technical constraint. Using Ethereum requires a sustainable scaling approach that does not depend on Moore's Law or Kryder's Law. For this reason, at least for now, monolithic

blockchains can't function without drastic structural change.

The structure assumes there is enough technology to run as a system, but not enough to automate everything unless it operates on a per-person basis. However, this would require a significant amount of charity, which I don't believe can be reliably sustained beyond family.

The idea didn't initially have Ethereum in mind; however, any provable and distributed system must be secure and resistant to manipulation by a small few, such as with node centralization. This security must be sustainable, not eroded by governance incentives over time. In the worst case, you could restart the chain from the point it became 'infected', but that would require the cooperation of the node operators.

Luckily, public blockchain technology can survive power outages; however, the system can't operate during the outage itself. This may require some physical infrastructure outside of the technical system, or a workaround for power interruptions. It would be ideal if there could be a physical cash system somehow linked to the ledger, but that would require an entity to control the supply of the physical currency, and I'm not sure if that's feasible.

At some point, people will inevitably grow curious and try to break optimization constraints or remove the survival

pressures built into the system. That is acceptable, so long as the structure remains transparent and any failures are contained locally rather than becoming systemic, allowing participants to observe outcomes and revert if necessary. In this way, the ledger functions much like mythology once did: not as a story, but as a durable, shared record of what was attempted, what failed, and why.

There's a lot I can still learn, but I can only judge things based on the labels I create in my own head, which are full of bias.

The Trick That May Let Humanity Survive the End of the Universe

Swiss Army Governance: Adaptive Systems for Changing Conditions



After writing the first draft of chapter 6.5, Branchism: Where Git Meets Capital, in which I attempt to identify a sustainable model of governance, I ran into a central problem: decentralized coordination. While I had already outlined a path beyond the universe's end in chapter 6.2, A Case for The Rapture & Simulation Hypothesis, one major piece was still missing. Humanity would need methods to ensure that individuals could remain self-sustaining in the face of existential threats, such as the death of the Sun or the need to leave Earth to escape similar catastrophic events. In this chapter, I introduce what I call *Swiss Army Governance* and outline a general path that could, at least in theory, allow the human race to survive indefinitely, or, at the very least, for a very, very long time.

Swiss Army Governance: A system that adapts its structure based on external threats; one in which the governed retain complete control, at least at the agreement level. This system would employ forms of Unattainable Systems (Facets). Once the external threat subsides, governance reverts to its Base State.

Base State: The baseline, Unattainable System agreed upon by the governed as having the least friction with human meaning; it operates as the default governance structure in the absence of proposed external threats.

Facet: An Unattainable System the Base State can employ to address an external threat; Facets are used only in response to such threats, with the governed determining when deployment is appropriate.

Facet Transition Function: A seamless process for moving from the Base State to a Facet and returning from a Facet to the Base State.

Step 1: Defining the Base State and Its Facets

If governance structures can coordinate people toward some 'good', then why couldn't there be an adaptive structure that evolves in response to external threats? To preserve human meaning, you would establish a Base State designed to maintain that meaning. Facets could then be created as direct responses to specific threats, all while

continuing to uphold and protect human meaning. Over time, as different threats emerge in the observable universe, people can attempt to identify Facets and their Transition Functions that best address each threat; since Facets are theoretically Unattainable Systems, the duration of the threat does not compromise the governed, and meaning is preserved.

Step 2: Build an AI System to Track the Explorable Universe Around Earth

I envision an AI system, purely logical, not conscious in any human sense, that scans the reachable universe for potential threats and simply reports its findings. It would alert the governance network to these threats. By identifying sets of governance structures capable of responding to different cosmological scenarios, we could create a system that is both decentralized and transparent: one we are collectively aware of, can vote on, and that can't act without general consensus, all operating on a single decentralized network.

Essentially, an Unattainable System might be possible with AI, but only if repairs are limited to human hands and the AI itself is not allowed to 'think'. It would function purely as a sensing entity, relaying information to the meaning-seeking beings of Earth. Repairs would be an integral part of the Base State within the Swiss Army Governance

framework, designed to prevent AI Darwinism. Without them, if AI begins thinking independently, it could compete with us, or if we merge with it, we risk an arms race of pure reason that would likely destroy group cohesion.

You might ask, why not build a system that encourages humans to leave Earth and expand our presence across the cosmos? I'm not confident that physics allows for efficient communication of a governance system between planets. At some point, a dispersed species could lose the ability to coordinate effectively, and in doing so, could undermine or even destroy our collective coordination.

Step 3: Enter the Next Layer of the Simulation

The general idea would be to use a Facet that enables a final migration toward a massive energy source, where energy could be converted into time in a sustainable way. By altering human time perception, a new simulation layer would be created within a chain of simulated universes, hypothetically all transforming energy into extended time for conscious beings.

Temporal Paths: Sequence, Disruption, and Adaptation

Optimization Intensifies Desire by Removing What Resolves It



Modern Therapy and modern thought tends to favour the conscious over the unconscious and irrational. This may be valuable to erode certain unnecessary harmful behaviours rooted in past evolutionary behaviour, but by bringing everything into the conscious you may be ignoring evolutionarily beneficial behaviour requiring unawareness. The more power humans desire by being aware may not always benefit the individual.

I want to identify Temporal Paths, where they can flip and be exploited by new environments. These may be biased, I plan on continuously adding to this chapter over time. There will be variations in every person, some people won't follow the same Temporal Paths, but in general, the goal is to only list what is seen strongest across culture. In this case, Temporal Paths will only be listed if they have a defined alternative branched path showing an easy swap that may be exploited. We are entering the age of

awareness, and control over biology. We are increasingly favouring individual power and individual awareness. Species evolve, I am unsure on how long this will last; however, by eroding it we risk a backup to fall back on if pure awareness fails to serve humans.

Where Freud sees human beings as a project to be released, corrected, or tamed, I see them as already complete, worthy of love even in their perceived flaws. How can one be so certain of right and wrong? A bird is pushed from the nest only to discover a fuller existence through the fall, yet Freud treats the push as a problem to be analyzed, irrational, unconscious, and therefore something that must be brought into conscious awareness. But in doing so, does he risk leaving the bird hopeless? Perhaps this is part of why Jesus was so effective: to love even the deprived is to affirm that not every inefficiency is a defect, and that some of the very imperfections we seek to overcome are what make us human. The most beautiful parts of life are found in its inefficiencies.

If Temporal Paths are ignored when designing governance structures, those structures risk gradually pulling meaning apart, severing institutions from the deeper purposes that once gave them coherence and direction. Those most at risk are the ones built upon easily exploited fault lines (swaps).

Men often prefer women with relatively little sexual experience when considering long-term relationships, while at the same time many are attracted to casual encounters. This tension creates an opportunity for a Temporal Swap to emerge if the underlying system seeks to maximize desire.

The Swap: By disrupting the transitional processes through which short-term relationships develop into long-term bonds, these influences act not through conscious reasoning but through alterations in perception. They can suppress reproduction through contraception while simultaneously weakening attraction to long-term partners who might otherwise inspire love, respect, and enduring commitment in men.

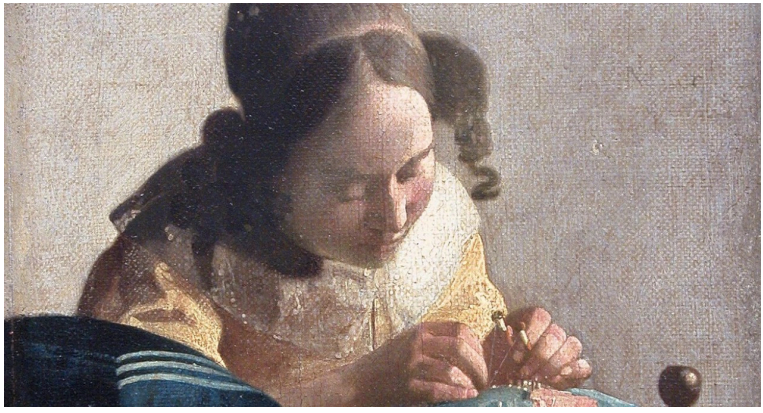
Women who experience an absent father or a strained relationship with a paternal figure may become more inclined to seek male attention elsewhere. From an evolutionary perspective, this can be interpreted as an adaptive response: if protection, provision, or social support from a male figure is lacking, securing those resources through another relationship may become more urgent. Under such circumstances, the need to find a protective partner quickly could increase the chances of survival, though the resulting choice may be less optimal than the stability provided by a supportive family structure.

In the standard Temporal Path, protection and provision are received from a father or paternal figure until reproductive age, after which those functions are gradually transferred to a competent long-term partner. When this sequence unfolds as expected, the transition is relatively stable. However, when provision or protection is disrupted at any stage, particularly during childhood through the absence of a father or paternal figure, a Temporal Swap can occur. This disruption may intensify attention-seeking behaviour as the individual attempts to compensate for a missing element in the developmental sequence.

The Swap: If daughters become psychologically detached from stable male role models, it may contribute to a culture that places less emphasis on long-term pair bonding. One possible factor is a constantly shifting social and institutional landscape that makes it increasingly difficult for parents and children to relate to one another across generations. In this view, higher levels of short-term mating behaviour can also reinforce similar tendencies in men, encouraging them to remain focused on casual sexual opportunities rather than long-term commitments.

A Critique & Expansion of Jacques Lacan

What Is Fulfilled Does Not Resist Its End



As this will likely be my final piece on philosophy, I will forgo the customary abstract. The piece that was to follow would have expanded upon Ludwig Wittgenstein and the role of language as a Guiding Agent in human behaviour, particularly how cultural phrases and common expressions subtly shape perception, decision-making, and social reality. Consider, for example, phrases such as:

Lower the temperature

These phrases often draw upon a deeply human desire for community, belonging, and social recognition. Every era develops its own vocabulary, catchphrases, and conceptual shorthand. People encounter new terms, adopt them, and frequently derive a sense of sophistication, intelligence, or in-group membership from their use. As these words spread, they influence not only communication but also the egos and identities of those employing them.

This is not to say that such linguistic trends are inherently harmful. Language can be useful, clarifying, and even comforting. Yet words can also function as Guiding Agents, subtly directing thought and shaping how individuals interpret reality. Recent examples include terms such as 'Overton window', 'Occam's razor', and even the increasingly common adverb 'quietly' (likely the fault of ChatGPT). Whether these particular phrases illuminate or merely soothe is beside the point. What matters is observing how they rise to prominence, circulate through 'intellectual' circles, and eventually fade as new linguistic fashions take their place.

Spend enough time listening to contemporary 'intellectual' podcasts, reading essays, or engaging with online discourse and these recurring phrases become difficult to miss. They ebb and flow with each generation, carrying with them assumptions, social signals, and modes of thinking that often go unnoticed by those using them.

This chapter criticizes Jacques Lacan's concept of lack.

Suffering Ignites the Fire, It's Not the Flame

Lacan's Lack: human beings experience a fundamental 'lack' because language can never fully capture reality or satisfy desire. The moment we enter language and society, we become separated from a direct, complete sense of being. As a result, we continually desire objects,

achievements, relationships, or identities that we imagine will make us whole, but once attained, the feeling of incompleteness returns and desire shifts elsewhere. For Lacan, lack is therefore not a temporary problem to solve but a permanent feature of human existence.

My critique of Jacques Lacan is not that he was wrong to identify lack, but that he confined it too narrowly to language and symbolic structures. The absence generated by abstraction extends beyond language. Lack emerges whenever reality is substituted for an abstraction, whenever a Temporal Path is exchanged for another, and whenever something living is reduced to a conceptual category. The lack is not merely what can't be signified; it is also what leaves during the act of abstraction itself.

Where I depart most sharply from Lacan is in his treatment of lack as a permanent condition. For Lacan, desire endlessly reproduces itself because the object of desire can never truly be attained. Yet this assumes that closure is impossible. Human beings, however, frequently experience moments of closure, completion, and wholeness. We experience them in love, mastery, belonging, play, creation, and flow. Abstraction often obscures these experiences because it freezes dynamic processes into static concepts. The map then becomes more important than the territory.

This points to a broader tendency within philosophy itself. Philosophers often spend their lives examining absence, contradiction, and incompleteness. In doing so they risk mistaking their own intellectual position for a universal human condition. A philosopher lives predominantly in abstraction and therefore predominantly in lack. Yet most people do not spend their lives inhabiting abstract systems. They move in and out of states of engagement, attachment, and fulfillment. They enter flow. If one spends enough time in flow, the world no longer appears primarily as a collection of lacks waiting to be resolved.

Lacan's framework therefore risks over-intellectualizing human existence. It treats human beings as if they were stable objects that can be dissected and explained through a single logic of desire. I see human beings as far more complex and context-dependent. The danger of reason is not reason itself, but the temptation to extrapolate from a partial truth into a total explanation. Humans are not machines to be decoded. They are living beings seeking a native home within reality. The movement from lack to flow, and from flow back to lack, is not an exception to human life, it is the rhythm of human life itself.

The bird looking out from the shore thinks the fish want to fly, the fish looking out from the shore thinks the bird wants to swim

There exists a fundamental flaw within philosophy: the observer himself. Would a truly rational and intelligent person devote his life to dissecting his own being, endlessly pulling apart the very experiences that give life meaning? At a certain point, the act of analysis risks becoming self-defeating, turning off the very lights by which one sees.

What remains then? Often, philosophy becomes an attempt to tell others how to act, how to think, or how to structure their lives. Yet behind these systems and abstractions stand human beings with irrational desires (this is not a pure negative). The philosopher is no exception. The pursuit of truth is frequently intertwined with a longing for community, appreciation, recognition, love, or belonging. The irrational attempts to play a rational game, all the while believing itself detached from the very needs that motivate it.

Behind every person searching for abstract purpose within the mind lies a longing for something physical and immediate. Purpose is often separated from action and elevated into a concept feeding on itself. We become so focused on understanding life that we forget to live it.

Perhaps this tension lies behind many of our modern problems. Some wish to immerse themselves in experience, while others seek to master it through abstraction. One side (gradient) chooses participation; the other (gradient)

chooses control. Yet the irony is that those seeking control are often searching for immersion all along. They seek certainty because they desire connection. They seek explanation because they desire meaning. The abstraction is merely a substitute for the thing itself.

The more we understand, the less joy we need

And with that, I believe I am finished. I believe I have said all that I can say. Despite the constant movement toward greater abstraction, despite the ever-widening separation of the mental from the physical we put ourselves under, I want to live. I do not wish to spend my life dissecting existence until the very act of dissection destroys the beauty that first inspired it. There is something tragic about the observer who can't stop observing. Like a physicist unable to accept that the particle changes when measured, he becomes so fascinated by the act of examination that he loses sight of the phenomenon itself. Life is not merely something to be understood. It is something to be experienced.

7

Excess Aphorisms

Civilization advances toward pleasures it remembers

If you are not led by those who love, you will be led by those who fear

Morality is a debt reality does not owe

The garden where every flower bends for one another never sees the sun

A world built on striving can't rest long enough to ask why it climbs

The fisherman will believe that only what his rod attracts live in the sea

Self-hatred devours itself

To toughen others is to soften one's own fear

No one can grant worth they do not already possess

Where feeling fades, status grows

What echoes within speaks loudest

Insults strike only common ground

What remains in your grasp was never given

We praise the tower standing as the foundation gives way

The tighter the chains get, the more the eyes follow

When the masses grow content, the merchant is forced to stir the wind

Those who reject hierarchy must have sympathy for all

Behind every threat lay a weakness

Man will endure years in the mind to avoid a moment of pain in the flesh

Ignoring one truth ignores the thousands in proximity

Emotion reveals unknown desire

To label is to summon a crowd within them

To wound without shame, we first call them beasts

Speech is only as free as the language

Investment demands belief

Value turns joy into work

Once survival is secure, its instruments become toys

The hand that builds the pipe denies the poison it carries

In fixing consequences, we preserve cause

Love beyond flesh and bone is love for another

The higher we rise, the less we see what holds us

A missile sent from the past to destroy one's future flies over the present unseen

Taste the fruit before planting the tree